

On
Cognition
and
Inquiry.

Toward an Introduction to Academic Study.

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Preface.

There are many writings on the study of the sciences [Videnskaber] in general, and on academic study and the student's vocation [Kald] in particular. The present one is a new attempt of this kind, following a plan of its own. If giving oneself a full account of what one does and accomplishes can do nothing but advance a person in his striving and activity—so that he may come to act with complete clarity and composure—then this must be especially important for the one whose whole endeavor is precisely to examine, everywhere, the innermost nature and essence [Væsen] of things. And though there may admittedly be, in other spheres of activity, people who, instead of being advanced, would be held back and arrested—indeed led astray in their striving—were they to strain to penetrate into their own selves and search out all that underlies their active power and the natural gift they have to thank for it, this cannot hold of the student as such; for he, called to penetrate to the ultimate grounds of all cognition [Erkjendelse] and of all things, and above all to ponder the nature of spirit [Aand] and of the spiritual life, cannot exclude from that inquiry the form of life that emerges in his own inner being.

This is why, in our own time, reflections on academic study have been made the subject of separate lectures at the universities.

But if one considers more closely what belongs to such a treatment and what does not, difficulties arise—difficulties that the author of the present attempt, too, could not but feel. To clarify the nature and essence of scientific study, one must enter into considerations that other scientific disciplines nonetheless claim as their own, and the question then becomes how a boundary is to be drawn between the two. Let me be permitted a few words on this matter here, so as to clarify the relation in which this presentation is meant to stand to the other scientific developments it meets at several points.

To show what a person who strives after genuine cognition and science [Videnskab] ought to keep in view, the first and most important thing is to consider what cognition and science are. But underlying all cognizing lies thinking [Tænkning]. The ordinary

developments of logic, however, cannot belong here. Just as little does it belong here—though the life that is to live and take shape in the scientific inquirer [Gransker] is indeed the object of our consideration—to set out the various life-activities that are to be distinguished in our spiritual life, together with their relations and connections, or to enter into psychological investigations. Nor should an introduction to academic study be confused with that general introduction to philosophy which has, with good reason, lately been established as a discipline of its own. Yet this latter cannot but come into manifold contact with all these investigations. And so the question arises what an introduction to academic study really is to be and to accomplish; indeed, doubt [Tivl] may well arise whether it can even claim and fill a place alongside those other scientific presentations.

We bring this matter to clarity most easily by asking how we came—how others before us have come—to make academic study a distinct object of distinct investigation. It was because it had to matter to the student, who as such has his own particular vocation, to reflect on this vocation of his, on his striving and activity. Among the forms in which the general spiritual life that psychology considers can come forward in a particular individual existence, hypostatizing itself in a distinctive way, the life that is to live and dwell in the student is one; in other individuals, in other spheres of activity, it takes shape in other ways. What now serves to illuminate this form of life from every side, and to remind us what it really is that we as students strive for and ought to strive for—and what we, in the midst of a life in which so much can distract and confuse, or draw us toward one-sidedness [Eensidighed], hold us back and detain us, ought constantly to keep in view—this is what belongs here. And thus there appears a distinctive center around which the manifold [Mangfoldighed] that presents itself to reflection must gather into unity [Eenhed].

A presentation of this kind may be regarded as a sort of monograph. Of such self-standing scientific treatments of the whole nature and character of certain particular objects—or of objects belonging to larger scientific systems—one can conceive two kinds. The usual natural-historical ones, and those resembling them, treat their object exactly as it is otherwise treated in its place within the doctrinal edifice to which it belongs, and so are to be regarded merely as excerpted sections or pieces of the larger scientific whole—perhaps only elaborated more fully than usual. Of a different character, by contrast, is a monograph such as the present one. Items of knowledge that otherwise belong in the most diverse places in other sciences are here to gather about a single point, in order—together with, and in one with, the reflections on what is peculiar

to the object—to illuminate it fully and from every side. Such a monograph, more difficult and intricate than one of the first kind, also has a better claim to stand forth as a self-subsisting scientific inquiry, or as a smaller whole within the great whole of the sciences; for here there is a distinctive center for a scientific organization of its own, whereby a body of interconnected cognitions grows together into unity in a peculiar way. And this organization—the inner ground-form of the presentation, the inner mode of connection and sequence of its parts, the course of its development—is determined by the object's own distinctive fundamental nature, not by a norm and manner of presentation borrowed from another science and fixed by that science's course and method [Methode]. A monograph of this kind stands to the sciences to whose fundamental considerations it attaches itself—and to which much of what it presents and works out is to be traced back, though always in a distinctive way determined by the object, and in a light of its own—as a talent stands to the general activities of the mind. Take away from a talent all that belongs to understanding [Forstand] and judgment, sense and imagination, reason [Fornuft] and feeling, and nothing will remain that could be called a talent; and yet a talent is something other than those more general activities of the mind. What, then, is a talent? It is the distinctive combination of them all in certain definite directions—the distinctive organization of the mind with respect to their united cooperation, aimed at a certain kind of productivity. Just as a thorough psychological portrait of a given talent does not consist in a portrayal of those more general mental activities in general, but must presuppose them as known—while it is precisely they that it must everywhere attend to and keep in view—so a monograph like the present one may have to look toward many particular points which, taken in and for themselves, belong to definite places in definite sciences, and may have to present much that, piece by piece, other sciences could claim and draw to themselves, and can nonetheless be, and assert itself as, a distinctive scientific whole in its own right.

It was, moreover, my intention from the outset—the reader will perhaps notice this easily in several places—to lay the content of the present work before the public in a form other than the present one: in the same form in which I have several times imparted it to my listeners, the form of lectures. The lecture is, among us, without doubt the mode of presentation that could most easily take the place the dialogue holds in Plato; like the dialogue in his day, it is taken directly from life, and the development of general concepts can hardly, in any way natural to us, be better combined in a connected presentation with speech's immediate address to individuals—and take on the liveliness that must follow from such direct attention to the thinking beings who are to be called upon to

meet what is presented with their own independent thinking [Selvtænkning]—than in the form of the lecture. But the fear that I might not come even remotely close, that my attempt might fall all too far short of the ideal of such a presentation which hovered before me, brought me to abandon the execution I had already begun.

I had also intended from the outset, in the Remarks to §§ 13–17, to treat the individual principal fields of study, both with respect to the philosophical and in the other principal respects. But what I might have said about this I later decided to set aside and reserve for the oral lectures I hope still to give on academic study, for those students who are still at the beginning of their course. I dared not credit myself with such an acquaintance with so many sciences that I should be able, even in general terms, to offer reflections on their study fit to be laid before the public in print, in a word fixed for good—or at least for a long time.

I must further note that if, in the present work, I have departed from the practice I observed in the two scholarly works I have previously produced—namely, of emphasizing no word—this has happened because I believed I ought to yield to the urging of one of those among my friends to whose company I owe much, especially with respect to my philosophizing endeavor. But since I am not accustomed to underline as I write—because it almost never occurs to me that it might be necessary—and since this time I had nearly finished the whole book before the decision to do so was prompted in me, so that I carried out the underlining only at the work’s final revision, whereas the moment of writing something down is the right moment to decide which word should be emphasized—I dare not hope that I have carried out the decision with the best success, and I therefore ask the reader, who will in any case find enough else to overlook, to extend his forbearance to this too.

This is what I had to send ahead of the work I herewith deliver into the hands of the public.

Copenhagen, 13 November 1821.

Sibbern.

Synopsis.

All cognizing [Erkjenden] is essentially a finding, a receiving, and a beholding. Truth, presenting itself out there of its own accord, refers itself to an apprehending individuality and carries with it, for the latter, a necessity that produces conviction [Overbeviisning], to which a personal affection is joined. (§ 1.)

Yet we cognize only insofar as we ourselves bring forth. *Scimus, quia facimus*. A living personality cannot receive except in and through its own forth-working. (§ 2.)

Receiving and producing here become one. Precisely by ourselves shaping truth's expression or presentation within us do we receive it and are made alive by it. (§ 3.)

In pure beholding, however, productivity is lost and does not come into view. But in the striving to cognize perfectly, reflection makes it become free and show itself as such. If we ask why we come to truth only slowly, through reflection—why its fullness is not given at once—the answer is: because a realm of freedom is to come forth, so that a realm of love may become actual. (§ 4.)

The thinking called forth by reflection now leads to a cognizing by force of grounds [Grunde]. The highest cognizing would indeed be a pure beholding of perfect truth, raised above all inquiry [Gransken] and grounding; but such an immediate beholding of the highest is not granted to the human being. Rather, all his assurance rests, in the end, on an immediate faith [Tro]. (§ 5.)

The endeavor to cognize by force of grounds is an endeavor to cognize truth in its truth. This is what calls forth genuine scientific study, which first truly begins with academic study. (§ 6.)

Cognition now becomes an intelligent cognizing (as opposed to the empirical); a cognition of truth in its truth is necessarily a cognizing by force of the constitutive First, hence a cognizing *a priori*, which leads to a construction *a priori*. (§ 7.)

Such a cognizing then aims not merely at grounds for our assuming something, but at things' own grounds of existence [Tilværelsesgrunde]. All philosophizing strives to

find these. (In mathematics, by contrast, we have a great example of a cognizing—even a wholly intelligent one—that does not aim at this.) (§ 8.)

The real grounds of things we find, most immediately, in the rational orderliness [Forstandighed] that, within a coherent order of things, requires or entails them—indeed, in the concepts [Begreber] of things. (§ 9.)

But as the ultimate ground there appears an all-real active First which, in bringing a determinate order of things into actuality, sets the individual things into existence in accordance with a rational lawfulness [Forstandsmæssighed]—indeed, in accordance with concept. (§ 10.)

This all-real presents itself to us in the Idea [Idee]. Cognition is in itself the Idea's own self-presentation in consciousness, even if it does not always show itself—or is not seen and possessed by us—as such. That truth is not a mere correspondence between an assumption and its object, but is that which livingly produces this correspondence, is clear from this. (§ 11.)

The Idea presents itself to cognition and comes to outward life and subsistence in science. (§ 12.)

The first thing in all genuine science is the Idea itself, as science's center and all-determining soul. In the cognition of it, and in the tracing-back of all cognitions to it, the speculative and philosophical element in science shows itself. Yet philosophy can also show itself already in the immediately judicious—in a certain scientific way of thinking and judging. (§ 13.)

In speculation's transition to the manifold—which is thereby to be beheld in its proper light—and in the determination of that manifold, dialectic enters, partly as a philosophical art of annihilation, partly as a scientific art of construction essentially and immediately bound up with it. (§ 14.)

Genuine cognition is, further, necessarily and essentially systematic. Yet the immediately free judicious element, just as it must prepare the way for the system, must also not be displaced by it. (§ 15.)

Furthermore, in all science the exact study of the particular [Detail] is of importance. (§ 16.)

Finally, in all science method [Methode] is still to be noted. It is best developed out of the science itself and its historical course of development—just as the study of a science's history is of essential importance for the study of the science itself. (§ 17.)

Not only in science, but also, through science, in a personal individuality does the Idea take shape, and thereby come to a complete outward existence or subsistence in

real actuality. (§ 18.)

To attain this subsistence and life in the individual, the Idea then calls forth its own opposite, setting the individual's sense of independence in motion and summoning a recognition and avowal [Er- og Vedkjendelse] that is to follow on the individual's part. (§ 19.)

Independent thinking [Selvtænkning] is called forth by a questioning. The possibility of assuming, but also of not assuming, then appears. Denial and affirmation stand opposed to one another. But the assurance that arises out of doubt [Tvivl] beaten down—the Yes that comes forth from the denial of a negation—is of an entirely different nature than what has not passed through this trial. (§ 20.)

The Idea's coming to the individual then appears as a kind of testing, and everything depends on whether that now follows in the individual which is to follow. There is indeed something here that lies within the individual's power; but that on which everything depends does not lie within his power, and must, when it is given, be received as pure grace. The conflict that is here to be brought to unity is seen above all in theological study. Yet in several respects there is a trial to be undergone here, since, on the one hand, egoism easily comes to draw nourishment from the consciousness of the independent thinking to which the summons has been made, and, on the other, the very endeavor after insight can easily lead into uncertainty, confusion, and error. (§ 21.)

Finally, the Idea will live and take shape not only in individuals, but in a whole of humanity, in which each is to find himself as a member and to intervene practically in the exercise of a definite vocation [Kald]. In the choice of that vocation, science and Idea must themselves guide us. We must, further, take science with us into life, and the exercise of one's vocation must at the same time be a constantly continued study. (§ 22.)

But the highest, the one thing needful—however lofty and significant genuine cognizing may be—is nonetheless not yet cognition itself. (Conclusion.)

§. 1.

All cognizing [Erkjenden] is essentially a finding, a receiving, and a beholding. (*Scimus, quia accepimus.*)

For all cognizing aims at the true, and in and through it we are to come to truth [Sandhed]—to come to have and possess it. But truth is not something dependent on us; it is and remains, without any regard to us, what it is in itself. Ours, then, can only be to seek quite directly to become conscious of it as it is in itself and presents itself to us; but such a coming-to-consciousness is a receiving, and—when it is determinate and clear and at the same time immediate, or certain and self-evident by itself alone—a beholding. But this immediate, self-certain element is present at every point in all cognizing, even when we reach it in a mediated way; for cognition then still always rests on the insight that, from such prior cognitions, the present one follows—and this following, or consequence, must be self-evident directly, or must be beheld. With this, what thus follows likewise shows itself as that which, on the presupposition of the truth of the prior cognitions, is self-evident, though only on that same presupposition is it also cognized. So that even relative and mediated cognition, at the point where it first enters by virtue of its mediateness, proceeds from a direct insight, and so far is itself an insight and a beholding. It is a beholding that gradually develops. In every case it is a receiving.

As such, it is always and essentially bound up with a necessity to represent [forestille] just as one does represent, and not otherwise. The immediate feeling of this necessity is conviction [Overbeviisning], which can arise only in that we are immediately seized by it and feel it. The object of cognition presses itself upon us, and precisely as it is now cognized to be.

The true that is cognized thereby shows itself as that which exerts a determining and effective influence in us—an influence in which it expresses and presents itself, and thereby lives again, in us.

Remark and Supplement.

1. That all cognizing is a receiving and a beholding is soon taught, too, by a glance at the various domains of cognition. Not only what strikes the eye at once: that the *beginning* of all cognition—in the higher spheres just as much as in the lowest sensory one—is a direct becoming-aware and apprehending, a noticing and sensing. In its advance toward the highest completion, too, it remains an immediate taking and beholding. In the domain of lower sensation this is at once, at first glance, entirely obvious; for although here a certain combining and synthesizing activity must indeed be added to the apprehending

one—so that sensation comes about only by means of a reproducing construction—this construction too aims only at presenting the thing exactly as it is found and as it presents itself to us. We feel ourselves affected, and just as the affection brings it about, so sensation turns out: precisely as we are determined to it by this affection, so must we represent. And though a difference not seldom arises here between what seems to be and what is found to be in itself, still this latter too is found, and must precisely be cognized, only as it is found through a scrutiny—if not by sense, then by deliberating reflection.

As it here shows itself in the sphere of the senses and of the experience they occasion, so it stands with every higher cognizing of the understanding [Forstand] or of reason [Fornuft]—indeed, it is especially striking in the highest cognizing. Whatever is cognized without appeal to experience, by an insight springing from pure thinking—whether by force of mathematical demonstration or of a priori reflection or of philosophical speculation—is always cognized as something that is seen to have to be so, and a necessity of understanding or of reason, determining our whole representing, thereby enters: as this necessity declares it to be, so it must be cognized to be. But when, in this way, all reflection—all comparing, connecting, and inferring—aims at investigating or fathoming what must necessarily be assumed, as it will itself turn out to be, so that it is cognized as true only in being cognized as the one thing that can be assumed, then reflection aims at letting the thing *give* itself, by letting it be forced upon one through a necessity of thinking. It is cognized only in being discerned—that is, seen and beheld (with the higher eye of the spirit [Aand])—as it is in itself. The triangle I construct; but that its angles together equal two right angles I discern as necessary in accordance with the triangle's own nature, once given to me. Indeed, in the very act of constructing it, I do so in a certain determinate way and under certain conditions, and this manner of construction and these conditions I must take as they force themselves upon me. All sorts of human circumstances and relations I can think out for myself (though even here I must proceed according to certain given conditions and determinations); but what, in a given relation, is right or wrong, good or bad, the fundamental Idea [Grundidee] of the good and the right must teach me, so that by it I must let myself be guided in my judgment, and in every case let stand as right and good what, in accordance with that Idea, I see to be right and good. Mine it can only be to inquire into the essence [Væsen] of the right and the good, and then to cognize it as it presents itself to my spiritual eye. So that, even if the cognizing which goes beyond mere experience is called forth by questions—which, as inner spurs to seek more than the experienced, show that we do not rest content with what is given in experience alone—still the whole thinking thereby set in motion leads

only to a new receiving and apprehending of a higher order, under which we must again seek directly to observe and behold what presents itself to us.

But now, in the receiving and beholding in which all cognizing consists, we also become aware of a *principal distinction*. What we apprehend and come to know through the senses—indeed also what the ideal or intellectual becoming-aware and beholding, which enters already in this sphere by way of thinking, can teach us, when the inner ground-forms of the things revealed to the senses, their relations and their activities, are cognized exactly as they are directly found—all this is merely received, as something given to us from without in the reality that presents itself in time and space. This cognizing is the merely *empirical* kind; the necessity by which it enters, and by which it acquires the character of a cognizing, is only a necessity of the sort that proceeds from a certain *affection* bound to time and space—a wholly sensory affection of a lower nature. What is cognized in this way is still cognized only as *contingent*. It is given to us as the actual, and for us there is a necessity to take it so; but that it should itself necessarily be as it is, is not yet seen in this merely empirical cognizing.

Of a wholly different kind, by contrast, is mathematical and philosophical cognizing; here there is an intellectual beholding that has nothing of that stamp of contingency. What is here cognized is not merely taken as given, as though that were enough, but is apprehended and represented as something that is so because it must be so, in accordance with an inner *necessity of understanding and reason* of a wholly different origin than that by which certain sensory affections force themselves upon us. It is indeed given to us, but given from within—or at least given as something that accords with an inner demand, and not at all given to us by way of sensory affections. It is cognized as something that cannot be otherwise; it is cognized as *essential*, and therefore valid for all times and everywhere—which is why only in this sphere can one speak of eternal truths. We will call this cognizing the *intelligent* kind, both because this word seems more apt than the word “intellectual,” and because the latter can also cover the just-mentioned merely empirical—yet still ideal—cognizing, in which the inner ground-forms and relations of things are apprehended entirely as they are directly found in experience.

2. Necessity enters when truth shows itself in relation to (refers itself to) *the individuality* that takes it up; and in the feeling of conviction, the life and working of the true in the individual is met by something purely individual, in which a person shows himself and comes forward as such, in that he attaches himself wholly to, and gives himself over to, that working. In pure receiving and beholding, the true was as yet seen only as presenting itself, so that only its own (universal) appearance showed

itself therein—no personal life. The reception was merely like a reflection or mirroring, like that by which water gives back light and color—not a personal taking-up, like that by which the gemstone has, in its color, taken a power and effect of light into itself, into unity with its own nature and existence. But in conviction it becomes an inward appropriation, whereby the true that presents itself in and for an individuality now also comes to dwell powerfully in this individuality, as in a being in which it has taken its seat, and which itself now is and becomes something through the reception. In this binding-together of the true and the individual into unity, the necessity that is indeed present is so lost that it is not particularly felt or brought into view. Here there is an *undivided* free life in the true, raised above the feeling of necessity. Only when the individual, tearing itself loose from the universal, moves in a particular personal striving does the opposition—and with it that same necessity—come to light.

3. In conviction, a personal *affection* and emotion, *πάθος*, is added to the reception—with a personal attachment and devotion to the power of truth—so that the individual not only lets truth gain room and power within him, but does so with delight, feeling that in this he possesses something and that his personal life is thereby expanded and heightened. The devotion now shows itself as *love*. This brings it about that, together with the power of the true, personality and freedom too come fully forward; for in love an independent being goes willingly and gladly to meet the true. Whereby the endeavor to cognize shows itself as a cultus or *worship* of truth. The inquirer's [Gransker] relation to truth and to his science [Videnskab] now becomes a *religious* relation—in the not ordinary, but literal and far-reaching sense in which the word denotes a relation, bound by sacred ties, to something holy, in whose power we feel ourselves, with willing devotion, to be. (Indeed, in the word's more ordinary and proper sense too the relation can show itself as religious; for just as a human being can and should do all that he does with God in view and out of love for God—so that this highest motive can and should be the everywhere-operative one—so too not only can that same motive, as such, embrace the scientific endeavor as well, but everything can and should in the end be cognized and beheld in its relation to the highest divine in such a way that the Idea of God becomes, scientifically, the all-illuminating, just as, practically, the all-animating. So that in the end every relation to truth shows itself directly as a relation to God. But in this we look toward an ideal that the scientific culture [Videnskabelighed] of humanity is still far from having approached.) With reverence for the voice of truth, and a heartfelt desire to bring it—and it alone—to speak and live in his inquiry, the votary of science must give himself over to being its organ, its servant and herald, who wills only what it wills.

His personality must be as a holy temple for it. But at the same time the speaking and living of the true within him must be felt and held fast as his own innermost and best life, and the relation must show itself as a true relation of love. What has sometimes been said—that a person is consecrated to his science and his art—we may recall here. To be kindled by truth, and then to take it up and faithfully preserve and tend it within us, until it grows and develops of itself and takes shape in us, so that it may truly come to fulfillment in us—this is ours. Let love of truth [Sandhedskjerlighed] be, like all genuine love, careful and conscientious.

Truth thereby shows itself as that which, *by its own might and power*, seeks to take shape in the individual, while the individual gives himself over entirely to letting it work in him whatever it will. And just as this holds of everything that, in any science or body of knowledge, shows itself as the true whose cognition study aims at, so everything set forth here holds of every scientific endeavor—even of one that still stands so far from the higher Ideas that it only rarely feels itself inspired by them. In *every* study, faithful devotion to the cognition that forms itself in us will bring the fullness that love gives. If, in the lower domains of inquiry, what we cognize seems not to bring us nearer to the eternal, still the fact that it produces complete cognition and living conviction in us will make us feel as though filled by a divinity. (Just as, even in the lowest spheres, cognition in itself really does come from the higher source, even if it does not come to consciousness as such. See § 11, Remark 2, below.) So that every study in which faithful and clear inquiry prevails has its *Muse*. In it the individual stands over against something he would make his own, needing it as something without which he himself cannot come to full life. But what he would thus make his own is not something he can treat as an object for the satisfaction of a sensory need—to consume, or to take as a mere vehicle or means. It always remains standing over against the individual as something that subsists in and for itself in its significance and worth, whether or not it comes to the individual—indeed, as something that has worth for the individual precisely only insofar as it has worth and significance (that is, in this case, has truth) in and for itself. And thus, everywhere that truth is sought, in whatever sphere, the relation between the individual and the true he seeks is such a relation of attachment as can—and, under a genuine striving, also will—become a relation of love.

We now also see here what it is to *inquire*, to *fathom*, to *reflect*—or, as one less felicitously puts it, to carry out reflection, investigation, consideration upon something. Namely, that it can be nothing other than, under this or that arrangement and handling of certain representations, to try to bring it about that the truth we desire to know may

come, of itself, by its own might and influence, to present itself to us—so that we now directly become aware of it or, as one says, find it out.

We must therefore also *immerse* ourselves in every study. Only thereby does it become genuine and powerful. If the true that produces cognition in us is to gain us into its power, so that it may form and shape itself in us, then we must forget everything else over it and, as it were, lose ourselves in it. Even the sensory forms of things are only then observed and apprehended fully in their distinctiveness and manifoldness when attention is thereby wholly captivated, as though we were entirely absorbed in the contemplation, or lost in it; for only then does the living *nisus formativus* that here enters—under which the true would take shape in us—work whole and undivided in its full strength. A book is best studied and works most fully when, for a time, it so captivates us and, as it were, takes our whole mind into possession, that we are wholly immersed in it. In this way—that is, with this vigorous attention and devotion—should every *classical* work be studied.

But only *classical works*, too, deserve and can be wholly studied thus. For a scientific work is classical not by the collection of items of knowledge it may contain, and which can now be drawn and learned from it piece by piece, but by its spirit as a whole, its inner genius, which speaks out of it in its totality, and by the total form that accompanies this—the way in which everything in it is presented and composed and, as it were, grown together into unity, so that everywhere in the work we meet the same vigorous and profound spirit, and all the manifold in it is as though of one piece. Such a work stands, by its spirit and by its form, valid and significant for all times, which the word “classical” especially seems to indicate; for it works not merely by a manifold of material that can be transplanted and reworked, but works as a whole by its distinctive original stamp, whereby spirit speaks to spirit. But then this spirit too must work in its totality and, as it were, enter into the reader or beholder—and it does so all the more, the more he immerses himself in the contemplation, so that he treats the work not merely as a means to the acquisition of knowledge, but as a work that has full worth by and in itself alone, and therefore also works toward the very formation [Dannelse] (*Bildung*) of the spirit as a whole.

We must read in such a way that we enter into a *harmonious relation of reciprocal action* with what we read, and are so set in motion that, through the words and sentences, we come to feel ourselves addressed by the general spiritual element in the work, which constitutes the inner source and first mover (*primus motor*) of the words and sentences—the soul that lives and speaks in them. Only such reading is a truly soulful reading.

The study of a work thus becomes an inner communion with a glorious spirit, which in several respects can have a beneficial influence on us and advance us in our whole striving. It becomes, throughout, all the more genuine nourishment for us the more it is a *disinterested* study; for the more we inquire and probe not for the sake of this or that particular aim, but solely out of pure love of truth, in order to take it up entirely into ourselves, the more it will work in us with its full power. The more our devotion is undivided, free, and wholehearted, the more easily and fully can the total immersion, or being-gripped, come about. For a time, then, we let the work carry us away, and let it do with us, and make of us, what it will. Thereupon truth's own power itself begins to speak in us and to bear witness to what is expressed in the work; whereby an immersion in our own immediate contemplation of the intrinsically true is added to the immersion in the work's utterance, and now determines what the work is to make of us.

In general, the spirit that lives and addresses us in a work can, of course, come to carry us away and captivate us, and become for us a source of new effects and formations of life within us, only in that it comes from truth itself—indeed, from that which can present itself immediately to every inquirer, enter into everyone, and in everyone bear witness to itself. Only in that we find the same thing again in ourselves, so that we sympathize with it, can what is handed down to us speak to us through the forms of transmission in which it is imparted. (This holds even of the study of the works of nature; nature too is a book that must be studied like any other book, but in which a spirit akin to us also speaks to us: the same truth that bears witness to itself within us as well. Yet this will only become fully evident in what follows. See § 7, in the Remark.) To grasp, cognize, and enjoy a work handed down to us we come, in the proper sense of the word, only in that it *reproduces itself in us*, and we, in the course of this its reproduction, are moved and enlivened by the spirit which—just as it now lives again in us—first lived in the activity by which the work came into being. But by this we are led directly to the next principal consideration, as we take into closer examination this reproduction, which shows itself as one whereby we ourselves are productive.

§. 2.

All cognizing comes to actuality and subsistence by means of a determining, a doing, a producing—and only by means of such; so that the latter is essentially bound up with the former. *We cognize only insofar as we produce. (Scimus, qvia facimus.)*

Cognition takes place when the true shows itself as such to a personality and is taken up by it. But a personality must reveal itself in a personal life. Now a life cannot be

conceived without a Something, a real [Reale], in which it expresses itself in uninterrupted activity, continually forming and determining this real, or outward, of its own; it gives itself a definite shape in giving this a definite shape. Personality, on the other hand, shows itself in finding and positing itself as the immediate center of its own existence [Tilvær], and in having this existence as its own. A personal life, then, must express itself in an activity and productivity in which the personal being finds and moves itself as the producing agent. If, then, the true is to be taken up into the personality, it too must be embraced by this personal productivity. The individual can therefore cognize only in that it itself works and produces a real—a (psychic) outward—corresponding to the cognition, in which it holds the cognition fast by determining and developing this outward.

Consciousness is the personality's first expression. In it is taken up everything that is to be taken up into the personality. Thus we too can cognize only by becoming conscious of what is to be cognized. But this, according to the fundamental nature of consciousness, we can do only by presenting it to ourselves, or representing it to ourselves [forestille] (objectifying it for ourselves). But this presenting or representing is our own act of fixing, whereby we posit (or *ponere*) the given and received before us and, as it were, make ourselves an inner image of it, in which we express it for ourselves and hold it fast. In this representing consists, here, that productivity. The representation [Forestilling] is our own product and, as an expression of our own life which we keep as ours, cannot be anything else. But only in this constant representing, and under its constant determination, development, and completion, do we come to cognize, and do we have what we cognize.

The possession of cognition therefore also shows itself as an *ability*, a *capacity*. We know only (sufficiently and fully) what we are able to bring forth in one form or another and thereby give to others. This productivity of ours, by which the received is now embraced, is also in itself a free one, which can arbitrarily present something other than the true. In cognition, however, this free element is bound and determined to a single way of representing, by the necessity that accompanies cognition and now comes forward in this respect too.

Remark and Supplement.

1. Here we see the essential connection of *language and speech* with cognition. All cognizing that does not aim at immediate or reproduced sense-intuitions, or at constructions carried out directly in time and space in the same way as these (such as, for example, the mathematical ones), takes place by means of a constant judging, which in turn takes

place through an inner speaking, by means of words (or possibly other signs), and cannot come about in any other way. But that this is so—which experience teaches directly as a fact—also shows how immediately a positing, determining, and producing activity is added to our apprehending and receiving. In word and speech we set what is cognized before us, thereby binding it and taking possession of it, making it something of our own, which we now, in our own way—in our designating and naming—hold fast (cf. Hegel's *Encyklopädie*, § 379 and the following §§).

2. Yet not only by words: in all representing generally we do the same. The preservation of representations after the immediate beholding is past, as well as everything we can do with them, testifies to this generally. The productivity essentially belonging to all cognizing also soon shows itself, to the observing eye, in every one of cognition's domains. As for simple *lower sensation*, we refer to the psychological observations that lead directly to the insight that spatial forms and relations, as well as temporal determinations and the qualities ascribed to things in respect of these, are cognized only by means of a reproducing construction of the objects that present themselves—observations which, already merely as such, lead to conclusions that justify assuming the same as regards the merely visible, audible, and other merely sensory qualities. (See the author's *Psychologie*, § 55.) How *thinking* takes place, and the cognizing springing from it comes about, by means of a constant determining, positing, and constructing, the logical investigations teach throughout and everywhere. Whether concrete objects are conceived and their nature thereby cognized by force of concepts [Begraber], or concepts themselves are regarded as the objects to be cognized, in either case construction takes place. For the former happens only when a connection is discerned; but this connection is seen only when the manifold whose connection it is is set apart from one another and then joined again into a whole, by means of a reproducing construction or a genetic procedure, under which we let the thing arise before us—that is, ourselves form it for us in an image—and now also see everything in its place, in that we see the necessity of setting it thus into the whole. Connection, and the real significance of objects within a certain coherent whole, can be cognized only by projecting and completing the intuition [Anskuelse] corresponding to it; to cognize it is to produce, or at least to be able to produce, its concrete expression. The concepts themselves, next—which are thereby abstracted, as the connections thus beheld in things and the ground-forms and real meanings thereby determined, or as the fundamental thoughts expressing themselves in things themselves—are cognized only when they are lifted out on their own, by cognizing their so-called content: that is, the sum of determinations that, according to the concepts,

must be found in the object and can be asserted of it as predicates. Whereby the judging mentioned above enters, as a determining, a fixing, and a pronouncing. Deductions of concepts—whereby the fundamental thought that determines the concept's whole validity and content is derived, or seen in its origin from a higher cognition—take place, like inferences and proofs, through trains of thought in which thoughts are linked to thoughts by determinations, whereby a whole of thought is developed. The deduction of concepts takes place only through a construction of the scientific whole, in which the concept now shows itself as an essential member; and proofs likewise come about only through combinations. An Idea [Idee], finally, is likewise cognized only in that it is either beheld as the expression of a higher Idea—in which respect, on the side of form, it shows itself as a concept—or else beheld as the essence, the determining being, and moreover as the real principle, giving essentiality and existence, in real objects and ground-forms; which objects and ground-forms are then not only, like all others, cognized solely by means of constructions, but can also be seen as the expression of the Idea only in being seen as those which through it become what they are—something that can be seen only under a reproducing, genetic presentation.

§. 3.

Reception and production, beholding and one's own determining and doing, here become entirely one, so that cognition, precisely in entering under the one form, essentially also takes on the other. (*Scientia et potentia in idem coincidunt.*)

In cognition, the production and presentation is not arbitrary but one determined with necessity, and what determines it is precisely our receiving and beholding, and the true that presents itself in and for it. As thereby the whole manner and character of the representation [Foretelling] is determined, the true expresses itself—but through our productivity, which it governs and determines, and in our product, which now nonetheless becomes the expression of that true, and, as it were, becomes the material in which the true realizes and individualizes itself in us, while at the same time our own life too realizes and substantializes itself therein. We are determined in beholding, but determined to produce something ourselves—namely, to form representations that become ours, yet such that we produce them precisely so as to correspond to our having-been-determined. And thus we are determining and determined in one. What is given to us or presents itself to us comes to clarity in us—indeed, comes to be ours at all—only in what we ourselves do. And yet here too cognition takes place only by means of a constant receiving and beholding; for that by which we are determined we have only in this its

determining influence, and the representation likewise, as necessary in accordance with that having-been-determined, takes on the same character. *We produce as we see that we must produce.*

The personality, insofar as it finds itself as a consciousness and self-determination—or we, who call ourselves “we”—find ourselves here between *two regions*. On the one side, the influence by which we are determined, and to which we turn and look as we receive and are determined; on the other side, our sphere of representations, which we ourselves work over and make into what it becomes, in that we seek therein to hold fast the received and make it our own. The former, as determining, above us, before us; as that which is to be expressed and to come to shape in us—the more inward and active, that by which we are governed. The latter, as our product, below us; as that in which we express our life—the more outward, the psychic material of our life, by its nature an object of our governing. Here there is always, on the one side, something that is obtained and possessed merely through the mastery it exercises in us, or the determining influence it has on our working and determining; on the other side, something that is merely expression, presentation, or result, which is had and kept only through a capacity or skill to reproduce it.

This latter may now remain behind as merely bare, lifeless material, like a residuum of the activity—as something now merely had and assumed because it was once assumed, a *standing result*, without its being any longer enlivened by the living activity by which it was *formed*. But it should not be mechanized or crystallize itself in this way; rather, it should be kept constantly ready, in the course of life’s advance, to enter again under the living influence of that determining First, and, under a constantly living and organic rebirth, to receive transformations and new shapes. Only then is the relation preserved as it is in itself and therefore also ought to be. As the influences from above, from within, from that which is before us, direct and command, so ought we to work in our lower and outer sphere.

Remark and Supplement.

1. In all cognizing by means of thinking (concept and Idea) this opposition and doubleness is clear. Concepts, as such, are had and held fast only either by means of the constructions whose norms they are, or by means of the judgments by which their so-called content is determined. But the norm, or determining fundamental thought, of a construction indeed enters and comes forward in it as governing and ruling, yet is not itself constructed; it is therefore had only in the living activity that proceeds from it. In judgments a concept is expressed, in that its content is determined; but since this content is a sum of

determinations ascribed not to the concept itself but to its objects—yet in accordance with the concept—the concept here too is had only as the determining fundamental thought of a doing and determining, and is not embraced by it, but hovers over it, or constitutes the inner first moving ruler within it, its inner *primus motor*. Which holds still more of every Idea. The concept can, to be sure, in turn be regarded as an object that is itself determined; but this can then happen only in accordance with another concept, which then constitutes the ruling fundamental thought in the determinations. Such ruling fundamental thoughts or concepts, which are had only in what is posited and carried out by force of them, also underlie all inferences. In lower sensation, too, a determining first enters into opposition to the representation thereby determined. In striving to see and hear rightly and precisely, and to obtain a complete representation of the object in which it can show itself in its full distinctiveness, then—precisely because the need for one’s own doing now comes forward—that which is to be beheld will also show itself as that toward which one must constantly look: that is, as that by which that doing is governed and mastered, and which is obtained only by developing, in accordance with its own determining influence, a complete image of it.

2. The apprehending and cognizing individuality here shows itself as one which, just as in its representations it forms a material in which it expresses its cognizing and life, so too is itself formed into being that in which truth expresses itself—quite as if the individuality were itself, in turn, the substrate or material of the self-presenting truth, in which the latter seeks to come to appearance and to take shape (cf. § 4, Remark 3). *Thereby we grow*, on the one side, *into that* whole in which a universal life expresses and realizes itself, in that we are embraced, filled, and made alive by it as members or organs; while on the other side a whole also grows and develops in us, in which we ourselves realize ourselves as personal beings subsisting for ourselves. We are ourselves assimilated by that more general life, in the very act of seeking to assimilate to ourselves the true that presents itself to us, by assimilating to ourselves its expression within us.

I refer here to the ingenious Franz Baader’s treatise in Schelling and Markus’s *Jahrbücher der Medicin*, third volume, first part, as well as to several of his shorter philosophical-biological writings.

§. 4.

In simple, pure, wholly immediate beholding, productivity is *bound* and *lost*, or is so absorbed therein that it does not come into view on its own, or come to consciousness, and stir according to its particular nature—just as neither is the influence, with its

determining and compelling power, felt and brought to consciousness as such. The opposition between the cognized true and the individuality in and for which it comes forward does not here show itself as an opposition. This cognizing is also, as regards the manner of cognizing, the most perfect; for the fact that the production comes entirely of itself proves that truth works with complete power, and that it is also taken up fully.

But in a striving to cognize quite fully what presents itself immediately in this beholding, and at the same time to cognize still other and more—because what is thus cognized points to other and more—the *object of cognition and the cognizing personality*, which in pure beholding were undivided, step, by means of a reflection, *apart from one another* and against one another. Productivity becomes unbound and shows itself as free, while the determining influence, on the other side, shows itself as such, with its necessity. The individual finds itself as one that must itself work, by way of deliberation and thinking, to reach the desired cognition; and just for that reason productivity must show itself as a free one, capable of presenting something other than what is found. But now, therefore, the attachment too will be embraced by self-determination and will occur in accordance with a willing. Truth now shows itself as an object that we can come to possess only gradually, by effort, through a free activity that must accord with truth's declarations—to which we must now attend closely, as they gradually sound to us in the course of our inquiry. Whereby productivity, while showing itself as free, is bound and mastered anew, so that it presents only in the one true way—yet in such a way that it now occurs with self-determination, and as one that could act otherwise, and therefore also by way of deliberation, and such that a free choice is possible. But pure, wholly immediate beholding—through a new, complete self-loss of the productivity that has come to clarity and self-consciousness—is nonetheless that toward which one strives, so that truth in its full fullness may enter into the cognizing personality.

Remark and Supplement.

1. The productivity that has become free can now also *express itself in its own* productions, independent of the given. But even therein it will always be determined—since it must take place in definite ways—by certain norms or concepts, which of themselves govern within it and are had directly in and through the power with which they determine the self-activity. And if these productions are to be more than a play with representations, then this freer productivity—although its products are now not to be mere images of what is found, but its own creations—must nonetheless, in the same way as in the endeavor to cognize, be bound and mastered anew by a higher cognition, under which the true shows itself to us in new forms and takes shape in us. So it is in mathematics and in art.

In general, life comes forth just as fully in action and self-activity as in a striving to cognize. In the former, free forth-working prevails, but also a certain cognition, which underlies it as governing and moving First. But here too the two opposites can, in the same way, be lost or merge into one, as in mere beholding, so that neither is the self-activity particularly felt as free, nor does the fundamental thought guiding it come to consciousness as such, since the action happens entirely of itself: a self-activity that, as regards its manner of working, is the most perfect—since therein the true and the being, the essentiality that is to take shape in us in our acting too, shows itself as that which works with complete, undivided, and unarrested power.

2. So far as the free productivity comes to consciousness as such, cognition's determining First too comes to consciousness as such; and vice versa. In a free working at cognizing, as in an acting undertaken with self-conscious self-determination, there can therefore, while *something* comes particularly *into view*, be *something else* deeper or more inward which, with its determining influence, is lost or merges into the cognition or the self-activity—in which respect the productivity, in another respect become free, does not show itself as free. But a reflection can then afterward, in a striving for deeper cognition, draw forth what was thus present hitherto but was lost in the whole. —Thus, for example, the principle of causality may at one time underlie, as a determining fundamental thought, a striving to fathom certain phenomena, without this principle being thought of; at another time reflection is turned upon it; and the standpoint at which the cognizing striving stands in the former case is quite other than in the latter.

3. But why does the true, full essence of things not show itself at once to the individual striving after cognition in such a way that all cognizing becomes a pure, immediate beholding? It is natural that this question should arise here. But its complete answer would require a general reflection on the ground of there being a time and a temporality at all, and of life's coming forth at all in a becoming [Vorden], under which it only gradually attains a definite subsistence—something for whose full elucidation a fathoming of the innermost meaning and essence of all human existence [Tilvær] would be needed. —Only the first basic features of such a consideration can find place here.

In the finite world the eternal and divine is to come forth, rule, and hold sway, so as therein to reveal its infinite power and fullness: this is the meaning of everything finite—that it is to be *the Other* than the eternal, in which the eternal is to come forth and reveal itself. But only in a consciousness and spiritual life does the eternal and divine reveal itself *as such*—in that the being in which it lives comes to know of it, and moreover not only to bear it within itself and be moved by it, but also itself to be able

to behold and have it as what it in its truth is. But the kingdom that is thus to come to the human being is to be a *kingdom of love*; for only in such a one does the true fullness of the eternal come to show itself, and to show itself in its pure spirituality, uniting a community of beings who are themselves spirits into a whole that can now in truth be called the kingdom of God: the kingdom in which God himself reveals himself in his divinity, in that he reveals himself in eternal love. But a kingdom of spirit and love *necessarily* presupposes—and therefore necessarily calls forth—as the other in which it is to be the ruling element, *an intelligence and freedom*. If, on the part of the beings to whom this kingdom is to come, a free and fully conscious devotion did not come to take place—namely, a devotion of one's own mind, one's own desire and impulse—then it would not be a kingdom of love that came forth. But a personal life that is to be a free one—which now, out of pure love and moreover with clear consciousness, is to give itself over to being enlivened and filled by the divinity, and to move only in God—must itself make itself into such a free life, in coming to clarity about the true meaning and essence of its own existence, and likewise of the whole of existence. But then the opposition must come forth fully, so that the reconciliation may become the true reconciliation and unity in love and freedom. But if consciousness is thus to come to self-consciousness and intelligence, telling itself what it is—if the personality is to come to freedom under a self-determination in which it takes itself as such and makes itself free—then it must come to a productivity in and under which it objectifies itself for itself. It must come to express itself in a sphere (that lower region mentioned above), which is its own, which it forms for itself, and in which it becomes conscious of itself and of its freedom in a free productivity. And thus life descends into a time and a temporality.

The personal being can, to be sure, no more make itself free (although we came to use this expression) than it can give itself truth. It finds itself free as regards possibility, but to have and enjoy freedom in deed (*actu*) it comes only through the liberating power of truth and love. But now it cannot be liberated either, except *in and through its own self-determination*—and that a self-determination which it itself wills and feels as its own. That which brings and gives the individual all reality, essentiality, and fullness can, since it is a kingdom of love that is to form itself, give it the fullness only by referring itself to *something* that must now *follow* in the individual itself, as the individual's own self-determining: namely, its own self-surrender and the acting that follows from it. The decision (that in which the whole working concludes or ends) must always be the individual's own. Therefore, too—so that we may still note this—the inner effects, in which the life that is to come to reality operates or presses forward into consciousness,

have the character of incitement and summons: namely, a summons to seek what the individual can obtain only when it desires and craves and seeks it, but which it can doubtless likewise obtain only in that it is given to it outright. But of this again further on; see §§ 19–21. In order that freedom may fully come to consciousness, and a complete self-consciousness may set in—yet so that this self-consciousness also clearly beholds what it is to strive to make itself into, so that now spirit and truth may be had in spirit and truth—for this reason the latter opens itself to the individual only gradually, under the individual's own striving, inquiry, and labor.

§. 5.

Insofar as the opposition between the object of cognition and the cognizing personality comes forward in such a way that productivity, or representation, shows itself as free—yet is now brought, by an incoming self-determination, to present in one single way—cognition becomes a cognizing by force of grounds [Grunde].

All cognizing is to be such a *cognizing by force of grounds*.

For all cognizing is to come to complete clarity in and for the cognizing personality and consciousness. But if it is to do so, then the productivity required for it, and lying within it, must also come to clear consciousness; and this it can do only in being carried out or undertaken by the individual with self-consciousness and self-determination. Thereby it shows itself as free; but if it is then, as that by which a cognition is to come about, bound to a single determinate presenting, it must be bound to it in accordance with a certain corresponding determining Something which, when it comes to consciousness as such, shows itself as a ground.

Cognition now comes about as the result of an investigation and a deliberation. Reflection and consideration call forth a *study* that steps in between a first immediate receiving and a final or concluding cognition. The mind, which at first opened itself merely to receive and gave itself over purely to contemplation and reception, is now set in motion in such a way that it is itself, by its own self-conscious labor, to bring about the production in which it is to possess truth; and it now seeks, by inquiry and grounding, a principle or first mover for this production of its own. But the cognition that thereby enters is nonetheless, when it now comes about, and as it now turns out, a new receiving and beholding; for in the end we assume what, in accordance with the determining grounds, we see that we must assume. This cognizing by force of grounds is also to be a passage to a complete beholding, in which the full power of truth works immediately and undividedly. But for the free personality, which is to come to complete freedom and self-clarity, it shows itself as a necessary passage.

Remark and Supplement.

1. The ground may, for that matter, well be merely a necessity accompanying pure immediate apprehension and beholding, so that cognition takes place as one that grounds itself; but the question of a ground has now been set in motion, and even if what is assumed is assumed merely because it is immediately certain by itself, this very immediate certainty [Vished] now shows itself as a ground, and cognition now takes on a different character than it had before, when this reflection had not yet entered.

This is especially to be remembered of the mathematical axioms. Sense-intuition, too, no doubt presents itself as immediately grounding itself, and may also remain with this stamp. But even then our representing is not seldom led to find itself as a free reproducing—especially if the sensory shape is so manifold, or the relations of its parts so intricate, that it can come to clarity only by deliberation and consideration; and then what leads to fixing the representation will also come, in opposition to the representation itself, to show itself as its ground. This happens still more when it is noticed that things often cannot, or should not, be represented as being just as the impression would immediately suggest. But once such so-called sense-deceptions have shown themselves as possible, doubt can now arise about the correctness of every immediate, self-forming sense-representation, so that, even if it is directly assumed, this now happens no longer merely on account of its own immediacy, but also on account of a cognition that no so-called sense-deception is present—and the consideration that teaches this now enters as a ground. Indeed, in the advance of the endeavor and of cognition, the whole of sense-intuition finally shows itself (to the philosophical eye) as one whose truth and validity can be doubted at all, and must, moreover, first be warranted and established. And thus the representing that at first formed itself entirely of itself, and seemed reliable enough in itself, will show itself as still needing grounding—in general and in each and every respect.

The intrinsically certain, from which this grounding is to proceed, or by which all other cognition is to be warranted, is now sought on a wholly different side, and cognition rises to a highest Idea, by force of which all else is now to be beheld in its true and full light, in its meaning and truth. But even if this highest Idea is, so far, immediate and resting in itself, we still come to it only by a thinking that must, of course, throughout be guided and determined by grounds—just as the very fact that all else can be clarified by that highest Idea may be the ground on which its cognition rests. And thus we find, at the highest point just as well, a cognizing by force of grounds, as we found the lowest to be in need of grounding; and this because all cognizing comes to actuality only

through a being-determined to a certain representing, a being-determined that, in the advance of the endeavor, must come to consciousness as such. Everywhere the question is asked why we let ourselves be thus determined, by what right this determining power is exercised over us.

2. The perfect cognizing would be one that, independent of all deliberation and grounding with all their unrest and striving movement, would rest wholly in itself alone and be immediately clear and certain in itself, without any question of its grounds arising, or any thought that something other than just what is beheld could be the true. But such certainty and security—a cognition come to rest and fullness in such a beholding—can rest only in the certainty of, indeed in the pure immediate sense or feeling of, the fact that what is thus beheld comes to us directly from the source of truth, is given and told to us by him from whom all truth, like every good and perfect gift, comes. This is the beholding that has been meant by the expression: to behold all things in God. It is the cognizing by which we are to cognize even as we ourselves are cognized—to know what we know because the spirit speaks it thus in us and gives it to us. Then truth no longer stands over against us as the thing we seek; rather, it dwells in us, in that the same that gives all things their essentiality now also gives us cognition—pure, immediate, absolute, or in and for itself, without its passing through any deliberation and reflection and emerging as the result of such. A consciousness and assurance that everything we cognize is given us by God—that our words are not ours, but, as we find them in us, are worked in us by the divine spirit—can alone be that in which this cognition can rest. Christ's cognizing we can conceive only in this way, never as a cognizing by way of reflection and inference.

As a highest goal, as an ideal, such a cognition stands before us. Yet this highest beholding cannot even be regarded as the goal that mere inquiry and grounding, once it reached its completion, could attain. A completed thinking can lead to a completed cognition by way of thinking—to a completed, wholly certain, clear, and self-reposing knowledge according to, and by force of, the highest grounds. But that highest beholding's pure immediacy can be reached only in that the highest true—the eternal source of truth, the spirit—becomes living in us and enlivens us in a wholly different (a differently real) way than the way in which truth, as highest Idea, animates and enlivens a thinking and a grounding.

For the forward-striving human being, however, *the way of thinking* is the one along which he is to advance, in order to press more and more toward the full cognition of truth. It is a more earthly way, on which one attains piece by piece. It belongs to the

sphere in which, within a finitude, under its own striving, a personality is to develop and be raised more and more to clarity and independence—in a life in which it more and more objectifies itself for itself and establishes itself in an existence of its own, yet only in order to ripen to the point where the spirit can now, in its fullness, enter into it as into an individuality now fully developed as its organ. Whereby then, when this point is reached, fullness will enter in place of the piecework; and now thinking—which surely is not to cease—and the fathoming of things—which is not to fall away—will themselves be illuminated by the higher light, enter into the higher peace, and, while an infinite fullness stands before them for contemplation and fathoming, will nonetheless themselves walk the secure course that no longer has constantly to ask itself about the grounds why it assumes what it beholds, why it cognizes what it finds in its grounding, but has in this respect cast out “every witness of human neediness.”

Until it comes to that, all cognition is burdened with *uncertainty*. The immediately given, which is directly beheld, cannot satisfy us, because it is not the true essence on whose cognition everything depends, and because we have of this true essence a fundamental consciousness that drives us to seek something other than what is directly beheld. It itself now points us to something else and higher; but this else and higher we come to only precisely by being thus shown and led to it—that is, in a mediated way—and this mediateness remains, so long as our cognizing is a cognizing by way of thinking, always attached to it for us.

But what can here already lift us above this mediateness is the firm *conviction* [Overbeviisning], forming itself, of its reality. This springs up in the course of our inquiry and grounding, as we are seized by the truth of what is cognized, feel ourselves carried away by it. In the course of our comparing and relating, deliberating and considering, it lifts itself more and more forward and becomes—in the subjective, individual, and personal respect (what concept and insight are in the objective respect)—the moving soul of all thinking and determining, from which it proceeds and to which it finally returns. And thus a *faith* [Tro]—overcoming and dissolving all deficiency in insight and in the developments and fixings of thinking—namely, a *faith in the reality of the fundamental cognition* [Grunderkjendelse]—takes for us the place of that perfect cognition. As faith it is—though awakened and nourished by a grounding, and constantly giving birth to a closer deliberation and grounding of itself—nonetheless not a cognizing by, and by force of, the development of grounds alone, but a more immediate appearance of the power of truth, which, bearing witness to itself, seizes and irresistibly compels to cognition—yet not because there is immediate beholding, but because everything so points and presses

us to this cognition that it shows itself as the center on which everything depends and in which everything rests, and without which we cannot subsist or manage at all. As our life in general, so too our life in cognition must seek its last support and rest in an infinite trust and confidence, and, as the life of a finite being, can in the end rest in nothing else. Yet that here too, as everywhere, divine grace is in the end the one thing on which everything depends and in which everything rests—this we shall come to set before ourselves more closely in what follows. But because we receive only by grace, that too is why we can have only by faith. Everything is in the end given, and must be taken as it is given, in faith toward the Giver. But precisely that which makes cognition not become a total beholding now also opens for this infinite trust the room in which it can show itself as infinite trust—so that the very fact that we do not have the fullness brings it about that attachment, devotion, and love come all the more into view.

And that, then, is what all the life in us aims at, and moreover also all the life that labors to reach a perfect cognition: that we, the more we exert ourselves to have something of our own and to possess something in ourselves, should the more come to feel that we can do nothing and have nothing except what is directly and outright given us; and that, the more we rise in independence and intelligence and command—as regards the manifold and its relative determination—the more we should recognize that, in respect of the One thing that is needful and on which everything depends, we must give ourselves entirely into God’s keeping, who alone works in us both to cognize and to carry out.

3. But it is only of the fundamental cognition (that on which everything depends, and which so far is the One thing needful) that this holds—that it rests, in the end, in a faith and trust. Everything else, which is illuminated by this fundamental cognition and is to be determined in accordance with it, must be beheld as given with it—all in its connection therewith and its consequence therefrom. So that, even if on the one side a faith and trust becomes that in which all conviction rests and cannot but rest, cognition is nonetheless not on that account to cease, on the other side, being a cognition by force of grounds, and of an *insight* arisen through the cognition of grounds. And just as everything cognized in accordance with the fundamental cognition must be cognized so, because we clearly see that the fundamental cognition necessarily entails it, and can follow the whole connection from the single point under consideration up to the highest, so too the fundamental cognition itself must precisely be clearly seen as that which bears the whole connection, and to which this connection necessarily leads. Under which the course will be this: that what was perhaps at first cognized by a certain feeling of

truth—indeed, by a relation to the subjectively human—comes more and more to be evident to thinking in and for itself and in an objective way, until at last a point will be reached where the highest, to which all else points, is evident not merely because it is clearly seen that all else points to it, but because it seems immediately *evident in itself alone*. But this consideration—in which we meet the profound thought underlying the famous so-called ontological proof of God’s existence—leads us over to our next principal proposition. —God bears witness to himself in consciousnesses, and no cognition that God is would be possible if God did not thus bear witness to himself within us, that is, in our gradually forming spiritual life, beholding, and contemplation; indeed, this fundamental consciousness of God (and of one’s own innermost communion with God) is what first makes the human being human. Herein, then, is immediate faith. But should not the same cognition also be able to become just as immediately evident for speculation, so that this evidence too, as evidence, rested only in itself? By which, however—since this evidence too would then have to be given to us, in that it was evident precisely by itself—faith would not cease to be that in which all cognition would in the end rest. Insight and self-evidence, or evidence, are themselves *worked* in us as well; but where there is question of a life working itself forward in consciousness in a real way, and what comes forth is seen as this life’s inner operations, there is grace and governance—and there, moreover, faith, attachment, and trust must show themselves. The purely intelligent is itself something that likewise comes only through real influences from above, and must therefore be received as a gift—and that with trust toward the Giver. In the cognizing that we conceive as Christ’s cognizing, an immediate self-evidence becomes one with the assurance that trust gives; it is faith and beholding in one.

§. 6.

Insofar as inquiry [Granskning] aims at a cognizing by force of grounds, it strives not merely to cognize the true, but also to cognize it as the true and in accordance with its truth. All cognizing is to be such a cognition of truth in *its truth*. Only then is it genuine and complete. It is the endeavor to cognize thus that sets the whole search after grounds in motion; it is what really expresses itself in that search.

In the first immediate apprehension and beholding, we receive what presents itself to us immediately and let that suffice. Of its validity there is as yet no question; even if it is the true that has therein shown itself to us, it has still not stepped forth as the true; it is not yet that for us. (Which is why Plato, too, in the *Theaetetus*, seeks a quite different definition of cognition than that it should be correct representation.) But if

truth is to come to us fully and take shape in us, it must give itself to us by itself, in that it becomes evident to us by its truth; only then do we behold and have it as it is in itself. Only thereby does true cognizing set in—which is not merely a taking-up and beholding, but a taking-up with assurance. But this already happens, though not fully and in the highest degree, insofar as cognition becomes a cognizing by force of sufficient grounds, and as far as this reaches; for so far and so long we assume what we assume because, in accordance with these grounds, it is evident to us as the only thing assumable on the presupposition of these grounds—hence as that which alone can be cognized as the true.

But if cognition is to become the complete cognizing of truth in its truth, in which truth shines by its own light, then at every point the grounds from which it proceeds, and on which its validity is so far conditioned, must be pursued up to the *highest and last grounds*—so that what is cognized is cognized by force of these, which, regarded from another side, may also be called the *first grounds*.

These, which then cannot in turn be traced back to higher grounds, must now be evident immediately by their own truth.

Remark and Supplement.

1. The free self-determination and productivity, with its own deliberation and consideration—which was called forth in the individual personality and came to meet the reception, testing it—was thus set in motion only so that truth might be more perfectly cognized and taken up. By this the cognizing personality is to rise to a higher level of cognition, and freedom is raised up so as to belong all the more fully to truth. So that truth may shine for us in its own light and thereby fully take shape in us, we enter into constant testing; we demand everywhere “a full account and correctness,” as the phrase goes—demand grounds and proofs in science, even where, for example in certain of the simplest mathematical propositions, the certainty is otherwise unshakable enough and no doubt arises or can arise. It is not enough that the true be given us; it is to be given us by the complete self-evidence of its truth alone. From no other hand will we receive it.

If, then, we see a higher *tendency toward independence* come into motion, and the personality assert itself as one that now, as far as possible, will rely only on itself and its own scrutiny in all its cognition, we nonetheless see that this happens only so that the power of the true may become truly complete in us. Even though we would test everything ourselves—indeed, it may even take on the appearance that we were calling the true itself to account, as though we ourselves would decide what is to be acceptable to us and would let truth hold only when we ourselves had confirmed it—still it is not ourselves or our own that we seek therein, but only that truth itself, in its truth, may

fully come to us. If we seek confirmation, it is that the true must confirm itself before our eyes as well. If we call to account, then what we call to account is only forms and representations that offer themselves to us but that we will not at once accept on trust—and we do so in order to let truth itself give us what we are to accept. It is here, where there is as yet only question of *rationes cognoscendi*, that we call ourselves to account. If we tear ourselves loose from every other authority by which we were perhaps formerly led, it is in order all the more to *subordinate ourselves to the highest authority*—that is, truth's own. Just as it is said elsewhere that only he shall find his life who knows rightly how to lose his life for the Lord's sake, so we may say here that we seek ourselves, or seek to win ourselves, precisely only in order to be able all the more completely to give ourselves up and lose ourselves.

2. Here we also see the point at which genuine scientific *study*, which first truly begins with *academic study*, comes to the fore, and where it becomes evident what it signifies. Precisely at the age at which, bodily and organically, a higher drive toward independence or self-subsistence stirs, and at which the transition from the child's life to the matured and completed human existence is to take place, the drive toward spiritual self-subsistence awakens and works, in the scientific respect too, in fresh, vigorous movements. For the student it is the stage in life at which he is to begin to strive to cognize truth in its truth. Therefore he is now to go to the sources from which his teachers themselves drew, and to know everything by force of the grounds and considerations by which the inquirers before him—from whom he learned, and naturally continues to learn—came to their cognitions. It is the stage of scientific coming-of-age [Fuldmündighed] that he is now to attain. He is to raise himself to the height of his age in his science, in order from there—if the aptitude for it is given him—to carry it further, whether by a theoretical or a practical path. Therefore he is now not merely to learn, receiving what is handed down to him as the result of inquiries, but *independent thinking* [Selvtænkning] is to set in—inquiry and grounding of his own: he is to study. In school, mere *learning*—though a thoughtful learning, to be sure—was the main thing. To satisfy his teachers, and only so far also himself, is what the pupil is to and will do. Now, by contrast, what chiefly matters is to satisfy the immediately felt demands of the feeling for truth. The endeavor is now everywhere to press toward the *last and highest grounds*; toward these the whole direction of study is to be aimed; and even if inquiry cannot yet, from a given point and within a certain sphere, reach with definiteness and clarity so far as to see the present thing in definite connection with the last grounds of all things—so far as to follow the connection of objects and their chain as far as possible—still these

grounds are always to be kept in view as the goal, however distant, toward which one is to strive, and a feeling for the importance and essentiality of one day reaching them is to be preserved and kept alive. This is what characterizes the academic citizen, and the man of science or scholar formed by academic study, as such. This is also why philosophical study—as a fathoming of the last grounds of all things, and a scientific endeavor called forth and moved by such a fathoming, with the distinctive stamp that such a fathoming must give it, a study first begun at this stage of life—now becomes here, too, of such decisive essentiality. —It is not, however, required, for a study to be called genuinely scientific, that its tendency be to cognize the given in its connection with the highest grounds of all things, or that its aim be strictly philosophical. Even if the inquirer keeps within certain limits and traces connection and relation only within a certain sphere, inquiry can still be genuinely scientific, provided only he aims to go, within this sphere, as far as he can—both by penetrating here as far into truth as possible and letting it shine as far as possible in its own light, and, partly to win it, partly to test what has been found and corroborate it if it seems to withstand testing, by extending his re-examination to the scrutiny of all the data that lie within the once-fixed sphere. The sense for all the more distant considerations to which one may have to go back must also be kept open and awake, together with a readiness to enter into them, so far as the present work will thereby not be interrupted but rather advanced. A constant general regard for them must show that, in the lowest, nearest, and most particular, a contribution to the highest, most distant, and most general is nonetheless intended. —A definite *limitation in the endeavor* may, moreover, be led to not only by personal considerations and grounds—insofar as every individual must more or less limit himself in order to accomplish anything with force and effect—but also demanded by objective grounds, insofar as every object ought to be investigated not only in its connection with the whole, and its significance thereby determined, but also in its particular appearance on its own, how it shows itself in and for itself; whereby it is then first regarded as a member of a certain smaller whole, which is investigated on its own, before this whole, and the object along with it, are considered in their larger relations. The philosophical spirit shows itself here in the direction the study takes toward the utmost and last that offers itself within this sphere—moreover, in the working toward the point where a higher consideration can now take hold.

3. How, again, the endeavor considered here—to cognize truth in its own truth and to let it be given by this alone—leads to the thought at work in the ontological proof of God's existence will perhaps be easily noticed; but to enter into all the considerations thereby called forth is not the place here.

§. 7.

Insofar as a cognition of truth in its truth is attained, there arises an *intelligent cognizing*, or a cognizing with insight and by force of a discernment. This cognizing—in which what is cognized is evident by its agreement with what understanding [Forstand] or reason [Fornuft] demands, or at least allows or admits, and is now assumed in accordance with a necessity of understanding or reason to cognize it—now stands in opposition to the cognizing of the given and the found, in which the latter is assumed merely on account of its bare givenness or foundness alone: a cognizing that as such has an empirical character.

Even a ground can be cognized as a ground, and a consequence as a consequence, only in that the former is seen as that which necessarily leads to its consequence, and the latter as that to which its ground necessarily leads, so that the consequence shows itself as one that, on the presupposition of the ground, cannot be thought otherwise—so that the necessity of assuming it shows itself as a necessity for thinking. What is assumed by force of grounds is always assumed in accordance with something the understanding can test and has tested. But just as the nexus between ground and consequence—the consequence’s being grounded in the ground—can be beheld only by an intelligent beholding, so too, when the true is not merely to be received but to be received as the true and cognized because it shows itself in its truth, mere foundness cannot be that on which cognition can rest; rather, it must rest on the true’s self-evidence. The true is seen in its truth only when it is seen as that to which we cannot avoid ascribing validity—when, that is, our thinking is so bound by it that we cannot think it otherwise; but this intelligent necessity enters only when an agreement with an understanding’s own demand or expectation shows itself.

A genuine and complete cognizing is therefore an *intelligent cognizing*. Only by such a cognizing is truth cognized in its truth. The empirical apprehending and intuiting must therefore, if it is to become a genuine cognizing, be so embraced by the intelligent endeavor that everything found as the actual is now also beheld in its—at least relative—conformity to understanding or reason. Only then does a genuine science come about. Whereas the knowledge we reach by merely empirical cognizing (so called only in a looser sense)—even if it leads to a doubtless needful and important, ordered and complete survey of the empirically given objects, and to a clear and exact presentation of their appearances or shapes and found qualities—still offers only an aggregate of phenomena, into which thought must first bring light and clarity by explaining them: that is, by showing their emergence and existence as one that the understanding itself, even if only

under certain quite special, however narrow, conditions, would have to demand, or at least expect. Whereby they then take on the stamp of essentiality and are lifted above the contingency with which they showed themselves, so long as they were as yet taken up only as merely found.

In intelligent cognizing, assurance is produced by a quite different and higher necessity than the empirical necessity to assume, which determinate affections bring with them. Although the apprehending individual must, in accordance with these, represent as it does represent—so that its productivity is so far found entirely bound and determined—it can nonetheless, so long as it is not discerned that the found is necessarily as it is, think it, that is, represent it, otherwise; and productivity is thus so far not completely bound. Empirical apprehension merely receives; but the consideration that raises itself above it can now also let it stand at its own worth. In the inquiry after the true in its truth, by contrast, thought is called forth, which will not merely receive plainly, but discern. But when it now, moving according to its own fundamental nature and its fundamental concepts, nonetheless arrives at what presents itself in the object itself, it becomes—precisely because it moved in its freedom and yet arrived only at this same one thing—bound with a higher power; so that complete boundness and masteredness enters by means of intelligent cognizing. Precisely because free testing and consideration has been called forth and asserts itself, what is cognized in accordance with it now comes to rule with the most complete power. Truth cannot shine in its truth, and be evident by this its truth itself, without seizing and carrying away with a higher necessity.

So far as intelligent cognizing goes and comes forth clearly as such, it now expresses itself in a *construction a priori*, under which what is cognized—being derived from the fundamental thought to which intelligent beholding has pressed forward—is presented in its necessity for the understanding. The thought that brought light into the cognized whole is now set forth as the first mover of cognition, by which everything is determined as it entails it must be.

Remark and Supplement.

We here follow cognition as it ascends, through a series of levels, to the highest. Only when we have made our way to this can all the foregoing be seen in its true meaning and its full light. But we will nonetheless, right here on the way, enter into the questions we gradually meet, and consider what they lead us to.

That an intelligence opens itself up in cognition, and that cognition everywhere strives toward *intelligence-character* [Intelligented], is soon seen once the endeavor

after complete cognition comes into motion and becomes clear to itself. But why is it so? *Why must all genuine cognizing be intelligent?*

Further: *how can the nature and constitution of an object given from without be cognized by a cognition whose living fundamental norms, whose determining first mover and determining manner, even at every point, are of inner origin—the very own of the understanding and reason speaking in us?*

1. That this last—we will take it into consideration first—is so, is clear. Every example of a cognition that proceeds from a deliberation, or in which connection, relation, ground, and consequence come into consideration, can serve to show it. Already when, in the simplest lower sensation, the representation is fixed in a certain determinate way—even entirely in agreement with the immediate momentary appearance, indeed even when it is only a matter of fixing this, and this happens with consciousness, so that a deliberation arises, or at least a question of whether a deliberation is needed or not—something intelligent will at once show itself, even if no difference between a semblance and the real is assumed but the possibility of a sense-deception is denied, insofar as something is thereby always determined in accordance with an inference whose validity and consequence—in accordance with grounds whose grounding power—can be seen only with the eye of the understanding. It is, in general, only a cognition by way of thinking that determines the reality of sense-intuition—which holds both when, within the sphere of the senses, it is asked whether and how far something is semblance or reality, and when, occasioned by considerations of a quite different kind, the question arises whether sense-intuition as a whole has any reality at all; so far, we receive the whole of sense-cognition itself, as regards the significance it acquires for us, from the hand of intelligent cognition.

The intelligent and the merely empirical cognizing thus already interlock in the formation of lower sense-intuition, and the former extends all the way through the cognition that, as regards its main character—namely, as regards what is assumed—still rests only on a simple apprehending or receiving of what is given in experience in its givenness. The same is seen, too, when now, by means of an intellectual intuition, the ground-forms discovered in objects are cognized. Although these too must be taken as they are found, intelligent cognizing enters here as well: not only in that, when the connection is not manifest, we must be led by grounds to determine the representation of it in a certain determinate way; we can also, in general, see a ground-form as a ground-form only by discerning how, in accordance with it, the outer shape or appearance whose ground-form it is actually comes about. The intelligent comes forward

still more when a Why is answered—when, that is, the explanation of phenomena is found; for a phenomenon is explained only when one goes back to certain fundamental determinations and fundamental relations, and the phenomena are now seen as necessary consequences of these—consequences that the understanding itself derives and cognizes as consequences thereof, because it is discerned that from such fundamental determinations only such phenomena, and no others, can be thought as consequences; as when the well-known laws of gravity, which might perhaps have been found in a purely empirical way through the well-known experiments, are discerned to be a necessary consequence of the nature and constitution of such an uninterruptedly attracting force as gravity is, which cannot be thought to act according to other laws.

Even if, in doing so, one often proceeds from first determinations that are merely apprehended in a purely empirical way and assumed on account of their foundness, without having yet been traced back to such first determinations as are evident to the understanding itself—indeed, even if the agreement with what the understanding itself entails, which shows itself when something is made comprehensible, is not seldom highly relative and conditioned (as when even the contrary-to-reason element in human actions is made comprehensible by being seen in its consequence from certain presuppositions, of which the understanding itself must recognize them to be a natural consequence: that is, a consequence whose following, or way of following, is conformable to understanding)—still the explanation and comprehension, and the cognition proceeding from it, is, so far as it goes as such, always entirely intelligent; within the given sphere of conditions, what is assumed now no longer stands as merely found and contingent. Finding ourselves in the midst of the empirical, we seek to come to light and clarity by starting from what is nearest and searching out its connection with what is nearest; and we can now also behold the members and parts most closely linked to one another in this their connection—indeed, behold them in their significance and essentiality for one another, and in respect of certain first members—without having yet pursued this discernment and comprehension to its utmost limits. Thus a certain animal form, or a certain mineral, that one takes from the series as an example, can be seen as an integral member—indeed, as an essentially belonging member—in the whole series; indeed, the whole system of animal forms or of species of minerals can be projected in an a priori way, in that the whole course of development of these forms is presented as though it were nature's course of ideas in the production of these forms, even if the determinations from which one thereby proceeds are still taken merely as those abstracted from experience itself by a broad survey of nature. But science naturally strives everywhere to widen the

limits within which intelligent cognizing has for a time remained standing, and thus to overcome this relativity of its. As far as the true, genuine cognition of the object, joined with insight, goes, so far too goes an intelligent cognizing; and where the latter gives out, so does the former.

Herein the understanding, in making its consequences, constructions, and deductions, everywhere proceeds from its *own* fundamental norms and principles. A logic, mathematics, metaphysics (metaphysical fundamental concepts and principles) not received or abstracted from experience, but springing in an independent way from thinking, is hereby everywhere laid at the foundation. And its determining influence extends into the smallest detail, whose particular constitution, in being explained and comprehended, is precisely also derived and cognized as that which, under the given conditions, is dictated by the understanding just so and not otherwise, and is grasped and comprehended only in that it, precisely in this its particular constitution, shows itself as that to which that logic, mathematics, metaphysics—and the construction guided by their fundamental determinations, or the execution and development of a certain intuition—necessarily lead.

And yet this cognition, although its determining fundamental determinations are of inner a priori origin, comes forward with a claim to objective validity, and cannot do otherwise. What comes forward as that which the understanding necessarily entails comes forward necessarily with this demand for reality. It is utterly unthinkable to us that it should not have it. Could a real conflict arise between experience and the necessary demands of the understanding, there could be no relation at all between the thinking being and reality. Yet such a conflict we could never find or establish. If something comes out as the result of a thinking or calculation that does not agree with experience, we always seek the ground of this disagreement in the fact that either our presuppositions were incorrect or an error has crept into our inferences. It can never occur to us that nature's consequences might perhaps be other than those of thinking—that nature's logic, mathematics, or metaphysical principles could be other than those of the understanding and reason that work and speak in us.

But how can such a cognition, springing from the understanding alone, be everywhere validly laid at the foundation in experience, and a whole empirical cognizing then built upon it?

Manifestly only because the intelligence that shows itself as such in the contemplating human being runs through the whole of reality and underlies it; because *the intelligence itself* is precisely an expression of nature's *last laws*. And how should something other

be, in the human being—as one member of this reality—the first and innermost mover, than what is such in the whole of reality in general? So that here one is not to think of a double understanding, as though our understanding met with, and agreed with, another understanding, nature's. It is the very same intelligence that, in its undivided unity, reveals itself in nature and in our thinking and contemplating, presenting itself, self-identical, here and there. What ties the connection and agreement between us, or our thinking, and reality, is here, as everywhere, something third which, higher than both the connected terms, equally underlies them both. To this, too—so far as the imperfect and piecemeal can bear witness to the perfect and total, in that it points to it as the source of its own possibility—to this, we say, it bears witness, that in the endeavor, guided by independent thinking, to penetrate into nature, the further it advances, the more a light really dawns for us over nature. What the understanding speaks, entails, demands is also given to us just as fully as what we reach in a wholly empirical way, even if it is given to us from a quite different side, in a quite different manner, and with a different stamp than the empirical; so that in the intelligent we have to do no less with something objective, and no more with ourselves or our own, than in the empirical. If here at every point there is an intelligent deriving and determining, cognition is nonetheless at every point a receiving and beholding, since we derive and determine, in conformity with the understanding, as we see that we must.

2. But in the human being the intelligence comes forward as such, or in *its intelligence-character*. Therefore the selfsame is here no longer the selfsame. Therefore that *a priori* enters here, which now shows itself to us in its real meaning and essentiality. If the intelligence is to come forward in its intelligence-character, if the rational orderliness [Forstandighed] that is in nature is to reveal itself in the human being as it is—and if in nature it is that which *underlies*—then in the human being too it must show itself as the underlying, indeed show itself pure in and for itself in its original independence, as the *constitutive and determining*, and moreover as the *a priori* in opposition to the manifold presenting itself in reality, and as the principle for an independent construction. And thus we see how the nature and constitution of an object given from without not only can, but also, if it is to be cognized fully, must be cognized by a cognizing whose determining principle and determining manner are of inner origin—the very own of understanding and reason.

It now also becomes clear why, although it is the selfsame intelligence that comes forward in us and in nature, nonetheless—and precisely because it is an intelligence and in us comes forward in its intelligence-character—something inner, or presenting itself

from within (subjective), comes forth in opposition to what presents itself from without (objective): both insofar as, in general, original demands proceeding from thinking itself show themselves, with which the given must be found to agree if it is to be comprehended, and insofar as, in the particular too, every point is cognized fully only when it is seen as that to which an a priori derivation or deduction could also lead. In the a priori construction both the inner and the outer show themselves in their greatest opposition—how they stand over against one another—but also, when the given now shows itself precisely as the necessary result of this construction, in their fullest agreement into unity: an agreement without which no genuine cognizing comes about. —Insofar as this a priori construction aims at setting a given reality in its full, true light, it shows itself as a merely reproducing construction, whereby we, as witness and assurance that we have fully penetrated into the cognition of the given in its truth, now by force of this cognition carry it out for ourselves in an image, which must then agree entirely with what an exact observation lets us find and behold in the given reality. But insofar as the fundamental cognition attained constitutes the moving, all-determining First in this construction, the construction comes forward as an independent one with the a priori character.

3. But just as an exact empirical observation must furnish the test of this construction's correctness and validity, so too only such an observation—an exact and careful study of the given reality itself, that is, of the rational or intelligent in it—can lead to that construction. Thought will penetrate the found; but for this it is required that the rational orderliness which reveals itself therein be apprehended—that is, understood—as it is, and wholly and entirely as it is. Here, therefore, it always takes on the appearance that our understanding met with an understanding revealing itself in existence. Only insofar as we find sense and understanding in nature and reality can we grasp and understand it—that is, cognize it fully; but this we do find therein, and therefore we can cognize it thus. The study of nature is like the study of a book, into whose meaning and whole spirit we seek to penetrate through its letter, but can also penetrate only insofar as we find meaning and spirit therein. But how do we penetrate into it? Only in that what we find expressed therein becomes evident to ourselves—and in such a way that we see why it has expressed itself as we find it expressed, and that we now ourselves agree with it therein. If an excellent work presenting deep truth is to be understood by us fully, the light that shone for its author must dawn for us, and we must come into possession of the moving first principle from which all his determinations necessarily proceeded, so that we now, with him, take truth at first hand. But precisely so it stands with the study

of nature; what in nature itself determines the significance of things must be grasped by us in such a way that a light dawns for us over nature from it, and what nature expresses, too, we must—penetrating through its letter to its spirit—seek to take at first hand. From which it is sufficiently clear that the aim cannot be, by an a priori constructing that tears itself loose from experience and proceeds entirely on its own, to make empirical observation and re-examination superfluous; but rather, precisely through the latter—as through an exact study of the words and sentences in nature’s book—to penetrate to its meaning and spirit.

The relation between *empiricism and rationalism*—an opposition that, especially in certain sciences, for example in medicine, has stirred up so much strife and struggle—must now surely be clear from this. Namely, that—just as, with respect to another distinction, we may say: only reason makes one properly understanding, but only the understanding, too, makes one properly reasonable—so too, surely, only a careful and exact study of the empirically given can lead to a completely rational cognizing, yet only a genuinely rational endeavor leads to a solid empiricism. If it is empiricism or experience to know that this or that applied means generally has these or those effects, without discerning how and why precisely such an effect comes to be the consequence of such a means, then empiricism or experience is no true cognizing. It is then to be classed with the knowledge that is merely an aggregate of certain results and learned propositions, without one’s being in possession of the grounds and the thinking that led to these results—without one’s seeing what lies in the learned propositions and is really asserted in them.

4. By means of free thinking there takes place a higher and more inward appropriation of the sphere of experience that offers itself to be cognized. The apprehending personality, which thereby, as it were, assimilates it and takes it up into inward unity with its own (rational) life, thereby becomes, as it were, at home in it and master over it, so that it moves and goes about in it as in its own property, in which nothing is any longer foreign to it. But in and by the same self-appropriation this personality becomes more and more taken into possession by the cognized truth, so that the personal life is absorbed into this truth’s own self-presentation, and more and more stirs and moves in truth and according to truth.

§. 8.

The endeavor to cognize truth in its truth leads—since it turns out that only that cognizing in which the given is beheld in its agreement with the demands of the understanding is a

genuine cognizing, and since the question now everywhere becomes whether the found must also be assumed necessarily to be as it is—to transferring the search after grounds to the objects themselves, and to asking why these themselves are as they are found to be. If formerly grounds were sought that were to determine our assuming—grounds of cognition (*rationes cognoscendi*)—now an inquiry of a quite different kind arises, as the *grounds of existence* of things (*rationes essendi*) are sought out.

Only with this does intelligent cognizing set in. With the most complete insight into the necessity of assuming what is assumed, this very thing assumed can nonetheless still stand before us as something merely found and contingent, of whose essentiality there is as yet only a question. Not this thing assumed itself, but only its assumption—whose grounds of existence the grounds of cognition now show themselves to be—is embraced by intelligent cognizing. This is always a cognizing of a *real necessity*. But if this real necessity is not merely to be evident, but to be evident in its truth and fully, then it must not merely be discerned, but discerned by force of the cognition of the real grounds.

Only then, when we behold things in their own real necessity, can we not refuse to ascribe essentiality and validity to them; and then we also see how far and in what relations it is to be ascribed to them—namely, so far as this necessity shows itself, and in the relations in which it shows itself. Only then, therefore, do we behold things in their truth. But in a real actuality, where things stand as members and parts of the actual whole, the real necessity—the necessity in and for the things themselves—must show itself as that in accordance with which these things actually come, or are present, and maintain their place. And thus their necessity must show itself as a necessity springing from certain grounds of existence, which grounds of existence must therefore be investigated. If cognition is to correspond completely to what is cognized—if the productivity by which, through the completion of the representation, cognition itself first comes about is to present what is cognized entirely as it is—then what is first and determining for the object must also stand as such in the cognition and representation. If things are what they are in accordance with a Something thus determining them, which as their real ground constitutes them, then cognition would be imperfect if they were not also beheld as those which are what they are precisely in accordance with this Something, or if this Something were not also, together with the things themselves, cognized as that by which they are so constituted.

Remark and Supplement.

1. The cognition of the *rationes essendi* of things now also lets us—only in that we see these to determine the modes of existence of things—behold them in their more or less

relative validity, or in their greater or lesser essentiality. They, as it were, warrant their existence and their descent to be granted a certain significance, as their real grounds show themselves; but now it is also seen that this significance and essentiality of theirs is in general only a conditioned one. Further than that on which their own reality rests, this reality itself cannot go. And just as it is only the thinking consideration for which the question of reality arises at all, and it is an intelligent fundamental concept that is thereby set in motion, so too it is the intelligence that determines the difference both between semblance and reality and between more and less valid reality, and now accordingly assigns everything given its place in this respect. There is nothing that does not have its reality; but this is seen only when it is seen how—indeed, how far—the thing cannot but exist, that is, when it is traced back to its real ground. Even semblance has its reality—namely, as semblance, as the apparent—and has a greater or lesser reality, the more or less such a semblance shows itself as necessary, the more extended are the relations that must be surmounted in order to escape it; but it is seen as such a semblance, and now also as a semblance necessary so far, only when it is discerned why and how it necessarily arises in accordance with that which, as its ground, brings it with it.

2. One easily sees that it is something quite different to investigate what we are to assume takes place—and to set forth the grounds of cognition that must determine us to it—than it is to investigate the real grounds why it is as we find it to be. The one investigation and insight often lies in a quite different sphere than the other. By the first, the phenomenon, or the constitution and relations, whose Why is to be answered by the second, is first fixed. But just as it is important first to know what must be assumed as given, before its *rationes essendi* are sought out, so the cognition of the latter often in turn casts such a light on the object of that first consideration that the *assumption's* own certainty and reliability is corroborated and completed by *insight into the real grounds*. If we see that a certain member or point in a given whole, in accordance with the connection cognized or assumed in this whole, cannot but be thus and so, and if what this conformity to understanding demands agrees with what observations and inferences from observation, or other grounds of cognition, lead us to assume about this member or particular point, then confidence in the correctness of the latter cannot but gain thereby—indeed, rise to irrefutable certainty.

3. Proofs aim at the presentation of sufficient grounds of cognition, and are carried out by *inferences*. The inference is, in general, the form for this kind of cognizing. By its form it leads, in general, only to seeing the necessity of assuming this or that. This is evident not only in the many cases in which the consequences or effects of an object's

fundamental form, or fundamental constitution and fundamental manifestations, become that from which we infer the object itself, and from which we thus derive the proof of the truth of the representation formed about it—as when it is established, from the well-known grounds, that the Earth is spheroidal and that it turns on its axis and goes around the Sun, whereby the question why it has such a figure and motion is as yet not at all answered, indeed not even touched, since it lies in a quite different sphere of investigation. But also where one does not thus infer back, from the constitution of certain phenomena, to a certain factual fundamental state or fundamental form, or a certain fundamental fact, but where a train of thought, striding straight forward from what is first in itself to what follows from it, leads to a series of cognitions by way of strict inferences, and to a whole scientific doctrinal edifice—even in an entirely intelligent way—the kind of cognition may still be such that it merely shows, in accordance with valid grounds of cognition, how the objects are constituted and what their relations are, without the grounds of existence for this being fathomed and brought forth.

Mathematics is, at least according to the usual manner of presentation, a great and telling example of this. The whole conduct of proof here gives, in general, only grounds of cognition, and no others are sought or demanded. The necessity with which and in accordance with which cognition takes place is indeed intelligent, and it concerns—which must not be overlooked—the objects themselves, the mathematical forms or intuitions themselves; it is really discerned that these objects themselves necessarily have the cognized qualities and relations, so that the necessity is not a merely outer one, determining us, but an inner necessity in and for the objects (the triangles, the squares, and so forth) themselves. But that whose intelligent necessity is discerned is nonetheless always only that qualities and relations are as they are; as for the grounds, only why we must *cognize* that it is so is shown—not why it is so *in itself*. In the auxiliary lines that are so often constructed—in general, in the accessory constructions that are so often made for the sake of the proof, and in other detours that are used—the actual grounds of existence of the qualities and relations considered are surely not to be sought. Mathematics in general aims only at the determination of forms and relations, not at their inner essence and connection with a higher and highest being. Mathematical *demonstration* is not yet a philosophical *deduction*. The proofs by which cognition takes place, along with the way in which cognition takes place by force of them, are, with respect to what is cognized itself in itself, nothing truly essential. The proof gives a more certain cognizing and leads to a more coherent one, but gives no higher and more essential cognizing. The source of the relations and qualities is not exhibited; they are not derived from their

origin or descent; (their warrant is not a true legal ground, but rather a kind of *causa in facto posita*). Cognition therefore also takes place piecemeal, not in an all-embracing connection in which everything would be beheld in mutual essential connection. This science has as little the form of a genuine, complete science as it is itself a genuine and complete knowledge from the ground up. That the mathematical method ought not to be adopted in philosophy—the strongest ground for this (to note it in passing) is that this method is by no means perfect enough for it, by no means truly thorough (going to the ground) and genuinely scientific enough. To take up the philosophical content requires a quite differently systematic and organic form, with a quite differently closely-connecting method than at least the Euclidean, and any other that proceeds in his spirit—however much its rigor and exactness are otherwise to be praised. As little as it would be fitting—despite all recognition of the beauty and significance of so many crystallization-forms—to force a tree into such a form, just as little is it fitting, even if one fully recognizes what is in itself finished and elegant in a genuine mathematical method, to want to force philosophical endeavor, which strives after a freer, more vital, and more organic form, to enter into the mathematical, when it is to express itself in definite presentation. In the organic manner of appearance toward which it strives, the last must bear the first just as much as the first grounds the last, since the whole cognition rests in that which, as ruling soul, runs through the whole—from which it follows that no single determinate proposition can be completely evident in itself, without any regard to the following ones and to the whole scientific aggregate of propositions; whereas in mathematics, which proceeds more in straight lines than in a cycle, each earlier proposition is certain enough without needing the subsequent one, and the evidence of the first propositions does not rest in the execution of the whole system—which, by contrast, is the case in philosophy, as will become clear in the following (for here we anticipate it). It can even be a question whether what mathematics, according to its usual procedure, gives us can be called a scientific system in the proper sense; at least, the many propositions, so often evident independently of and without regard to one another, are not seen in any such essential connection with one another that they are traced back to a unity and show themselves as those which together form a self-rounded whole.

[Mathematics as a whole is, from the standpoint of philosophy, to be regarded in general—like the empirical—as a great phenomenon (like a certain particular world of the understanding), whose possibility and last grounds become a task for philosophy. A doctrine of mere forms and relations, then, cannot yet be a complete science either, and cannot therefore be withdrawn from philosophical endeavor, as though it were suffi-

ciently complete in itself and enough for itself. The genuinely scientific mathematician will also strive to bring a philosophical spirit to move and stir in this sphere of cognition. But if we ask how philosophical endeavor can gain room in this science, and in particular how a complete cognition of real grounds, and by force of the cognition of real grounds, can be attained here too, that is surely not so easy to say: no science is at present further from what could be called its philosophy than mathematics. Two principal points, however, can be indicated in this respect. We have already—this is the *first*—noted that, although the proofs give only grounds of cognition, the proved qualities and relations are nonetheless cognized as such as cannot be otherwise in their objects, so that their real necessity is discerned. And this is discerned because it is discerned that in every possible case the same could be proved under such presuppositions, since the object's (e.g. the triangle's) fundamental form will always allow it; but in that this fundamental form of the object shows itself as the constant real ground of possibility of the same manner of proof, it is seen that it is really the ground of existence of the proved qualities and relations. It therefore depends only on this: that this actual ground of existence too be seen as such, and that what is to be proved be seen as *its* consequence—and that as its direct consequence, not one moreover resting on certain auxiliary constructions—or rather, that it be seen as belonging to this fundamental form itself and to its essential expression. Such a manner of cognition and proof was the aim of the sketch of a geometry according to a genetic method which Ørsted, a good many years ago, began to work out and communicate to several persons, and which he—as we wish and hope—will surely one day find occasion and inclination to bring to light. The objection that such an attempt will probably meet soonest and first—namely, that the proofs in this way could not attain Euclidean rigor, but that, when figures are now to be considered in their arising through the movements of lines, even the *crux mathematicorum* which in the higher mathematics gives the mathematician striving everywhere after rigor so much to contend with—the concepts of the infinitely small and infinitely large—might now gain admittance into the lower mathematics as well: this objection will mean so little in the philosopher's eyes that what is feared will for him be precisely the gratifying thing about it; for that precisely where the so-called irrational in mathematics presents itself, the rational comes into view, is a remark that is now, and has already long been, no longer new. (See in this connection the both deeply and sharply seeing Hegel's *Logik*, first volume, the Remark, p. 206.) But even if in this way the fundamental norm of a mathematical construction, which is at the same time the fundamental form in the mathematical intuition thereby produced, is everywhere brought forth so that it is everywhere seen as the ground of the

qualities and relations cognized to take place in the constructed intuition, and further, a certain necessary course develops from it in the sequence of the propositions after one another—there still remains the question of the real grounds of existence of the various constructions themselves (of the triangles and squares and other forms themselves) and their real significance in the whole of cognition. Real concepts (that is, proper and true concepts) of them mathematics does not yet give. Should such not, however, also be found? But where and how are we to seek them? In order to see finite forms in their real significance and essentiality, we must—which is *the second* thing we would point to—see them as integral members in real actuality; only as members and parts of this, or as forms that each in their place necessarily arise in this actuality, are they seen in such a connection with the whole that this can now also be pursued far enough that they are seen in their connection with the last grounds of all things. Thus they will already be regarded, in the first place, when they are seen as constructions to which the real intuiting and productive activity by which they are produced must necessarily come in its necessary course of development. The order and sequence in which the propositions are to be presented, and the light in which they are thereby to be set, will then especially become an object of consideration; but then something philosophical will thereby already show itself in mathematics, which will now also be able to become an object of debate, as well as of dialectical consideration—something that mathematics, in accordance with its apodictic but not philosophical manner of cognition, otherwise does not know. But more important than this merely subjective consideration will be to seek them out in *nature*, and, when one finds mathematical forms there—whether as fixed shapes, for example in the crystals, or as forms of motion, for example in the course of the planets—to investigate why in nature precisely *such forms arise at such points*. The mathematical forms are found here *as given objects in reality*, hence in a certain necessary connection with the whole of given nature, and now the endeavor to penetrate everywhere in nature to the last grounds cannot but embrace them as well. Precisely because in pure mathematics they were not regarded as given, no question arose about their *rationes essendi*. In such a philosophizing over the mathematical forms it would now probably also turn out that the real significance of a mathematical construction can be different in different respects; from which a certain uncertainty as to its correct determination, or at any rate a difference as to the course and manner of its determination, could result, and the philosophical difference in mode of intuition, and the strife following from it, might again come forth in this sphere of cognition otherwise freed from such contentions. But this would nonetheless bear witness that the cognition

had become organic.]

3. Although the grounds by force of which cognition takes place in mathematics are merely grounds for the assumption, still—since that to whose cognition these grounds lead shows itself as something that, in the constructed forms or intuitions, indeed in the objects themselves, is as it is in accordance with an objective intelligent necessity—we have in mathematics an example of a purely intelligent, and indeed an absolutely intelligent, cognizing. Nothing here is taken as merely found, but everything is found and cognized as something the understanding demands. The understanding finds itself here entirely in its own sphere, in which it is completely at home; therefore the certainty here is a complete self-evidence.

Philosophy too strives after such a certainty, but its far higher nature and aim make it here far more difficult to attain. While mathematics aims at investigating the qualities and relations of objects that are products of its own constructions—constructions of whose essential necessity there is not even any question, since their mathematical possibility is here enough for their reality, so that mathematics has therefore only to find out what is an essential consequence of certain determinations thus possible—philosophy, by contrast, has not only to find out and determine what in and for itself is the true with respect to objects (physical or moral) that are actually given, and which must be taken with the determinations with which they are found, but it even aims at—indeed, is to start from—that which is the absolutely true in general, which underlies all the conditions and determinations with which any objects whatsoever can show themselves. Since here all things show themselves in infinitely many connections and relations, and these relations precisely determine things' own modes of existence or forms of appearance—since all things in general have only a relative being and essentiality—there is here an infinite series to live through, an infinite aggregate of objects to behold in their connection, before absolute certainty can be attained with respect to any of them. Many points now soon shine forth as so evident in themselves that no doubt seems possible about their certainty; but yet precisely that from which complete certainty should spring can become what shakes their certainty, because they, when an accounting is now demanded of their validity, do not seem capable of being established with a self-evidence against which a skepticism could not, after all, arise. Here, then, everything finally depends on whether *a highest, absolutely fixed point* can be found, to which everything can be so linked that by it its more or less relative validity can be determined with firmness. This highest point will now soon show itself to be not merely the highest, but also the center around which everything gathers into unity and validity, and by whose light every point

is to be illuminated, so that it is beheld as the all-valid that runs through everything. (See further on, § 10.) But now the question again arises wherein the certainty of this pure Absolute's reality and truth rests. And then the matter takes on, on the one side, the appearance that this certainty could rest only on the fact that everything *else* pointed precisely thus *to that*, as the first and all-conditioning—that, as surely as so much else, which could now be gone through in its principal points, was true and undeniable, so too that must be true and undeniable. But on the other side it is clear that everything else can point thus to it only on its own presupposition, and that it must have shown itself in its reality in order for us to see everything else point to it. But then it must be cognized as that whose reality must not merely rest in itself alone, but whose reality must also show *itself by itself alone*.

And then we see how natural is the thought already taken into consideration earlier, which underlies the ontological proof of God's existence—a thought to which an endeavor to cognize truth in its truth, and by its own truth, could not but lead, and to which all the reflections in which we here find ourselves point at almost every point. Just as faith in God necessarily takes on—as indeed it already has from the outset—the character of a firm faith resting in itself, so the intelligence too strives to bring this cognition to an equally immediate self-evidence resting in itself. But this is not the place to carry out these considerations.

§. 9.

The inquiry after the grounds of existence of things aims most immediately at finding out their connection and relations, and the real significations thereby determined, from which their existence and constitution are comprehended and explained. But such a cognition is a cognition of *a concept* and a cognition *by force of a concept*. The proper, true concepts of things (*sensu eminenti*)—namely, their *real concepts*—now show themselves as those in which the true grounds of things are most immediately to be sought.

For to ask after the ground of a thing is to ask after something *other* than the thing itself, from which it follows, and with which, therefore, its existence is given as necessary. An inquiry after the ground of an object therefore goes beyond the thing—unless the thing is found to have its ground entirely in itself, or to be itself the Other in question. Another object is then sought, of which the given one can be regarded as a consequence. But then (not to mention that this other object, if it is of the same kind and sphere as the first, will show itself as just as contingent, just as far from being enough in itself, as the first) what most immediately brings the object with it—indeed, its nearest

ground—is really the connection, the nexus, between the one and the other, which brings it about that the former can and must carry the latter with it. Which holds equally, whether the one follows as effect from the other as cause, or several objects in conjunction show themselves as those that essentially go together with one another. Always, when any other object whatever is adduced as the ground of one in question, it will and must be asked why the former has the latter as consequence—which is a question after a certain mode of connection between them, in accordance with which the one carries the other with it. The connection then shows itself as what most immediately grounds; the conformity to understanding itself—so far as it is beheld as the conformity to understanding and necessity of understanding that, in the thing itself, with the one requires the other—is here most immediately the actual real ground; only by discerning this is the thing comprehended and explained.

But connection is cognized fully only when it is seen as that by means of which an aggregate of parts or other particulars is joined into full unity and wholeness. Such a connection is the expression of a concept, and a cognition of a thing's essentiality and significance in accordance with such a connection is both a cognition of a concept and a cognition by force of a concept. A thing's concept, as the fundamental thought determining the mode of connection, thus shows itself as the ground in accordance with which the individual members belonging to the thing are as they are. Because the thing is this or that—that is, corresponds to this or that concept—it has the qualities and parts it has, and these stand in the relations in which they stand. But the thing is, in turn, the thing it is, and corresponds to its concept, because as member and part it essentially belongs to the larger real whole in which it is found, and whose concept carries it with it. Its own concept here shows itself as a single thought necessarily following from the concept of the larger whole; whereby the concept that before stood as ground with respect to its individual members is now itself grounded, or seen in its essential following from a conformity to understanding.

The cognition of a great connection embracing all given objects, in accordance with which they would all be seen as essentially needful members in an all-embracing great whole—so that it would be clear how a necessity of understanding entailed or demanded them all, with all their qualities—is inquiry's ultimate aim in this direction of its.

Remark and Supplement.

1. Where phenomena show themselves as facts—but in nature everything can everywhere be regarded either as facts or as results of facts—inquiry aims at the *laws* according to which effects are produced, and to fathom the grounds of things becomes, so far,

to fathom their laws (though naturally as such as are discerned to be necessary in accordance with an intelligent necessity); but these laws are then, as the fundamental forms of activities, a kind of concept.

2. We see here how the Platonic Socrates (in the *Phaedo*, pp. 97c and 99e) could feel himself driven to reach for Anaxagoras's νοῦς, and, in order to come to a true cognition of the grounds of things, to take his refuge εἰς τοὺς λόγους. This cognition is indeed not yet the highest; it itself points to a higher one; but this higher cognition, to which it leads, is not to displace it, but to corroborate it—indeed, it will first show it in its fullest validity. Meanwhile, we can and will, right here where it enters, establish ourselves entirely in the cognition that the conformity to understanding itself is that in which the sought reality rests—that the concepts of things are their proper, nearest grounds of existence.

The general ground for this cognition is that everywhere the actual Because can most immediately not be an object, but the nexus that brings it about that this object has the first as its consequence. If, for example, heat is adduced as the ground of a body's being expanded, cold as the ground of water's solid state when it has become ice, these objects are still not thereby cognized as grounds of these phenomena; rather, this cognition—that the adduced object really is the ground of the phenomenon in question—arises only when it is discerned how heat expands, cold solidifies, and why the one cannot but expand, the other solidify. But if this is to be discerned, the whole nature of heat and of cold must be investigated, together with the whole aggregate of effects that, in accordance with this nature, it is discerned as unable not to have. But the question then becomes what heat, what cold, really are. And this question is a question after the concept of heat and of cold, from which the laws of their effects are then discerned. For this it will now be required to investigate what significance heat and cold have in the whole of nature, and also under what conditions they come forth. But when it is now discerned that heat, for example, must come forth under these or those conditions, this can still only really be discerned when it is discerned how it follows from heat's whole concept, from the real significance it has in the whole, that under such conditions it must set in—whereby heat's own inner nature shows itself as the properly causal element (αἴτιον, *Phaedo* 99b), which under the given conditions comes forth because its nature entails that it must then come forth. But heat's nature is its distinctive constitution, or manner of being, determined by its real significance; and moreover the cognition of its nature is one with the cognition of its concept. And so it stands not only when the ground of a certain kind of phenomena in general is inquiry's aim, but also when in a particular

individual case the ground of a certain fact is sought; there too it can be found only by entering into the investigation of a certain connection, but then the insight into the ground will rest on the insight that an object such as the one in question, in accordance with the nature of such an object in general—hence in accordance with its concept—had to step into reality under such circumstances. Let it be well noted that a ground is not cognized and discerned as the ground of a fact merely because the thing is assumed and cognized as that on which such a fact always follows, and according to a definite rule, but only when it is at the same time discerned that this fact must follow upon it because it necessarily carries such a fact with it; and this cannot be discerned without discerning the connection, or nexus, that leads from the one to the other—so that this nexus is that on which everything depends. And this holds not only with respect to our cognizing, but just as fully with respect to the thing itself; for what is it, too, in the thing itself, that brings it about that after, or with, the one thing the other always and necessarily follows, other than precisely the real connection between them, which entails that with the one the other must set in? Once it is discerned as entirely necessary that from a certain object another follows—but without this insight the cognition of groundedness is not complete—this too must be cognized as something that is so in the object itself because in it it could not be otherwise; and the necessity of understanding then shows itself as that which, in the object itself too, brings it about that the ground has the consequence it has, so that the conformity to understanding shows itself as what properly grounds. When—to go back to an example that occurred earlier (§ 7, Remark 1)—the laws of gravity are explained and discerned by a mathematical speculation, what else can be named as their real ground in nature than precisely this: that a force like gravity cannot be thought to act, and therefore cannot actually act either, in any other way.

What has here been elucidated about the kind of ground called cause is even more evident when several things, found together at once without temporal succession, show themselves as those which carry, the one the other, with them. That the ground of a certain animal form's existence must be sought in the whole developmental course of the animal series—indeed, in the connection within the whole series that requires such a form as an integral member in the whole series—is easy to see; likewise, that the heart has the form it has because the whole organization—hence the fundamental form of the organism, or its concept—demands such an organ among the rest; and so forth.

3. But if the grounds of things are thus sought in their concepts, will not the inquiry after grounds end, in the end, at something quite different from what it sought—come out

at a place that seemed least of all to be the one where it should come out? The question after the ground of something requires something *other* than the thing itself, of which other the thing is to be a consequence, or with which other it is at the same time to be given; and it is manifestly no answer to such a question when the very thing whose ground is asked for is given back, under another shape, as the ground. But does this not happen quite manifestly when, with Plato (the *Phaedo*, at the passage cited), seeking the grounds of things in their concepts, one says that the ground of, for example, two things' being two is not the adding by which the one is joined to the other, or the dividing by which one thing is separated into two parts, but is nothing other than twoness; or when one would say, for example, that the cause of a human being's dying is not the poison or the disease or the like, but is death; or that the ground of its freezing is not the north wind, which is said to have brought such cold with it, but is nothing other than frost? Is such not the manifest tautology?

And yet it is clear that—to keep to the examples—it is not the poison alone that, without more, makes the human being die; not the north wind alone that, without more, makes the water frozen. Upon the introduction of the poison into the body, there comes forth, by means of the relation between it and the organic life-process, such a state that now life itself, in its corresponding activity, causes death—that is, that under a concurrence of these conditions (partly the outer, the poison, partly the inner, the living activity working in accordance with its nature) there sets in the state that is now precisely death itself, which sets in because under these conditions precisely it, and nothing else, must set in, because the nature of such a state, of such a fact, is that of such a one—and, as it were, adds this new thought, and demands its realization, to the preceding ones.

And thus, as regards first *facts and states*, their real grounds are to be sought both in the things themselves in which they are found—or these things' own nature, that is, in their concepts—and outside them, in what is usually named as their grounds and causes. Everything sets in, and has its thus-and-so constituted subsistence, only under certain determinate relations, which are therefore conditions for it; and when they are all present, it too must necessarily come to be present, and thus these conditions too take on the character of grounds. But when it now sets in and comes to be present, it comes forth with its distinctive constitution, as something new that comes to the rest and whose place can be taken by none of these; it comes forth thus because it is itself as it is, and with this its distinctive nature and constitution belongs at this place; it sets in, therefore, in accordance with the distinctive thought that requires such a Something at

such a place—that is, in accordance with its own concept. The point at which the thought of such conditions coincides with the thought of such a fact—so that it is discerned that the latter, on the presupposition of the former, must necessarily be thought in this determinate way—is the point where the actual ground lies; but this is precisely the thing's own concept. In the special case, everything depends on seeing how a certain general thought, a certain concept, under these given circumstances necessarily came to reality; how, for example, under these conditions frost or death, in accordance with the concept of frost or death, came to actuality; only then are frost or death seen as the cause of the water's freezing or the human being's dying.

And if we then, secondly, ask how these very thoughts that demand the setting-in of such facts—*these very concepts* in which we seek the grounds of these facts—come forth, we see that they are, in accordance with a necessary train of thought, derived or deduced from certain preceding concepts, which necessarily also lead to these in a whole system of thought. A certain principal thought demands, when it is to be realized, this and that determinate thing, which in accordance with it must be; but in this there are now many particulars, each of which must be constituted thus and so, to which, therefore, just as many concepts correspond, which dictate not only why they must necessarily be thought along with it, but also how they must, on that account, be. As the thing, the fact, or the factual state, is explained or seen in its groundedness—because it is discerned that under these relations a necessary train of thought necessarily requires precisely the thing's existence in this way—there is now also seen, at the same time, the thought determining it to this, the thing's concept, in its necessary emergence from such a train of thought. Meanwhile it nonetheless comes forth as a particular thought, a particular concept, on its own, which in the whole train of thought is indeed demanded thus by the pressing necessity of the rest, yet is a new thought on its own and a member subsisting in itself just as fully as all the rest, with which together it forms this whole of thought. So that the concept itself rests equally in itself and in the whole connection in which it comes forth and from which it is derived. The thought shows itself as what determines the thing, and therefore the ground of the thing's existence and constitution must be sought in its concept; but if one asks after the ground of the concept itself, this is to be sought in its deduction, in the necessity of understanding that, in a certain necessary train of thought, leads to such a concept—so that not precisely the fundamental concept from which one proceeds, but the connection of thought and necessity of thought as a whole, which leads from the fundamental concept to the concept in question, is to be named as the latter's ground.

4. The question of grounds here still everywhere comes forward only as a *Why*. This leads most immediately from phenomenon to phenomenon, or from a given object to another given in the same way. But because this other cannot, without more, be adduced as the answer, but is only just so much: it is not always easy to determine what, in a fact, is the actual fact. But once it is found out, it only now becomes the object of a grounding—in order now to find out its *ratio essendi*. The question why the planets go around the Sun, and so forth—or the inquiry into an explanation of the whole planetary system, regarded as a great found phenomenon—already leads over into a quite different sphere. It can now lead to seeing this fundamental fact in its essential connection with others, and thus the concept of a larger connection may open itself up, whereby a *more deeply lying fundamental fact* would come into view, as a task for a new grounding; but the explanation may also perhaps lead back to *intelligent determinations* that are evident by their own self-evidence, and from which that fact is seen as a necessary consequence—whereby, however, a certain mode of connection always comes into view, as the foundation of the whole explanation. In general, this course of explanation leads all questions of grounds back to certain fundamental questions, on whose answering everything will finally depend, but with whose answering light will also finally be brought into the whole. Partly, several coordinate *isolated facts* will gradually more and more be seen as *the same, or alike*, so that one and the same fundamental fact is recognized again in them all; as when in combustion, in the rusting of metals, and so on, one finds again the same process of oxidation. Partly, several coordinate *facts interlocking with one another*, or states or fundamental forms connected in a real way, will be able to be beheld as consequences of a *real connection* embracing them all, so that only this finally becomes the remaining problem; as when all the activities and manifestations of the mind show themselves in so essential a connection with one another that finally only the existence of such a self-conscious and self-determining personality in the midst of a finitude becomes the problem that remains; or when all individual animals seem so to be essential members in a whole self-developing series that now the fathoming endeavor turns to this whole formation expressed in such a series, in general, with its fundamental determinations, in order to ask why it exists at all. But thus, finally, the necessity of assuming still something *quite other* than *the whole chain* with all its members—something in which the whole, as it were, hangs, or by which it is in general borne and held—will press itself upon us more and more; which leads over to the next consideration.

The necessity of understanding, or conformity to understanding, that demands the existence of things and determines their qualities—the concepts of things, on whose thorough cognition the cognition of things themselves depends, and which in things themselves show themselves as that in accordance with which they exist and are as they are, hence as a foundation for their subsistence and whole distinctiveness—may indeed be posited as the *nearer rationes essendi* of things; but in these, taken in and for themselves alone, their *first and highest ground* cannot yet be sought. Even if in this intelligent grounding one were to proceed from determinations—and from something one must proceed—that (like the first ones of mathematics) were self-evident and had to be assumed in accordance with an immediate intelligent necessity, still only an assumption would thereby be grounded, not the existence of the corresponding things in a reality; and the whole real existence would so far still stand as contingent. Intelligence and concept can indeed *entail* that such and such objects are there; it can indeed *demand* them; but it does not set them into existence or make them actual. The whole total connection, from which things' essentiality and the necessity of their existence follow and become evident, will still—so long as it alone shows itself as cognition's last foundation or first origin—stand as a great problem, of which it must equally be asked why it, in general and in its wholeness, is as it is, as it was asked how the actual whole, in which it is found realized, comes to be actually present. We must therefore still seek the last grounds of existence in something other than the whole rational orderliness—in a Third that connects the two, the given reality on the one side and the rational orderliness on the other, and that everywhere brings the concept into the immediately actual (into objectivity), and brings it about that the former is expressed in the latter. Which Third must then be just as embracing as the whole connection—must show itself, just as fully as this, as One and all.

This, then, cannot be merely a rational orderliness, but must at the same time be a power [Kraftighed]: an *active First*, which shows itself as a principle *by which* things are as they are, so that everywhere, in its working, it is present in them, and they are only its outer expression and effects. A principle that not only *determines* (in an ideal way), but realizes, or *makes actual* (in a real way). Such a principle grounds and gives essentiality by itself, working, being present in things and, as it were, filling them with essentiality—quite as the soul is everywhere present in every part of the organism. It is the true *being* and essence, the true real or substantial; and only when it is beheld in them, or they are beheld as belonging to its full manifestation, are they themselves beheld so far down to the ground that they are thereby illuminated, as by an inner light. It is beheld only as it should be beheld when it is seen as *a life* that enlivens, or at least makes

actual, all the things grounded by it; and all these things, which now show themselves as a mere substrate or material for its life and working, are seen only as they should be seen when they are seen as enlivened or made actual by it—so that these, in their whole aggregate, are seen only as its expression, and it itself is seen as that which dwells in them and shines toward us, or speaks to us, out of them.

In place of that *Why* there shows itself here a *By-which*, and in such a way that that by which things are shown shows itself as that which, as the inner essence, is *present* in these things. But that *Why* does not thereby fall away. It can and must still constantly be asked: why does that first Being and Active One work precisely in *this* determinate way, why does it step forth just into *these* effects? A question that, when one starts from its consideration as fundamental consideration alone, and does not look toward an already given reality, will run: in *which* effects and forms of expression will that true being come forth? In general, it cannot be thought as the ground of existence of any individual object except in accordance with a certain all-embracing connection, a certain conformity to plan, a definite *order of things*, according to which precisely these or those definite things are brought forth, as it carries them with it. But this whole mode of connection, or order in things, must itself be grounded in that active First, that true real. But if it is asked: why precisely this order and no other? or, better asked: which order of things, then, must that First set into existence? then no other answer can be given than the same that must be given when the question is: why is there anything else at all besides that true, essential one alone? why does it set anything else into existence? And to this the answer can only be: in order therein completely *to reveal itself*; hence in order that this other may be (or become) its complete expression, so that it can itself completely fill it and be in it. That to which we must look in order to find the *first origin* and determining ground of all things is also that to which we must point when it is asked: to *what end* everything exists. That *by which* it is, is also that *for which*, or for whose sake, it is. But then that mode of connection, or order of things, must also be such as this requires it to be, in order fully to reveal its essentiality. We see, then, how the inner, all-grounding being entails and demands, while at the same time it works and makes actual. While it is itself One and all, as that which is everywhere present in all as the sole thing that in truth is, it nonetheless at the same time demands this all as something *other* than itself, in which it is now to be as the all-filling, and thus itself also stands in relation to this other, as though it were merely a member in the chain—albeit the first moving member. Which becomes especially evident when the whole connection is now to be discerned and cognized as that which is expressed by it in reality, and in accordance with

which every individual thing is determined and brought forth; for then one must proceed from certain first determinations, as those which that all-real being first demands, to which, therefore, cognition is first led—and since in these a connection must at once show itself, the all-real being itself stands as the very first in the series or chain of this connection, hence as a beginning first, as a member. Its significance with respect to the other, its relation to it, must now be determined, and indeed a *concept* be formed of it. But although it thus stands as the first determining member, it is nonetheless not merely the first, but also the all-moving, which, animating and determining, runs through the whole, and everywhere shows itself therein at every point, so that the whole that now comes forth is, in its wholeness, to become its total expression. —This true Being, Absolute and Eternal, so far as it is beheld in one with the form under which it comes forth—or the concept through which it comes to its real appearance—is what we call *Idea*. In the *Idea*, then, all cognizing finds its last support and rest, in that it finds therein its absolutely first point of departure.

Remark and Supplement.

1. We have only a few strokes to add in order to carry the train of thought up to the very highest point—to the point where the highest *Idea* comes. If things' first and only true *ratio essendi* is to be sought in an all-real, single Being and principle, but this is such as at the same time entails and posits an infinite, coherent whole and an infinite rational orderliness or conformity to plan in this whole, then it shows itself not merely as a being and a life, but as an all-real, existing and living being, which posits an infinity in order to reveal its infinity therein, yet which in itself is independent of what it thus posits—determining it, but not determined by it.

But why, then, does it posit or bring forth this whole, when it subsists in itself without it? *Why is it not merely, but also reveals itself?* We answer: so that it may come forth in infinite *fullness*. Hence, after all, so that it may still more fully *be*. There must be something in it itself that requires its revelation, so that it cannot and will not rest in itself alone. We cannot conceive it as stepping out and revealing itself without conceiving it as though it *had to* reveal itself and could not do otherwise; and yet there can exist no compelling thing, no commanding necessity, for it: if it must reveal itself, it is because it *must will* to reveal itself. But how is a *Must* to be thought together with complete freedom—how is that which does not at all *need* anything else outside itself for its subsistence nonetheless to be thought as that which *requires* something else outside itself, as though it were, after all, not enough for itself? It can be thought only as a necessity and a demand of *love*. For love has this in itself: that it cannot be without the

other, without the object of its love, and that it nonetheless requires this object for no other reason than solely in order to love—which here is not in order to receive, but only in order to give. That which, besides the highest being—which now, as a loving being, must necessarily be thought as highest *personality*—must further exist, is *its kingdom*, the kingdom of God, as a kingdom of holiness and love, and moreover of beauty and fullness. But therefore a *freedom* too must be, and a *kingdom of freedom*; and in order that this may be, freedom must itself make itself into such—whereby we come to the consideration already called forth earlier (§ 4, Remark 3). (Let it only be further noted how the Idea of the Son of God—as the first and at the same time all-embracing object of eternal self-revelation and love—here presents itself quite directly; but this consideration lies too far from the present investigations for us to enter into it here.)

2. The highest aim in this direction of inquiry, and for all striving after cognition in general, now becomes to behold everything so in relation to God that this highest Idea—just as it is *practically* to be the *all-animating*—now also *scientifically* becomes the *all-illuminating*, as we have already noted earlier, in passing, in Remark 3 to § 1. But a philosophical cognizing (a cognition by force of Idea) can, at many points, already fully set in as such, without the object's yet being beheld in the highest light. What makes a cognizing philosophical is, in general, not what is cognized alone, but the way in which it is cognized: namely, that it is cognized by force of a fundamental cognition of something beheld as the productive principle—but thereby also as the sole real, or existing and essential, that gives all reality—and with respect to that, whatever it may be, which is to be cognized by force of it.

§. 11.

What determines for all things their more or less relative essentiality, and with respect to which alone they are and mean anything, must naturally also be that which gives cognition itself its essentiality and makes it what it is—so that *the last ground of existence of cognition* itself is likewise to be sought therein. Cognition too, then, is a form under which the Eternal reveals itself or realizes itself, and the complete cognition of truth is, in its essence, the very *life and self-presentation of the Idea in consciousness*. But if it is to be a complete cognizing, it must also show itself to consciousness and be had and possessed by the cognizing personality as what it thus is, so that it is cognized as being the Idea's own life in us—to which we should therefore, with willing mind, give ourselves over, to be its pure vessels or organs.

Remark and Supplement.

1. The point at which this form for the Eternal's revelation—belonging to the highest forms—enters and is beheld in its essential connection with, and its significance within, the whole (which whole exists in general only to serve the Eternal, so that the Eternal may come to a kingdom and dominion therein), is evident from the foregoing, where we have seen that a kingdom of freedom must come forth in order that a kingdom of love may come, but that the former in turn necessarily leads to an intelligence presenting itself as such—that is, coming to consciousness.

2. What the *truth* is whose votary the inquirer is to be now becomes entirely clear: namely, that here there is something quite other than a mere agreement between our representing and its objects, higher or lower. The truth, or the true, is that which *livingly produces this agreement*, in that it, itself working, determines the whole manner and formation of the representation. Precisely what gives things, forms, and relations themselves reality, or essentiality and truth, now shows itself to us (and has already earlier announced itself to us, in the Remark to § 7) as the very same that also, living again in us and in our conscious cognizing, gives the latter its reality. Truth itself, which now shows itself also to be, like virtue for example, the expression of an Idea, is to be the enlivening principle in our cognizing, just as virtue is to be it in our acting; and just as the latter is it under one form, so truth is, under another form, the Infinite and Eternal living—indeed, present—in us, whose organs we are to become by completely bringing its inner declaration to consciousness, clarity, and a powerful dominion in us, in inner utterances and productions. So that we too, in relation to nature and existence itself, are to take—and to take with clear and fully conscious cognition—everything that we have and possess in our cognizing at first hand. If, then, a reproduced image of the whole is to live again in us, and we, precisely thereby, to grow completely into, and together with, this whole, then in this we are nonetheless to have more than a mere image; we are therein at the same time to have the mighty influence and presence of the Eternal itself, which in that actual whole too is the true real and existing.

It goes without saying—though we will not omit to note it expressly—that what is here said must not be interpreted as though the meaning could be that, for example, the principle of gravity, or the effect manifesting itself in nature under the form of gravity, should now as such be assumed to be that which called forth our concept of it or our cognition of it. Whereas indeed the same One that entails—or demandingly and effectively posits—a gravity in the system of nature now also posits the concept of it in our system of understanding.

3. But what the (essential and genuine) true—what the very power of the Idea—thus

works in us is not, for that reason, at once cognized by force of the origin from which it in itself really comes. Because a cognition in itself proceeds from a life of the Idea in us, cognition does not for that reason yet take place by force of the cognition of the Idea; the objects are not for that reason yet seen in the Idea's light, come to the clarity of consciousness. Thus mathematics, for example, is indeed—as a science, and as the thought calling and bringing this science to consciousness—the expression of an Idea and a life of the Idea in us. But mathematical cognizing is nonetheless not a cognizing by force of Idea.

Even mere lower sensation, and wholly empirical apprehension and cognition, is to be regarded in the same way: as that which in itself comes about through the Infinite's own life and working in us—though it is so far from coming to consciousness as an expression of a higher life in us that it does not even seem to be worked from within, which, however, as an expression of our life, as a manifestation of life and a result of a life-activity, it cannot but be, as it already shows itself to be when the productivity by which it comes about is noticed. But the actual mover of this productivity, its determining First, can likewise now only be a life, or a proper—indeed inner—principle. And now all considerations lead to seeing a universal working—equally present in the outer as in the inner, and in both the one and the other all-determining—as the last and true ground of all lower sensation. See the author's *Psychologie*, § 58, p. 212.

§. 12.

If the Idea is to come to live as such in the individual by presenting itself as Idea in his cognizing, it must come forward as the governing and determining First, as the forming and ordering principle, in an aggregate of cognitions that come to constitute a coherent whole of cognition, in which the Idea—as it calls forth and determiningly develops it—presents itself. This presentation of the Idea by and in accordance with its own self-presentation—in which the Idea itself (as the more inward) is had and beheld in one with its (more outward) presentation—is science, genuine, complete science. The individual cognitions are *scientific* insofar as they are had and beheld as essentially belonging members in such a whole, and now therefore proceed from the inquiry and discernment by which such a whole is gradually sought to be brought about.

In science, then, not only *the One*—which is everywhere to be regarded as the essence, to which all is to be traced back and on which all depends—is cognized, but also the *manifold* thereby determined, in its infinite diversity; yet in such a way that everything in it is beheld both in its nearer or more distant relation to that One—indeed, in its greater

or lesser reality—and in its definite relation to all the rest, with which together it makes up the full presentation of the Idea, and moreover at its definite place in the coherent whole. So that in complete science these three—*Idea*, *system*, and *detail*—are inseparable.

To such science *all* cognition is to be developed; *every* cognition is to be a scientific cognition in this way.

For—this is the first point—if the Idea is to be beheld as Idea in its truth, it must necessarily be beheld as that which gives essentiality; indeed, it must be beheld in one with that to which it gives this essentiality, or beheld as the determining and all-illuminating element in that other, which has its reality by it; otherwise the Idea would not be beheld in its full truth, for it belongs to its essence to give and determine essentiality. Next: if the whole aggregate of individual objects that present themselves to us, and at whose investigation our striving aims, is to be cognized in its truth—or cognized fully, as it is—and if it is now something only with respect to the Eternal, and has significance only through its relation to this, then it must also be beheld in its relations to this, and in this relativity of its; but if all else is thus to be determined and illuminated with respect to that Eternal and by the Idea of this Eternal, then this Idea too must now show itself as the all-illuminating and all-determining element in this whole manifold sphere of cognition—and then this sphere must also, by the power of that Idea, be formed into a whole of cognition, in which the Idea will then show itself as the all-real and all-filling. To behold the individual members or parts in their truth belongs not only that the real essence which is their true ground be beheld in them, or that they be beheld in relation to this, but also that the necessity of understanding—indeed, the connection of thought—be seen, in accordance with which that highest being comes, besides all else, also to lead to precisely such a particular's acquiring reality; for only thereby does this particular come to its reality at all. But the individual member cannot be seen in its place and in its relativity except in that a whole systematic cognizing, embracing at the same time all members connected with it, comes about.

Remark and Supplement.

In science the Idea comes forward in an *Other*, in which Other it now shows itself to be the truth, or to be the true and the essence. Indeed, it first shows itself truly as Idea when it shines forth as the true in the Other whose truth it is.

It is thus, to be sure, subjected to an *opposition*, and regarded as one that is seen in its truth and significance only in such an opposition. Even when we speak of the Idea in and for itself, in its purity, we think of it as over against the Other, above which it is to raise itself in order to be seen in its purity. But it cannot be otherwise at all; for already,

in presenting itself to consciousness, there is here something besides itself—namely, the consciousness to which it comes—so that it already so far at once comes forward under relation, and this all the more because our beholding necessarily goes in one with a productivity, and this productivity, in which our own life expresses itself, at once enters into all the relations to which our life in general is subjected. Because we ourselves belong to that Other in which the Idea comes forward, we cannot have it entirely without any accession of this Other. So that the expression “the Idea in its purity” can have only relative validity. But this relative validity it does have. As the Idea shines forth through the Other, we must nonetheless behold it itself as something other than this Other through which we behold it; and in that we, as far as possible, see both in their opposition, we see them each on their own—indeed, we see the Idea too in its purity, as it were separated out from the Other from which it shines forth.

§. 13.

The first thing in genuine and complete science, the true real and substantial in it, by which alone all its manifold first has any significance, is the *Idea*. As the self-constituting and self-realizing living principle, it is to run through science and live in it, and thereby bear the whole; therefore to meet us everywhere in science as a true center, or to be that to which every point in it points. As the spirit in the whole of science, as that by which everything in it first finds its truth and reality, it is not to be sought in these or those principal concepts or principal propositions alone; only the whole science in its infinite completion would be its adequate expression—so far, that is, as what has determinate form can express or utter the true infinite, which moreover lives above all form in pure spirituality and freedom. Nor is the Idea present in any uttered whole, as in a finished work, otherwise than in the active life by which this work, this expression of it, is constantly brought about anew and brought forth or created, or constantly reproduces itself. *Not in standing results*, but in that which brings it about that such results *come forth*, do we have the Idea and the true rational element in cognition.

In referring everything determinate—everything that shows itself with a determinate form and as a determinate Something—to the Infinite and Eternal, as to the Absolute, from which all consideration must proceed and to which it must return, the *philosophical* element in cognition shows itself; and since everything is thus to be referred to the Absolute, all cognizing must strive to become a philosophical one. Insofar as here an immediate glimpsing and beholding of this Absolute everywhere lies at the foundation, there everywhere enters here a *speculation*. The speculative shows itself in this: that,

in the course of this referring and determining, the same single Absolute, as the all-embracing and all-being, everywhere stands before the eye of the spirit in its wholeness and infinite significance—as that which, while it determines and, as it were, assigns to all things their relative essentiality, is itself above all form and constitutes the formless and invisible center toward which all directions point, but which comes to visibility only by being that to which all else is referred. Speculation is here a pure beholding; for what, as the utterly first and immediate, is had only in being beheld as the enlivening principle and essence in all else can be cognized only in that it is now directly posited and seen as the immediate being, as the essence in the forms which by it become its expression—just as the life in the organism must be directly beheld as the first real being in it.

From the Idea there indeed necessarily proceeds a discernment and comprehension. But the cognition of the Idea is nonetheless no discernment and comprehension. For the latter already presupposes that what is considered is beheld in a certain connection and determined in a certain way in accordance with a connection—so that it is already seen in relations and as a member in a chain. Meanwhile, concept is essentially bound up with every Idea, and as the Idea comes forward in science, it comes forward in a system in which everything is concept at every point, so that now the Absolute itself (as was noted earlier) comes to stand as a member—as the first and foremost, to be sure, but still always as a member. But in and under the discernment thus proceeding, and the conceptually correct deriving and determining, the Idea is then had not in this foremost member, but had as that which—just as, in the manifold considered, it is the single real essence that comes forth from it in its unity—thus becomes for us the soul in our whole deriving and determining. Cognition is an ideal beholding, which is had as the foundation in a living infinite thinking, in which the Absolute constantly—while it mediates itself in a manifold—shows itself in its pure, immediate absoluteness.

Remark and Supplement.

1. By the cognition of the Idea, and the illumination it gives, the manifold *detail* of individual cognitions—apprehended empirically or found out through reflection, more or less deep-reaching—first *truly benefits us*, because thereby we first see what we really have in them. So far, the Idea is that on which everything first depends, that which is first to be striven for. But on the other side, in turn, the exact study of the manifold detail is that by which the Idea first truly benefits us. A certain immersion in the philosophical—under which the individual and particular is regarded only as a means and vehicle for the consideration of the Idea, and certain principal truths or principal propositions, with their all-sided consideration, are chiefly brought forward—is, on the one side, just

as important in academic study as, on the other side, the exact re-examination of the material and the detail in its whole extent.

2. Just as wisdom consists in knowing what has unconditional worth, what has only conditional worth but still has worth, and what has no worth at all or only a slight one, and in now keeping this in view in all judgments and actions and determining these in accordance with it—so philosophy shows itself in cognizing and knowing what has absolute essentiality, what has only a relative being and essentiality, and what, finally, has none, or has it only as semblance, or at least in the lowest sense—and in now, accordingly, resolving all scientific questions, so that it is discerned *what* each thing, with respect to the highest being, can properly be said *to be*. Although this can indeed not happen without seeing every thing in its place in a scientific whole—and all philosophical grounding and determining therefore necessarily has regard to such a whole—still genuine and deep philosophy shows itself not only in the execution or possession of a scientific system, but can also lay itself open and step forth with living power and clarity in the way in which singly given questions are treated and individual cases are considered and judged. Indeed, this immediately *judicious* element—in which philosophy comes to view in a more practical way than in the system, though as yet only in the domain of cognition—belongs essentially to the appearance of a genuine philosophy. Philosophy shows itself so far in a certain *scientific way of thinking and judging*; indeed, even when it comes forward in a certain systematic aggregate of determinate cognitions, it is had not in these, but in the living thinking and beholding that has called them forth and can constantly call them forth anew in other expressions and under new turns—so that here too the same must show itself as in that immediate, free judicious element.

3. What speculation, and the beholding for which the Idea constantly stands in its totality, as the One and all from which everything proceeds and to which everything returns, is in the scientific respect—that, in the merely personal and individual respect, is this: to have an *ideal* in view, to bear an ideal within oneself, and to be inspired by and for it. The ideal is here the utterly completed science, as the full, no-longer-deficient presentation of the Idea, in which everything would be beheld in its infinite connections and significances. To such an ideal we look in the midst of the deficiency of what has been attained, in order to strengthen ourselves, under our piecemeal working and determining, by the glance toward the perfect—to which, after all, the imperfect we already have points, and whose reality we already behold and, as it were, possess in advance, in that we find ourselves on the way to it.

4. But how, then, is concept different *from Idea*, as regards the way in which both

come forward and are had? For a concept too is had in a genuine way only as the moving and determining First and Ideal in the judgments in which it is expressed. In these judgments it is to be sought neither in the subject nor in the predicate, but in the fundamental thought in accordance with which such a subject is joined with such a predicate; indeed, a concept is expressed not in one but in many judgments—from one alone, but first from many, it shines forth as that from which these judgments proceed, yet which, as it were, hovers freely over them. How, then, is Idea still something other than concept?

The concept aims at the particular member, which is thought as it is thought because the concept itself—as the fundamental thought that determines the member's real significance and its mode of existence—determines how it is to be thought; and since its real significance rests on relations and is determined with respect to relations, which can be innumerable and vary in many ways, the concept therefore now becomes the ruling and determining fundamental thought for a multitude—indeed, an innumerability—of determinations; and we also see why it so often turns out that the selfsame thing can be subsumed, and from another side again cannot be subsumed, under one and the same concept, why stringent definitions are often so difficult, if not unattainable. But insofar as here only *one member*, a certain particular, is considered in its real significance and now determined according to its relations (though it is precisely this relativity of its real significance that brings it about that the determination runs out into an innumerability of determinations, which can vary incessantly, and in which the only constant is that the judgment in every individual case turns out as it turns out)—insofar there is here, although there is something ideal as determining First, still only a concept. If, by contrast, in the given particular there is also beheld the not merely determining but also really *active First*, which brings it about that such a thought everywhere, in its relations, comes to real actuality—or which sets the concept into reality—then we behold the Idea therein. But now the concept is realized not only in the things we consider; in ourselves too these determining fundamental thoughts arise. In this, then, the Idea too is present. That which brings it about that such a concept comes to life in us, that which enlivens the concept now moving in us in its particular sphere—this is the Idea. That, too, is why only those concepts which aim at objects beheld as members in the whole and considered in this their conjunction with everything else show themselves as organic centers for an innumerability of determinations and judgments; mathematical concepts do not have this character; in mathematics each form is seen entirely isolated on its own, and there is no question there of real significances. Where these are kept in view, one at once

looks toward a whole; but in the cognition of the relativity that thereby everywhere shows itself, there stirs of itself a sense of the Absolute. If it comes to cognition what it is that brings it about that we determine and judge and discern as we do by force of the concept, then we are already led into a system and are now also brought to glimpse that from which all system proceeds, in which all system hangs; and then we already see the Idea, as that which reveals itself at the individual point through the concept—and the cognizing that was in itself already an expression of the Idea's life in us now becomes a cognizing by force of the cognition of the Idea.

§. 14.

As the purely speculative would express itself in a scientific whole, the *dialectical* enters, which is the expression of speculation itself as it sets itself in relation to the manifold, determining this and forming it after itself. Dialectic enters in the transition of the Idea and of speculation to the development of a systematic whole. It thereby comes forward at once and in one: first, in a *negative* way, as a dissolution and annihilation of all the modes of representation that fix themselves at lower standpoints, insofar as these—perhaps even naturally, indeed necessarily—have taken on the stamp of a significance, indeed an absoluteness, that did not belong to them; but then, secondly, at the same time in a *positive* way, as that which precisely, in showing things together with their concepts in their relative invalidity or nothingness, *eo ipso* shows them in their relative significance or somethingness, and thus leads to assigning them their place and to carrying out, or *constructing the scientific whole*, in which everything is seen in its relations, and moreover seen as it should be seen. So that the dialectical—as that which proceeds from the Idea, beheld and had as the pure substantial in cognition—precisely because it exposes the nothingness with which everything named as something determinate in reality (and not only the objects but the concepts themselves) is afflicted, and thus, as it were, shakes the fixed assumptions in their foundation, at the same time also leads to assigning them their relative validity and establishing them in it.

Remark and Supplement.

1. Dialectic shows itself here as an *art*: first, insofar as it consists in the movement of thought, or advance in thinking, by which the Idea is in fact made to hold with respect to a Something which—though it is first to be determined and illuminated by the Idea—has nonetheless, independently of it, presented itself in its manifoldness and fixed itself, each on its own, with a significance, indeed an absoluteness, which, when it is now to be

warranted before the philosophical consideration that is to appraise and determine its title, cannot hold up. But since nothing can be thoroughly shown in its invalidity without its also being seen whether and how far it is, in its sphere or in its relations, nonetheless something that has not without reason entered, or come to be named along with the rest as something particular on its own, this *philosophical art of annihilation*—which, unlike skepticism, does not have a merely negative aim, but sets out to annihilate all the lower understanding's modes of consideration in order to put the highest cognition of reason as the sole valid one in their place—will at the same time necessarily and essentially go in one with the philosophical, scientific art of construction.

Just as in the organic world the incessant change is a necessary consequence of life's uninterrupted living in its material (see the author's *Psychologie*, § 5), but now also points to, and bears witness to, life's inner power, bound by no form, so *the relative*—and what is therefore incessantly determinable otherwise, never exhaustible in determinate expressions and propositions—is, in all philosophical cognition, a necessary consequence of the Absolute's absoluteness, and of the fact that the Other in which the Absolute comes forth is never the Absolute itself; but this relativity without end then also points to this Absolute, and from the dialectical movements of thought (in the usual negative sense) the cognition of the Absolute must therefore always emerge strengthened. Even if the selfsame can be both affirmed and denied of the selfsame (if, to take simple examples, matter can be said both to be something on its own and not to be something on its own; if it can be said both that the concept of several virtues has reality and has no reality), we nonetheless have the positively valid in that which brings it about that we must thus both affirm and deny; and when we rightly see how, precisely in affirming, we must deny, and vice versa—or how we see the affirmation in its validity only when we at the same time see the validity of the denial—then we have, precisely in this discernment, the Idea, or the immediate Absolute, under this its appearance. And a direct consequence is now to seek the union in a deduction of the concept, in which the concept is beheld at its *relative* place with its relative validity; and the dialectical movement of thought thus directly points to, and leads to, the scientific construction.

2. In dialectic the *logical* and the *metaphysical* go in one; and it has often been noted that in the ancients' division into dialectic, physics, and ethics, the first stands in place of both the logic of later times and its metaphysics, or at least its ontology. A speculative logic (not a merely observing, reflecting, and describing doctrine of logical forms) is seen in the dialectical in its practical appearance in investigations in which given concepts are thought through and determined with respect to the highest true, which highest true

is the object of metaphysics; so that both in this respect, and insofar as a speculative logic itself has the cognition of this highest true for its basis, the metaphysical goes in one with the logical. If that which is in living movement in the dialectical is made the object of a special attention, logical cognitions could spring from it.

3. The dialectical, in the ordinary sense—namely, in its negative direction—sets out to contest and abolish, or at least to refer back within the proper relations and limitations. First it turns against such *modes of representation* as may have formed and fixed themselves, in humanity's endeavor to fathom and cognize, with a validity that cannot belong to them. Next it is directed at the very *objects* given for intuition, or at the representations necessary to the human being in the sphere of immediate real intuition. The highest, finally, is that it turns against *the concepts themselves*—namely, the necessary concepts, especially those obtained a priori—and shakes even these through in such a way that their validity comes to confirm itself only through an insight into their relative invalidity. Which last cannot but be the aim of a dialectical endeavor; but this is what Plato (see his *Parmenides*, p. 129), while laying particular weight on it, also finds especially difficult.

§. 15.

The Idea's execution in a complete presentation, in which everything is beheld in its place and in its significance—indeed, in its truth—in accordance with the Idea and by force of the cognition of the Idea, leads to a *system*, and scientific cognizing now becomes a *systematic* one. In the execution of the system the Idea must stand its *test*, whether it can now show itself everywhere as the real and can, in the particular, furnish and fulfill what it, as Idea, should be able to furnish and accomplish. That all cognizing ought to be systematic is clear enough, since only in a system can everything be seen in its relative place and in its relations, whereas everything is precisely only what it is, and has its significance, in its relations and at its place.

Such a system is now necessarily carried out in and by *concepts* and thereby itself becomes a system of concepts; for since in it everything is to be seen in its connection and determined with respect to this connection, as it shows itself in accordance with this connection, cognition becomes throughout a cognition of connection and of the objects' real significations and forms of appearance, or fundamental forms, thereby determined—so that everywhere every point is determined as it is determined in accordance with a discernment and comprehension; indeed, even the object of fundamental cognition, the Idea, must now (as already noted earlier) enter as a member—namely, the foremost

member—into the whole, quite as if it, though the highest object, were nonetheless only a certain particular object as well, like the rest and alongside them. But although the Idea must thus itself come forward as a concept, it must nonetheless at the same time be seen as the all-real that runs through the whole system, and presents itself in, and shines forth from, every point, as we have earlier sought to show. If, then, the Eternal is seen as the real essence in and under the many fundamental forms—if the Idea is beheld and had as the all-determining and everywhere really working element that, through that system of concepts, presents itself, in its unity yet under many shapes—then it becomes evident how, in science (as in real actuality), the Idea, its unity unimpaired, can come forth in a *plurality of fundamental forms*, in each of which it shows itself in a new shape, and that one can now speak of a *plurality of Ideas*. How the Idea is only one and is not itself several, and yet again so steps out into several that several Ideas can be named, becomes clear when the Idea is seen as that which externalizes itself in a system which, so far as it is derived from the Idea, is its expression, and in which, therefore, in every form thereby determined the Idea itself must be beheld again—but beheld again as in many effects and principles hypostatizing or constituting themselves on their own, with just as many corresponding distinctive individualizations, hence as in many Ideas. These then, each in its sphere, show themselves as the all-real and absolute, on which everything depends, from which everything proceeds and into which everything returns, and now also step out into a *plurality of sciences*. But this all-reality and absoluteness of a given Idea is nonetheless only such as holds with respect to everything belonging under this Idea's sphere—so that it is only a relative absoluteness.

The Idea's life then shows itself, under the form of cognition and science as well as under that of real actuality, as an *organizing* one which—in becoming the determining principle for a manifold aggregate of individual cognitions that are distinct, yet in their distinctness and relative opposition closely connected—now also, in thus giving this aggregate its whole shape, at the same time itself takes shape therein. The stringent, sharp, and rigorous element that is in all life which organizes itself and, moreover, fixes itself in a distinctive form in a determinate way, then also comes to view here.

Remark and Supplement.

1. Although the Idea can indeed come forward livingly in the free *judicious* element, still even therein a system—at least certain basic features of one—must be had *in mind and in view*; and if the particular is to be determined in an exact way and fully seen in its significance, then the reflection will necessarily enter into an investigation of a

comprehensive connection on all sides, and it will soon be felt that only a total working-out of all the many considerations set in motion, into a well-connected whole, can bring one to the exact determinations that alone can satisfy.

To genuine scientific endeavor there belongs, therefore, not only interest and respect for the matter itself that is to be expressed, or for the content of cognition, but also for the form in which it is to express itself, and a careful, indeed scrupulous, reflection on at what place and in what connection each individual point is to be presented, so that there may be definiteness in the particular, order and sequence or consistency in the whole. A certain *logical enthusiasm* must proceed from, and accompany, the enthusiasm for the Idea. The former is of the same source as the latter. In order that the Idea may enjoy its full right and show itself in its full power and totality in the presentation, form too becomes so important.

2. But only as the Idea's essential and necessary expression and becoming-real is the system what it is. Therefore the free judicious element, as well as the dialectical, must go before the system and prepare its way. Otherwise the systematic tendency easily leads to the forming of *opinions*—in order, after all, to bring the manifold that has been set in motion, the many isolated cognitions that have been attained, to a certain unity and wholeness—which, though hypothetical at first, gradually captivate and ensnare. The development of a system must therefore not be *hurried*.

The system must, further, also be kept perpetually alive in all its parts, or in *living movement*, by the fact that these are constantly beheld, as they are beheld, or posited, as they are posited, by force of the Idea, which then, in incessant reproduction, calls them forth anew. Hereby the many individual cognitions are first held fast in such a way that, preserving themselves in constant freshness, they are now also each time seen in their truth—which they do not have or show at all in their isolation, or in their merely systematic conjunction with the other members, but only in their connection with the Idea, as those which belong to its living total expression.

3. Two things are here to be feared and forestalled. First, the *nebulism* (to use a word Goethe adopted in judging artists) that merely keeps the form, or the system, in a certain haze, out of which it only glimmers forth in indeterminate outlines, in a certain generality, without the particular being exactly determined, so that there comes to be no firm bearing in the whole. The desire to behold the Idea at once in its great totality sometimes even leads to a certain rapturous enthusiasm, in which only certain cognitions take on a more or less settled shape, while the greater part is had only quite loosely, and large gaps are filled out by a dim fantasizing, so that the eye may at least be gratified by

the semblance of a whole. Next, one must watch that the systematizing does not end in a *crystallization*, whereby in the end only a dead substrate remains, which once bore an Idea and was the expression of its living movements, but is no longer filled by it. If the system is to continue to be what it, in its truth, is—and moreover ought to be—then it must be preserved under constantly new formations, in which it is constantly reborn, in that it then also constantly transforms itself and comes forth with new determinations, until, at certain stages of development, it even ripens into a metamorphosis, in which it passes over, out of a form developed up to a certain point and so long, with good reason, held fast, into another.

Yet even without a system's thus crystallizing—even if, under a constantly living influence of, and reciprocal action with, the fundamental thought from which it proceeded, it keeps itself in the most living movement—it can easily lead to *one-sidedness*, and so ensnare and bind that, since everything is finally seen only in the light of this one system, it does not even enter into the new considerations that might lead it to be reborn in a new shape, by taking up something new into itself with respect to the first fundamental thoughts. And for this, room, or freedom of spirit and willingness, should always be kept open. For since we behold *the One* on which everything depends only *so far as*, or in the measure in which, we see it as one and all in the corresponding whole, cognition must not only be able constantly to expand and become more inward and powerful with respect to the manifold that is more and more penetrated by the Idea, but the Idea itself must, in the course of this, be able constantly to show itself not merely in a clearer, but also in a different light; and thus cognition, precisely by expanding in the one direction, must be driven constantly to seek a new—namely, a more primitive and more all-sidedly referring—*first starting-point*; so that, therefore, along with the manifold, the fundamental cognition and the fundamental principle itself—that is, the way in which the fundamental principle is seen and grasped—must be able to undergo a constant *reformation*. And therefore that free, immediate *judicious* element—just as it must precede the system and prepare for it—must also *follow upon it*, when one now goes from the system to the manifold detail. As important as a definite system is, so necessary is it to be able, to a certain degree, to free oneself again from the system's bonds and let the Idea move freely, independently of the form in which it has sought to come to a definite shape. To this belongs that we, in living reciprocal action with the phenomenon or the problem itself, let it exercise its power over us to lead us wherever it will, and let it itself call forth in us the thought by which light is to be brought into it—which, however, doubtless presupposes that there is a fund of thought from which the new

thought, that is now to correspond to the thing as the thing itself points to it, can spring. True interest and love for the matter, and a desire to fathom it as it is, will lead one to let the relation of reciprocal action between what we have and are, and the new particular we are to consider, become as it should be, so that a free glance learns whether the new datum must go straight into, and, as it were, be assimilated by, the system—so that the system cannot thereby be brought to any transformation of significance—or whether its influence must be such that the system thereby comes to move back into itself and, to a certain degree, to loosen itself out of its fixed state, in order, in assimilating the new, to advance in its own developmental process and, in consequence of this reception, itself to undergo a transformation, be it only in one single respect. In particular, the endeavor to bring what has been cognized to others—when it becomes really important to us to convince them, and we are therefore compelled to enter into their trains of thought—can work against the one-sidedness to which the development of a system easily leads, against the bonds it can lay on free thinking. In general, reciprocal action with others—and with several different thinking beings, whether under a mutually living communication in intercourse, or under the study of the works of different authors, or of the history and historical development of a science—cannot but be of importance in this respect.

4. A complete system (that is, one come to a certain degree of completion) lays itself open *practically* by the fact that every concept and every object of investigation is seen exactly in its connections with all the other concepts and objects set in motion along with its consideration, and that the course of the Idea can be carried from every point straight up to the highest, from which, as the fixed starting-point, everything proceeds, and can be carried on all sides, so that the individual point considered can thereby be set entirely in its proper light and fixed in its relations and with its significance. Insofar, now, as all the principal points in a science are seen in this clarity and connection, a whole system can already shine forth—in sure and manifold features all referring to one fundamental form—from the treatment of the individual questions that arise, and from the way of judging and determining the concepts on the whole, without its yet being had expressed in the systematic form. To deliver the system as system in an outward scientific *presentation* can itself, even if it is already thus practically possessed, have its great difficulties. In particular, the order and sequence in which everything is to be presented can cause many scruples and doubts. The illuminating and grounding element ought indeed to stand in front; but since everything individual, as in an organic whole, rests in the Idea—while this in turn is had only in the execution of the whole system,

and becomes evident in its full truth only when it shines forth from the whole scientific aggregate of cognitions as the true in them—every individual cognition really rests in the whole system itself, which nonetheless, when it is to be presented, can be built up only by the individual cognitions gradually joined to one another; and just as the thinker who would express the system already has the whole system in view at every point and sees the individual in the whole, so too, in the presentation, at the individual points—indeed, already at those with which it begins—the whole total cognition should come forward livingly and be set before the beholder's eye. But this cannot happen in a presentation that can only be given member by member. Something must be taken first and placed in front. Indeed, this cannot even be the fundamental cognition, which must first arise before our eye and ground itself as fundamental cognition before it can be set up as such; nor can it, as that without which the whole is not seen in its true light, come last. One must be led up to it, and then it must enter as that from which the whole system is now to proceed. As regards, too, the many individual cognitions springing from the fundamental cognition, which become the manifold members of the system, it will not seldom turn out that the one must already be had and presented merely in order to be able *to arrive at* the other, but that this other in turn must be *presented* before the first can be seen in its *full truth and significance*. Indeed, not only individual cognitions and propositions, but *whole courses of Ideas* (even whole sciences) can stand in such a relation to one another that, while each of them demands to be worked out and presented on its own in its direction and in its sphere, the one nonetheless can neither be fully grasped nor become entirely evident without presupposing the other—and that mutually. In such cases the systematic arrangement brings great difficulties with it.

It then becomes necessary *to take from a certain side* what in itself, however, does not proceed from this one side, or raise this side up in itself more than the others. But just as from this is seen *the possibility of several procedures or methods* that can make an equal claim to groundedness and worth, so from it too it becomes evident how, in the same science, *several scientific systems* can be set up alongside one another, without any of them being able to claim sole validity or a decided superiority in all respects—and that even if, as regards the scientific content on the whole, agreement prevails.

5. Genuine system is only that to which we come from the Idea and by the Idea, in that the Idea is considered as it expresses itself in a certain aggregate of detail, the extent and kind of which detail is then determined by the Idea itself. But also when an aggregate of particulars is given to us on its own (in an empirical way) and becomes the object of an observation aimed at beholding it as it once for all offers itself, without its yet being

cognized in the light of the Idea, the endeavor will always be to order this aggregate of observations, or observed forms, and the (merely formal) common concepts formed about them—or genus- and species-concepts—into a system, into a comprehensive survey. But here too the philosophical endeavor can and should show itself *partly* in the way in which a certain ideal of such a classification, with respect to what it is by its purpose to furnish, is constantly kept in view, *partly* in the way in which, in its execution, a higher consideration is worked toward. (Cf. § 6, Remark 2, at the end.)

6. The necessity of a system in science follows so directly from the fact that nothing individual can be seen in its proper light without being exactly seen in its relations and its connection with everything connected with it, that no exception can find place there. One science, however, seems to make an exception—a science that, when its *presentation* is in question, is regarded rather as an art: *history*. But events too are seen, like everything else, in their proper full light only when they are seen in their often many-sided connection with others—partly contemporaneous, partly preceding and following—and characters too must be seen in their times and at their places. So that the same grounds that elsewhere demand the systematic in cognition also clearly show themselves here; but what elsewhere, in other sciences, has another form and is called system, is here the *historical composition*.

§. 16.

A system can take place, an Idea can express itself, only in a manifold aggregate of individual cognitions which, as the parts or members of the scientific whole, can also be considered each on its own, and so far be taken as special cognitions. These then make up the *detail* essentially belonging to all science, whose exact study is of the highest importance. Only when a concept is seen carried through, an Idea seen as the real essence, in the whole manifold of objects down to its smallest parts or remotest species—so that everything in that manifold is comprehended in accordance with the concept and seen in the Idea's light and as its expression, or at least as something in which the Idea too is the real essence—is the concept and the Idea itself fully grasped. Only in the manifold concrete does the Idea show itself in its full power, as the truly all-determining, and only in the thorough investigation of the detail does the cognition of the Idea undergo its full test. In the exact study of the detail there shows itself the *spirit of observation* needful to the development of all science.

But could a special study of the detail on its own be conceived, *prior to*, or at least *separated from*, the Idea and the concepts, and then come to meet these? How could

such a thing be possible? Insofar as the special cognitions are to be genuinely scientific—whereby the particular is cognized in its truth—and moreover to be intelligent cognitions, they can be had only as consequences of, and by force of, Idea and concept; they are then precisely the appearances of these in, or determinations with respect to, the particular, and the study of the detail can then be nothing other than the complete execution of the cognition of the Idea and the concept itself; it consists, then, precisely in the pursuit of the fundamental cognition into all the many different particulars, or special cases, that are to be subsumed under the fundamental cognition and are to be illuminated and determined by it. Observation can therefore here be fruitful only in an *indirect* way: partly in that it notices and brings forward the special *questions and problems* that now await their resolution from intelligent cognizing by force of the concept, partly in that it directs attention to the many cases in which what has been cognized can find *application*—an application that, however, must now take place in accordance with the insight coming from elsewhere. Insofar, by contrast, as—as in the sphere of the empirical, prior to all clear insight and intelligent cognition—the results of Idea and concept can be given as uttered results of an intelligence which, however, is thereby not yet immediately given as such, because it has as yet presented itself only in its consequences, a special observing study of a given detail can, in a more *direct* way, lead to genuine scientific cognition, in that the fundamental forms of things, their connections and relations, and the concepts and laws expressed in them are now investigated as they make themselves known in the things themselves. And here, then—although here too it is an intelligent cognizing that matters, since an intelligence presenting itself in the given things is to be fathomed—the *special study of the detail* becomes of such great importance and essentiality.

Remark and Supplement.

1. How the *spirit of observation*—indeed, empiricism—can be of importance for such sciences in which nothing is to be, or can be, abstracted from experience, for example in *mathematics*, and also in *philosophy*, even the most speculative, will become clear from what has been set forth. To be sure, the consequences of a mathematical proposition and its applications in various special cases can only be *seen* by being *discerned* in accordance with the proposition itself, and cannot, moreover, be simply apprehended and observed as something immediately given or found. But in the *attention* to everything that can be derived from a proposition, and to the various possible combinations in which what has been cognized can be seen under distinctive modifications or in special forms, a certain mathematical spirit of observation can show itself and much advance the development of the science. The empirical, next, merely sets the mathematician

problems; but an attentiveness to such problems—possible only on the presupposition of a manifold study of empirical objects—together with an exact determination of the questions whose answering the natural scientist expects of the mathematician, has not seldom called forth mathematical investigations that would otherwise scarcely have arisen, indeed significant extensions of the mathematical disciplines; and thus even a spirit of observation moving in the sphere of the empirical can become fruitful for a wholly non-empirical science. We will only recall one of the most recent examples: *crystallography*.

In philosophy too the same holds, and similar considerations can be made about it. The questions that experience can put, for example, to philosophical *ethics*—a science whose propositions, down to the most special, cannot, since these too are to express an “ought,” be drawn from experience—often call forth considerations that become fruitful for ethics. Indeed, the retroactive influence of such considerations and investigations—arisen through attentiveness to empirically given relations and their manifold modifications—reaches even back to the first principles, or to the whole fundamental cognition, which indeed rests on no empiricism, but to whose deeper, more determinate, and more comprehensive grasp we are nonetheless often prompted, indeed guided, by attention to, and reflection on, the many empirical objects in which it is to bring light and insight, or over which it is to exercise its dominion.

Already in this respect, then, a certain *philosophical spirit of observation* can show itself. But also in yet another respect entirely. The content of philosophical cognition is given to us in yet another way and by another path than in the (scientific) form of philosophical cognition and by the scientific path: namely, through a certain immediate sensation or feeling, *a feeling for truth* (to which we also reckon the aesthetic and the moral feeling). In this there shows itself the Infinite and Eternal announcing itself in us, the Idea, in its more *real* effects, referring itself to our subjectivity, our well-being, or our personal situation: from this the immediate faith that announces itself independently of scientific consideration, and likewise a certain immediate tact or discernment (the immediate judicious element mentioned earlier), has its origin, and only thereby is it possible. But not in its generality—only in its special manifestation with respect to something individual and concrete—does the general and universally valid Idea show itself in this immediate feeling for truth, which is not yet entirely clear to itself. In it, then, there is something with which the scientific development of the Idea, when it is carried out, can and often will meet. It meets here with itself, with its own special self-announcements, but in a quite different form than in scientific derivation and inference.

And so here there is a *detail* that can become the object of a special heedfulness, and with respect to which the Idea (the scientifically expressed Idea) can undergo a test and find a confirmation.

2. All genuine and living love for the Idea, and joy in it, gives birth of itself to an *interest and joy in the detail*, a desire to pursue the particular down to its smallest parts or most special modifications, in order fully to behold and appropriate the intelligent through the empirical, the general through the special; indeed, this desire to pursue the particular belongs essentially to the testimony of a true vocation for a given science; whereas to despise the detail testifies to a lack of genuine sense and feeling for the Idea, to whose essence it precisely belongs to come forward as the all-determining in its manifoldness, and whose power lets itself be seen only in its effects—so that we can attach ourselves to it and behold it only by attaching ourselves to that which bears its stamp and expression, and beholding it in this. When we ask ourselves how an inspired painter of the Dutch school could find joy in observing and studying so faithfully the reflections of light on a chair or a copper kettle under certain lightings, in order faithfully to reproduce it in his painting, the answer lies near at hand: it was precisely the light, the general, all-enlivening light, that gave him joy to behold and pursue in the countless nuances of its reflections on objects; the general light was what enlivened him in this study, and was what he wished to present in some of its countless effects. And when, in this way, a thinking mind with a sense for the highest has not seldom restricted itself to the exact and faithful study of a special object (an insect or a species of plant), it was because the whole mattered to him, and because he saw that for the sake of this whole it was necessary to study this individual object too. And when he studied the individual object with the spirit and tendency of contributing thereby to the highest and most general, he thereby also came to study the most general in the individual object, and in doing so to feel himself in living contact with the whole general, all-embracing, all-sustaining nature—and could now, in the thorough presentation of the individual object, also deliver something that, just as it could not have come about without a manifold regard to the whole of the rest of nature, could now also cast a light over a wide-embracing sphere. Even the most self-limiting study, as we have already said in the Remark to § 1, has its Muse.

§. 17.

In completed science the Idea comes forward, in and by means of a system, as that which illuminates and determines a detail, whether this latter is now given as an aggregate

of objects to be fathomed or as problems to be solved. All three belong essentially together, and, in the endeavor after complete cognition and in the development of the science, must all be kept in view—and that all three at once and together. The Idea, the all-illuminating and all-determining fundamental cognition, is indeed in itself the first; but it is had—not only in its full light, but also in the right way—only when it shows itself in the manifold in which it is the all-determining and all-illuminating; and thus, in order that the cognition of the Idea may take on a definite shape—even only so far that it can be grasped in such an expression that a scientific derivation can begin to run a firm course—the detail must already be studied to a certain degree, the system sketched out. But again, if the Idea had not already sprung forth before the glance and been grasped with a certain degree of definiteness, this preliminary sketching of the system, and the study of the detail that can become fruitful for the cognition of the Idea, would not be possible. And as regards the mutual relation between system and detail, the study of both stands in the same reciprocal dependence; for the particular cannot be studied in such a way that one can work toward a system unless a certain total connection already hovers before the beholder's eye, while the sketching of the system in turn presupposes an overview of all the individual members and parts that are to be seen in their connection in the system, set at their places, and seen in their relative significance.

Several paths, therefore, along which—or ways in which—one can come to the goal in a science can be conceived, and several can and must be combined with one another in the course of inquiry and elaboration. Thus, besides Idea, system, and detail, there is, in every science, with respect to the thinking being's striving, still *method* to be noted. Partly there must be a certain method in the study by which we ourselves work our way forward; partly such a method also shows itself in expressing what has been cognized in its connection and communicating it to others. In the latter respect, method and system stand in close connection with one another (see § 15, Remark 4); yet in communicating the same system—the same cognition or assumption with respect to the significance of all the parts, their connection, and their relations within a given scientific whole—one can nonetheless go different ways; one can, from different sides and in different ways, lead others into the scientific edifice, without the edifice itself being thought differently. And thus there is always a difference between system and the scientific method of presentation.

If, in a science, the ways in which one can proceed to reach one's goal, and the points one has to observe in doing so, are made the objects of a special reflection, then the consideration becomes a *logical* one; every science, therefore, can give occasion for

special logical considerations, in which the general logical element is brought forward for attention as it shows itself with respect to the particular inquiries and presentations that this science demands.

Remark and Supplement.

1. In general, the difference between the *analytic method* and the *synthetic* is to be noted. To the system—which, as it were, constitutes the center of scientific cognition, and gives it firmness and solidity—we can move from two sides. The genuine scientific procedure must, as that which proceeds from the Idea and derives a systematic whole from it, be *synthetic*; the same considerations that lead to discerning the necessity of a system also show the essentiality of the synthetic method. But for this, only a penetrating and comprehensive consideration of the detail—that is, an *analysis*—makes one sufficiently ripe; and that not only in the scientific study and presentation of empirical objects, but also in the pure philosophical sciences, in which the possibility of an analysis is discerned from the previous paragraph. Yet it must be well noted that analysis has genuine worth only when it constantly aims at a system—indeed, at a possible synthetic presentation of a whole—just as all thorough analysis also already bears in itself the germ of such a presentation. To behold and possess the Idea as the all-penetrating light—on this, after all, the highest cognizing depends; but then a deduction too must necessarily proceed from it. Meanwhile, the manifold that is to be illuminated must all the while be kept in view, so that the scientific derivation can now also really be carried down to it and be brought to bear upon it: the territory that is to be considered and surveyed from the higher standpoint, and in which we are to orient ourselves from this standpoint—indeed, which we are first truly to come to know by this consideration from above—must nonetheless first have been traversed down below in itself and in its individual portions. To forestall one-sidedness, a prior manifold and exact analysis is so important. Moreover, when a course of Ideas from above has led down to a definite point and led to a definite concept, only a glance at the world of experience itself can finally teach one to find in this world what corresponds to this concept; but then this given reality in experience must first have been exactly observed—indeed, made the object of analysis. In merely empirical sciences, analysis is the study of the letter in the book of nature, through which alone one can come to *its spirit*, its thoughts. But just as one has truly studied and grasped another book only when one has penetrated so far into its spirit and intelligent content that one can freely express this, proceeding from its fundamental thoughts, and can, by force of these, oneself carry out the whole again in an, as it were, reproduced presentation, so too nature is studied to the ground only when the possibility of a synthetic presentation

has been attained. In pure philosophical inquiries, analysis is really the *study of the Idea* itself (see § 16, Remark 1)—namely, as its light is reflected upon an individual special object, on which its power, significance, and fullness can not seldom show themselves and be observed very definitely, before it has shown itself clearly in and for itself, or in the scientific whole. —On a happy *combination of analytic and synthetic procedure*, therefore, so much depends, in study as well as in presentation.

2. Method is best developed, in a science, out of the science itself and its own historical course of development. Every inquirer finds the science developed to a certain degree and in a certain form, and no one can carry it further with power and effect without proceeding from the point at which it stands in his time. Even if genius can see far beyond it and cast forth a seed for new developments for centuries, still genius too must express the new in a definite relation to what exists. Since we are all definite members in humanity's whole developmental series, arising at definite points in that life of humanity which expresses itself and lives on through the centuries, we too must intervene in this life and contribute to the advancement of the great work from the point at which we are set. Otherwise the seed we may cast out will not correspond to the soil in which it is to fall; the impulse we give will not awaken the reaction, or continue itself in the propagation, without which it does not come to lead to what it should. The spirit that is to speak in us and through us should indeed be of the truth alone, and we should not let this spirit be bound by any age's existing scientific, or generally spiritual, condition. But since it is precisely to lead out of the existing condition in order to lead further forward—under constant rebirths, entering in their times, of the outward form in which it appears—the activity by which it is to accomplish this through the endeavors of individuals must, precisely in order to be able to lead to rebirths and transformations, refer itself in the most definite ways to what exists. But into what exists, only that thinker's activity can fully take hold who knows it fully; and know it fully can only he who has considered it in its coming-to-be. And thus, in every science, a *study of the science's history* becomes of such high importance.

§. 18.

In science the Idea steps out, in an ideal and universal way, into an outer form, and thereby comes to outer reality or existence. But in and through science it also comes to live in and for a consciousness and in personal beings; and thereby it first comes to *complete outer existence*, and now first comes forth as a might and power in real actuality. Here, in the souls themselves, we first see the stuff or material that is to be inspired and

enlivened by the Idea, so that free personal individualities become the organs for the Idea's living appearance and working, in which it is to take shape and come to dwell.

To this, then, the Infinite and Eternal itself, announcing itself in the Idea, presses and strives, so that it may come to a kingdom in humanity. And therefore it announces itself and *works its way forward*; not only does it present itself of and by itself—it also moves, seizes, and carries away. In this consists the *element of genius*, from which all higher cognizing necessarily proceeds.

Note. What might further be noted in this connection has partly already occurred in the foregoing; partly it can be read in the author's *Psychologie*, § 22 and the Remarks thereto, where geniality is treated at length.

§. 19.

If the Idea is to come to live as such in consciousness and to shine in and by its own truth, it cannot come forth and work in an instinctive way, but must enter in such a way that the self-conscious individual says to himself with clarity what it is that speaks in him, and that he now, with heedfulness toward it and reverence for it, lets it gain room and power within him, because he himself recognizes it as something to which he must open himself; so that the individual, although he indeed has it only insofar as he is seized by it, is nonetheless not seized blindly, but, with self-conscious clarity, with insight and freedom, lets himself be carried away and determined. Even if conviction is essentially an irresistible being-seized, it is nonetheless also a willing one, and it is a genuine conviction only when it is both in one. We must ourselves see the truth in its truth if a true cognition is to set in.

The Idea therefore necessarily refers itself to a *self-consciousness and freedom* and, in summoning it, sets a *self-thinking in motion*, in order, through this, to come to the life in the individual to which it is to come. We have already had occasion to note this earlier (§ 6, in the Remark).

The Idea therefore announces itself not only in a Something that presents itself of itself to consciousness, but also in a *drive and incitement*—namely, an incitement to draw forth, by one's own attention and reflection, that self-presenting Something before consciousness, and now to attain what the incitement points to and demands: in general, an incitement to something that is now, *in the individual himself*, or in the self-conscious personal life, *to follow*. See § 4, Remark 3.

The Idea therefore, in order to come to appear and live as Idea, *necessarily calls forth its own opposite*, and itself brings the Other in which it is to reveal itself in its truth—the

self-conscious personal life—to express itself as such and now to come to meet the Idea's own self-advancing influence.

Note. What might already here press upon us for closer consideration and further elaboration, and has not already come forward in the earlier Remarks, we bring more conveniently into connection with the considerations that the following §§ will call forth.

§. 20.

Self-thinking is set in motion by a *questioning*—and that (since freedom is to become conscious of itself as such, so that a willing devotion may follow) a questioning whose satisfaction is not given at once. But a question that lets itself be felt as such—a question whose answer must first be *sought*—sets one between *two*, of which *one is to be preferred*, and thus entails *the possibility of doubt*; and since the individual finds himself as one who can come only by his own determining and doing to the representation in which he is to bring the desired cognition to consciousness in himself and to have and possess it, doubt too comes to actuality.

An *assuming and not-assuming*—or, if it is really the true that has announced itself (of which, however, the individual must first come to assurance), a *cognition and non-cognition*—now stand opposed to one another. But if it then now comes to cognition, this takes on a quite different character, power, and significance than if the doubt and the ensuing struggle and trial had not been gone through; what determines to cognition, and that to which it determines, have now stepped apart from one another, and cognition now first fully becomes a cognition of truth by force of its truth, a cognition with insight and full assurance. An affirmation that proceeds from the denial of a negation or opposition—hence from a double negation—is indeed quite other than a direct assuming, in which no possibility of negation has yet stirred. Without this denial of the negation or opposition, life does not come (as Franz Baader, with reference to Hegel, says: *über die Ekstase*, zweites Stück, p. 6) *to ground itself*, nor even to open or to raise itself up. But without that negation's being awakened, it is (as he adds) indeed not possible to deny it again.

Remark and Supplement.

1. *The question* (namely, the fundamental questions from which the whole striving after cognition proceeds) arises of *itself*, because the higher life that is to come forth now also wills to come forth, and therefore, in the fullness of its time, also really announces itself and strives forward in the individual, who indeed exists at all only in order to become

the organ or vessel of this higher life. Therefore the fundamental concepts that underlie these questions and make them possible also come forth *a priori*, at least in obscure manifestations. But to *the answers* we come—even though these too must in the end be found, indeed be given—only by means of a striving and inquiry that is our own striving and inquiry. Why, is clear enough from the foregoing (§ 4, Remark 3, and several places). The drive shows itself, like every drive, both as the *drive of the universal* (a driving and urging on) in us, and as our own drive, our own longing and desire. The tendency is here too, at once and in one, a tendency to be more perfectly united with the general and universally valid, the all-real, and also a tendency to more perfect self-subsistence; and when we do not rest content with what is first given, it is a double incitement that drives us to seek more. The double striving comes to harmony when the one precisely wills to come forth in order that the other may fully find its fulfillment—when we strive after independence only in order to become the Idea's and cognition's complete organs, by becoming its independent ones.

2. The same thing that makes doubts possible also brings with it *the possibility of error*. Because, in our own seeking and striving, we are ourselves, with self-consciousness, to bring about cognition, we can make other determinations and form for ourselves other representations than the true ones—led to this by being determined by something other than what should rule, or by going further than its declarations go.

§. 21.

In the course of inquiry the individual strives after a cognizing to which he cannot come without himself striving for it and exerting himself for it. But everything now depends on whether, in the individual too, that follows which is to follow: first, whether the individual *really comes to cognize*—that is, not merely to learn and obtain information and knowledge, but also to know what is apprehended as valid, and to take it up and keep it with assurance of its truth; and next, whether this cognition becomes so living and penetrating that a fruitful self-thinking will proceed from it.

So far, the Idea's coming and self-announcement is a *testing*. Indeed, there is now also something *critical* in it; everything depends on what turn the effect takes, as now free self-thinking and testing—in general, one's own free doing—comes to meet it. It is this *periculum vitæ* that Franz Baader names (*Sätze aus der Bildungs- oder Begründungslehre des Lebens*, note to 6). Because the Idea is to shine by its own truth, in intelligence and freedom, its real effects in the individual in whom it would dawn can have only this character; but for that very reason everything depends on whether, in the individual, cognition and self-thinking now come or not.

But even though we can strive after cognition, seek and strive, we can as little give ourselves conviction itself as we can ourselves bring or give ourselves the truth: even the full truth—entirely evident and certain to other thinkers—can stand right before an individual without his yet seeing the truth in it and being seized by it, that is, without his yet being able to cognize what he nonetheless already knows. Precisely because cognition is to be truth's self-evidence by its own truth alone—hence by its own power—no one is able to give it to himself or to others. We can only work to *awaken*, or to bring to expression, what—constituting the whole existence of the rational being—is in each; but compel it to come we cannot.

Thus everything in the end rests on something that can be received only as, quite simply, a *gift and grace from the Lord*. He who, according to Paul (Phil. 2:13), works in us both to will and to accomplish, is also the only one who works in us to cognize.

If, then, there is on the one side something that is up to us, or set within *our power* (ἐστὶν ἐφ' ἡμῶν, Epict.), with respect to which we must show *moral strength* in diligence and endurance, honest love of truth, and careful vigilance, so there is on the other side something that *is not within our power* (τὰ οὐκ ἐφ' ἡμῶν), which we must meet with a *religious disposition*, a religious devotion to God's will and his ordering over us—a disposition that is to show itself both in calm waiting, patience, humility, and resignation, and also in trust and courage.

Remark and Supplement.

1. By *ourselves* we are to seek to cognize what is to be cognized. What is handed down, however correctly and definitely, does not become ours—does not come to genuine rebirth, new movement, and life in us, so that, because it rules in us in its truth, it can now speak and work again with its power out of us, and we become its true organs—unless it so seizes us and is discerned and cognized by us that a living conviction of it comes forth in us. It must gradually become as much our own as if we had come to it by ourselves alone and had drawn it from ourselves—that is, had received it immediately from the truth itself speaking in and for us. A consequence of this is that we, as it were, translate it for ourselves into our own language, expressing it for ourselves in a distinctive way.

How, in this, we withdraw from every other authority in order to subordinate ourselves solely and immediately to the highest authority, truth's own, we have already had occasion to note earlier (§ 6, Remark 1). If, on the one side, the assumption has no true worth when it does not proceed from one's own insight and free self-thinking, so, on the other side, it also has no worth when it is not truth itself that is cognized in it.

On the one side, self-thinking must necessarily go its own free course, and one should not will to arrive at any other goal than that to which clear reflection and one's own insight will of themselves lead. And yet, on the other side, the goal to which we are to come is necessarily prescribed; for if it is not the truth to which we come, then the whole endeavor is nothing—but truth is only *one*. It is here as with virtue, which shows itself in that we, with *willing* mind and living inclination (love), partly determine ourselves to, and partly find ourselves in, the *necessary*. We are to work forward as if it were indifferent to us at what goal we arrived, so long as it was a goal to which clear insight and real conviction had led us; and yet it cannot be indifferent to us whether our conviction and supposedly clear discernment agree with what is intrinsically true—whether it is from truth itself that our assurance stems. We must, in the end, indeed set ourselves at rest by saying that we have honestly striven and inquired and now cannot see or cognize anything other than what we assume; but no one could, in the scientific respect, set himself at rest thereby, unless there attached to it the thought: and that which I thus cannot but see and cognize is surely also in itself correct. In the religious respect there is, to be sure, yet another kind of reassurance.

The oppositions that are here to come to harmony—the two opposites being to meet, quite of themselves, in one—these oppositions are seen above all in theological study. The preacher and teacher of the Word is to speak the Word to hearts, and partly to call forth, partly to nourish, living faith and conviction. In him, therefore—since no one can speak to the heart without speaking from the heart—it is an essential requirement to be personally, livingly convinced of, and penetrated by, the truth of the Word he has to proclaim, the doctrine he has to teach. He can by no means, like the jurist, content himself with appealing to the fact that this is what is prescribed to him, and then, distinguishing between what is prescribed and his private opinion or judgment, hold the latter back. If the doctrine of Christianity—indeed, of the Church—is not, at least in all important and essential points, at the same time his own conviction, then he cannot without dishonesty take on the clergyman's vocation; he would also, by taking it on, entangle himself in an existence dangerous to himself, in that he would come to bear one thing on his lips and another in his heart; for in the exercise of his vocation he is compelled constantly to come forward as personally convinced. Indeed, however much freedom may prevail in the discourse—however much, according to the diversity of gifts, the manner of teaching and working may be of different kinds (a freedom and distinctiveness that Christianity to so high a degree not only permits but itself calls forth)—still, to be a true Christian priest it is required not only that the teachings of Holy Scripture constitute his conviction in

each and every point, but also that he so enter into its whole mode of expression and distinctive language that this too becomes his own, that precisely the Bible's expressions and words are to him the most apt and telling, and that he feels that just such a Word of God is most perfectly proclaimed in such a human word. He would otherwise not be a proclaimer of Christ's Word. So entirely positive and prescribed is the goal to which the theological student is to come.

And yet he should by no means so set about coming to it that, with a suppression of self-thinking, he should conform or accommodate his whole way of representing things to the handed-down holy doctrine—whereby precisely that on which everything depends, living conviction, would be prevented from coming forth powerfully and taking firm root. It can only have been the strangest confusion of thought that could ever have brought anyone to lay it down that the teachings of faith are to be assumed and believed without any regard to one's own feeling for truth, and to that inner personal agreement with them which is possible only on the presupposition of one's own reflection and, moreover, one's own testing; so slavish a demand would even exclude the possibility of the living conviction that springs from reflection and testing. The studying theologian must, as a student, precisely set free self-thinking in motion, and assume nothing either contrary to, or with a concealment of, his own feeling for truth and conviction—nothing without his own discernment.

But while he is to follow his own discernment and self-thinking and his real own conviction, his conviction is nonetheless to become a certain definite one, in that, in the way just described, it is to agree with the handed-down holy doctrine; and what he is not to set about in such a way that he should adapt himself to it and accustom himself to it by fixing his eye on it alone, this is to become, of itself, the result of his striving. Only by going through such a trial by fire does it show whether his striving also proceeded from a true inward vocation; only from such a trial by fire does a genuine proclaimer of the Word come forth. The faith he may perhaps already have won as a Christian, he is to win once again as an inquiring self-thinker, if he is to find himself called to be the Word's genuine—that is, independent, freely speaking and working—organ.

An opposition—indeed, a conflict of this kind—surely could not be resolved, and could not have been resolved so countless times, if Christ's Word and doctrine, and the apostles' preaching, were not of a quite other origin, or descent, than any philosophy or other doctrine; if, by its divinity and its genuinely perfect truth and its depth satisfying to all human profundity, it were not, as it were, provided in advance that every thinker who goes to the ground, and who will thoroughly engage with it, must indeed come to

affirm it.

In no other sphere of cognition does the demand upon what is to be the result stand so precisely and sharply defined alongside the summons to free self-thinking. But in itself, such a trial is to be gone through in every scientific endeavor. For in every science everything depends on whether we come to the truth, and on whether it so seizes us that the self-thinking and self-activity needful for the exercise of the vocation dawns in us. To be sure, in the other spheres of cognition the wholly and universally valid sum of truth is not thus pronounced in advance and laid down in a definite outer presentation that could serve as an outer touchstone, as in theology. But just as, in all domains of cognition, it is assumed that there are certain cognitions so established and settled that whoever could not attain conviction of them or insight into them would have to be regarded as excluded from that science, so too, in particular, as regards the exercise of every vocation, there are certain conditions with respect to personal conviction, insight, and mental gift—or aptitude and talent—that are needful in order to be admitted to it, both on the part of the public and by the judgment of one's own conscience.

In this, then, there is something that does not further rest on us, but in which only life, in its own progress, can teach what life will give. But then here too there is something in which the religious mind, which feels itself in, and gives itself over to, the hand of a higher governance, must especially show itself. No one can know in advance whether the essence of things, that on which everything depends, will so open itself to him that he will attain the complete, self-certain cognition, resting reliably in itself, with the sure judgment and the requisite skill—so that he can say to himself that he has found what was the aim of his striving. The spirit gives itself to whom it will, and in the measure in which it will. And we? If we would win life, we must venture life. A pledge that we shall attain what we desire is not given us in advance. Of the student Schiller's words hold entirely: "Du mußt hoffen, Du mußt wagen, / Denn die Götter leihn kein Pfand, / Nur ein Wunder kann Dich tragen / In das schöne Wunderland." The student must, as Fichte, in his lectures "über das Wesen des Gelehrten," lays it upon our hearts, work and strive—with diligence and love of truth, in general with the *uprightness* that he is to show in his study too, and with the confident *courage* that also belongs here—as if he had the aptitude and would surely one day attain the goal, and then place it in God's hand whether he is to attain it, or one day to learn that he was destined not for this, but for another place—not for a higher, but for a lower one. No one can add a cubit to his stature, however much he worries about it, as the Scripture says. But we must nonetheless reach for what lies ahead, and press toward the goal (Phil. 3:14). And if we do not attain it, still

the time cannot be wasted in which we learned to know ourselves, learned to find our place and to know God's ordering over us.

2. But in yet quite other respects there is here a *trial to be gone through*, often a hazardous trial, and it shows itself that study too can have its *precariousness* and its *danger*. Namely, insofar as, *on the one hand*, egoism can "take occasion" from the higher cognition to which the way is to open for us, and gain an all the more corrupting influence the higher the aims are; and, *on the other hand*, the very endeavor to come to insight and clarity can precisely lead into confusion and error.

We are summoned to test our own powers, to determine and decide for ourselves, and to bring it about that in the end, in our field, we assume or cognize nothing without its having found agreement in our own free conviction and insight, and, as it were, received sanction. How natural, then, that we, when the time has come to ascend to this higher level, tearing ourselves loose from others' guidance, begin to form our own modes of representation for ourselves, and, when we have formed such for ourselves, hold fast to them and cherish them with a special predilection, because in them we have tested our own self-thinking. But in this there is then something that can easily detain or ensnare our striving forward toward truth, and lead astray—indeed, give admittance and influence to that which should never mean anything alongside truth. That this or that has been found out or thought out *by ourselves* now easily comes, imperceptibly, to contribute to giving it significance for us. Greater grows the danger when we now even let ourselves be brought, before the time of maturity, *to come forward publicly* with our ways of viewing things—something that already, because it restricts inquiry to a certain particular and arrests the all-sided, disinterested study that strives merely to attain cognition, is not good in the proper academic years, and, when it comes too early, testifies to a not truly deep reverence for science. What has once been asserted is easily held fast eagerly, because it *has once been asserted*, especially when this has happened in a public way. Especially if polemic—which in general so easily, to use a word of Goethe's, pushes back calm cultivation, when it does not proceed from living warmth for an important cause and is joined with high mental power—brings one to take the party one takes as a *party*, so that a *party-spirit* takes root, and the matter is gradually no longer defended or attacked because a still lively conviction and discernment leads to it and so far as it leads, but because it now once for all belongs to our party to judge so. Indeed, far uglier—even base and bad—motives we have not seldom seen gain the upper hand in scientific endeavor. How much moral badness can lay itself open even in the writer, as writer, of this the literature of our times bears witnesses that arouse dismay.

Now that deviation has shown itself as possible, one must therefore expressly watch that pure love of truth *alone* governs and rules, and that only truth is sought and nothing else—either in place of it, without whose attainment the whole endeavor would indeed be nothing, or alongside it, whereby the endeavor and the study would be polluted and distorted. It is especially pernicious when the lack of true reverence for truth even goes so far that mere *arbitrariness* (the wholly momentary and accidental) comes to play in place of faithful and conscientious heedfulness of truth itself, so that now one thing, now another seems and is assumed according to momentary pleasure, and mere *whims* determine assumption and judgment. Be it that a craving for the new, the unusual, the brilliant and strikingly conspicuous, or some other vain desire leads to a perhaps even unbridled and *frivolous play with the objects of cognition*, as though all esteem for the loftiness of truth, all feeling for its holiness and all care to let it speak by itself alone, had vanished, and only striking whims and expressions were what mattered. Or else that a *dull indifference*—a self-conscious lack of true conviction about anything whatever—so arises that everything is only assumed and kept according to momentary appearance, as a mere *opinion* that can be let go again, and in which one does not feel oneself to possess anything one knows one can, or believes one can, rely on with heartfelt trust and reliability: an *indifferentism* that bears the stamp of pure nothingness. There must be something of which a human being is as convinced as of his own existence, so that he *will live and die by its truth*. Only from such a conviction can a strong and capable life proceed. [That indifferentism must not, moreover, be confused with what has been meant by the word *tolerance*. Intolerance—which would gladly force its cognition upon others, or in general, in order to make it prevail, use other weapons and means than truth's own might and power and the truth-proclaiming word that carries one away to conviction and spiritually compels, in which truth, bearing witness to itself, also works by itself—bears just as fully as indifferentism, though in a quite different way, the stamp of a lack of genuine feeling and esteem for truth's inner loftiness and holiness; for intolerance aims not at promoting truth as truth, but only its outward acceptance and confession without genuine conviction—as though truth's so-called acceptance without this living conviction really were an acceptance of truth, a spreading of truth's dominion. To set other means in motion to promote a cognition than precisely those that can produce true living conviction is not only to show a singular lack of trust in truth's power—as though its own power in and for itself were not strong enough—but even leads to missing that on which everything really depends, and to letting an authority other than truth's occupy the place that truth's own power should have. Every undertaking

of this kind commits (like the assassination that Saul committed) a robbery upon what belongs to truth. From which it becomes evident that indifferentism and intolerance both lack the genuinely deep love for, and esteem for, truth, which powerfully wills the truth, and therefore wills only pure truth itself in its purity. Tolerance, moreover (to note this too), is not something lying midway between the two, but something that, with respect to motive and principle, is quite different from them.]

3. Yet even without base and low motives playing a part, or a reprehensible way of thinking lying at the ground, re-examination can lead to error—even in the eagerly striving person. The striving that is in motion drives forward; but assumption and representation, so long as the true that should determine and master it has not yet shown itself, or not shown itself clearly, does not yet become bound and determined to a single way of representing, but finds several possibilities before it, between which one now wavers. Thereby the endeavor to come to cognition is halted in its progress. Then it easily happens that, despite all honest love of truth, mere drive to get forward brings one to seize an expedient and to pursue it, without definite certainty of its correctness being had; the consequence of which easily becomes that an incorrect mode of representation takes root, which—though it was at the beginning recognized as merely *hypothetical*—nonetheless not seldom afterward gains the dominion of truth and certainty, in that it, when much is seen brought to unity by it, or drawn to it so as to be brought into connection and coherence with it (something quite possible with the false representation), finally becomes habitual and, as it were, at home in our whole sphere of representation. Indeed, in order to get further and not be halted entirely, it can sometimes be needful—or at least natural and conducive—to form such hypothetical modes of representation tentatively and to pursue them until, in the course of the investigation, they can be tested and bear witness to themselves. Yet it must not be forgotten that we, who cannot master the higher working by which cognition is given us, ought not to *hasten forward* on our own beyond what is given us, but must wait until the true itself will show itself to us. But the consequence of this then easily becomes what is said: *that the way to truth goes through error*. The systematic tendency, which strives to bring the manifold—cognized and comprehended piecemeal—to unity, and would behold a whole therein, and to this end soon wishes a multitude of points determined, especially easily leads to it. See § 15, Remark 2 and following. In general, of the individual inquirer there holds what we see to hold of humanity in its advance to cognition, and what seems to be a fundamental law for the organic course of development of all life in general: that the organic striving, through which the inner essence of things is to come to outer appearance, spirit and truth

to dominion, must pass through a plurality—indeed, perhaps a countless plurality—of standpoints and states, on and in which life must gradually settle for a time and come to a certain degree of clarity, unity, and firm subsistence, and to definite results, before it can reach the point at which it can fully ripen to depart from them again and strive up to higher, and therefore more surveying, standpoints and new organizations. But then the complete *all-sidedness*, in which everything comes to show itself, in all respects, rightly in its light and with its relative validity, is aimed at *through a series of one-sidednesses*. On the one hand, we gradually take what is to be cognized in its connection and wholeness *from different sides* (we have discussed this earlier, § 15, Remark 4); on the other hand, in the consideration and investigation of the manifold that offers itself, we always first penetrate into a *certain definite* manifold, seeking its unity and inner essence, before we seek to embrace it together with a *certain other*, which perhaps has also already been investigated on its own, and now to find the higher point of unity for both—whereby the inner essence cognized therein (that is, the expression of the Idea that has come forth therein) will also come to show itself in a new light, when it is now beheld as the same, the primitive and constitutive, in both these different aggregates of manifoldness. As we, from the side of the manifold, approach unity and the Idea—and as we seek to behold again a cognized Idea in the manifold, or to make it prevail therein, and therefore make this manifold the object of a special scrutiny (see § 16)—we must begin by taking certain individual smaller wholes embraced by the larger whole, each on its own, and first penetrate to the relatively first and to the unity in each of them, before we can come to grasp the deeper unity in them all; for precisely the innermost in each of them is the point at which they are most essentially bound together. But when the time comes for it, then what in each of these spheres seemed to stand fast will no longer be able to; the higher standpoint at which we arrive will show *everything* in a new light, and what has come to a certain degree of firm subsistence must then loosen itself again in order, in a living and organic way, to enter into the larger whole.

But thus there can easily, in the course of study, follow upon a firm, calm, and self-satisfying state of cognition a state in which uncertainty, insecurity, and unrest set in. What we had, we cannot keep as we had it; and the new that is to come has not yet won shape in us, but moves in us in a fermenting mass, in which a thousand individual elements for a new formation move alongside and against one another, each asserting its significance, without their having yet found their relative place. In the course of development of the sciences in the history of humanity we find—just as the geognost finds it in that of the earth's globe—not only different formations that have succeeded

one another, each developed in its own distinctive way and with its own directions, but we also find, in the midst between two such, not seldom transitional periods in which fragments of an earlier formation are found bound together by a wholly heterogeneous cement and, as it were, kneaded together into a coherent mass—yet by no means uniform throughout, still less crystallinely developed. The scientific course of development, too, is an *undulatory* one; rising and sinking alternate with one another. What can and shall, however, as the constant, run through this alternation of calm subsistence and fermenting becoming, and even in the midst of it maintain a higher calm, so that the unrest cannot penetrate to the kernel of life and endeavor, is a firm conviction of the reality of the *fundamental cognition*—and, moreover, of the very *striving* thereby called forth—the conviction that there is something to seek and therefore also to find: a conviction which, joined with the religious disposition, will bring it about that, under all the wavering, dissatisfaction, and darkening that come in their times, there will be an unshakable ground, and with it a secure fundamental peace and an unclouded fundamental clarity in our innermost—a mood that can be maintained in no small degree by that glance toward an ideal mentioned earlier (§ 13, Remark 3), which Schiller in his poem “die Ideale und das Leben” has so gloriously depicted.

As regards in particular the *philosophical* grounding needful to all genuine scientific culture, everyone has, long before he can be mature for philosophical study, already settled into a way of taking and viewing life which philosophy cannot let stand; he has given away the name of reality to that which has no true reality. A mode of representation other than the philosophical also maintains itself throughout life alongside the latter—much as we go on speaking as though the sun went around the earth, however well we know that this is not so, and however easily the practiced person can at any moment place himself on the right standpoint. Already for this reason it is no small thing that is to happen when philosophy is to come to an individual and become living in him; for his whole sphere of representation is to loosen and, as it were, melt away, in order to undergo a new process of formation and to be reborn. Yet, when the time for it comes, it has not so great a difficulty in this respect in the eager-to-learn student; for precisely a longing for the Idea awakens at the time when he is mature for academic study, together with his striving after independence, and he is easily prepared to open himself to that which is first to bring the right light and the right life into all that he has hitherto learned. For a time he gives himself willingly over to the contemplation of the Idea. In the form in which it is offered him, he takes it openly, and the higher self-thinking goes in one with a higher learning. What is thus handed down to him in a

lively way—through a free self-thinking addressed to his own self-thinking—he easily thinks himself into, appropriates, and rejoices in and by it; he also carries it further in many an individual point in an independent way, and attaches to it many an own answer to self-posed questions; it now seems entirely to have been assimilated. But if a deeper drive toward philosophy and genuine science lives in him, then it will in time show itself that the appropriation was not thereby at an end. What was thus taken up will gradually come up again, be worked through once more, in order now first, under a proper and complete rebirth, to be fully assimilated and (to use one more physiological word) taken up into, or pass over into, constitution; all, or at least a part, of the principal questions that seemed well answered and brought to rest—especially the fundamental question underlying them all—now first come up in such a way that the sting in them, or the birth-pangs therein (ὥδῖς, to take an expression from the second of the Platonic letters), are felt; and now, for the first time, one really asks from the bottom of the heart. What we formerly grasped and surveyed in its whole connection, and therefore cognized in this its connection and consistency, and in which we thus found what we sought—the Idea and the fundamental cognition—so that we willingly took it up: this we now see in a different light. What the already matured thinker might at once have found, when such a doctrine was brought to him—that it, despite its perhaps good, well-grounded, and very comprehensive coherence, had nonetheless either not at all or not sufficiently taken account of this or that which had otherwise been thought in this science, or at least might have been thought of—this the student too will, in the course of his study, be able to notice about what he earlier readily let find entrance in himself. Nothing handed down as a scientific system is, after all, perfect—as little as regards all-sided regard and survey as otherwise. Even a certain immediate—though certainly not always infallible—*feeling for truth*, which, without unrefuted objections having yet formed themselves, can strive against what has been received, or at least against the way in which it is developed, now also comes into consideration. In the person in whom such a feeling or sensation resists, it is something real that, just as well as definite objections, is to be cleared up and may not be set aside. In being led into an otherwise deep-reaching and well-connected whole of thought, one must indeed not let such resisting sensations—indeed, not even many definite objections, drawn from one’s hitherto-held mode of representation or arising on the moment—gain a significant or even disturbing influence. There is many a new doctrine, many a new thought or new mode of presentation, of which it may with reason be said: Test it practically, take it up and enter into it, and you will surely find that it is of the truth. But if someone has taken it up precisely in this way and

lived with it, and has precisely thereby been ripened to set himself against it (as, in general, only by cognizing does one become truly able to contest, in the right way, that which otherwise has some true content), then he can also give a resisting feeling power; perhaps something announces itself in it that, through him, will break a new path, open the entrance to a new cognition.

Study, in general, calls forth a *reciprocal struggle* between a science expressed in a definite form and firmly maintaining itself in it, on the one side, and an individuality that also asserts its distinctiveness, on the other. Only in our own way can we grasp—into our own language must we also translate for ourselves—the universally valid truth; indeed, as the universally valid it is to show itself by being able to enter as ruling into us too, such as we once for all are, provided only we do not lack the requisite aptitude and strive eagerly and honestly. But in a science consistently carried out, exactly determined in its parts, it comes to meet us and seems unable to step out of this, or to yield anything of it. Meanwhile it must nonetheless loosen itself, and pass over from the fixed form into a certain fluidity, in order to be able to enter into us; for it comes to become ours only in that, by the power of its inner first moving life-principle, it is reborn or builds itself up again in us; and thus, in the course of this its re-living or rebuilding in the new individuality, the new contribution that this individuality is able to deliver can come to be added—and now, therefore, the individuality too, in the reciprocal struggle that sets in, enjoys its advancement.

But from this there then easily arises a *ferment*, which the powerfully striving person may have to go through—and that perhaps even several times, in different epochs. The general is to become his; but in order to become his, to build itself up again out of its elements—indeed, to undergo a certain new modification with respect to its mode of expression, perhaps even a metamorphosis and reformation (which, however, one must guard against setting about out of a desire for originality)—it must in him dissolve into its elements. A multitude of points shine forth, a multitude of separate, often opposed assumptions press upon one, but unity and harmony cannot yet be brought into the mass that has come into motion but not yet to clarity. Then, not quite seldom, doubt and unrest lead so far that one even doubts the reality of the whole endeavor, the reality of the fundamental cognition underlying this endeavor, which now seems not to hold up and endure through the whole course that—to repeat a word that occurred earlier—was, by succeeding, to bear witness to it. About our own vocation to strive forward on this path, disquieting doubt arises still more easily. In this we must then take to heart that, while we are still first striving forward and working to find the truth and bring it

to clarity and evidence in us by developing an aggregate of individual cognitions and presentations that is to become its adequate expression, we must—since this expression of it, its clear appearance, can after all come forth only as an effect and consequence of its own influence and power—necessarily have given ourselves over to it and have let ourselves be determined and led by it, before evidence and assurance can come. The product, the clear and definite presentation—and, moreover, the fullness of truth, or complete self-revelation, that first comes with it—cannot, after all, set in at once together with that which sets the productive striving in motion.

In the inner life of consciousness too, in which we are to grow in insight and cognition, there is a self-operating working and becoming (φύσις) to which our own labor refers itself, and by which a light must now dawn for us of itself. But this self-working light in us requires its time and has its stages, as well as its crises.

And here it is, then, that both in the religious and in the scientific respect a faith (see § 5, Remark 2)—as a trustful attachment to, and conviction of, that whose power and significance have already shown themselves and borne witness to themselves, although its fullness has not yet come—must find room. Indeed, just as patience and trust may now be needed so as not to be overwhelmed by the unrest, so too a certain respect for an αὐτὸς ἔφα is needful. Even if we are not to assume *on authority*, we still cannot refuse to have *esteem for authority*, for the judgment of thorough thinkers—indeed, of thinking people in general; and just as it strengthens our conviction not a little that in it we meet with another thinker (since what shows itself the same to two who have come to it by different paths seems thereby to show itself as valid over both), so it is also natural that when we come up against thorough thinkers, we are thereby brought to pause and to new reconsideration. But especially should he who has not yet come to that thorough investigation of a great manifold, and the overview of it, which in every science is needful for a solid judgment about any individual point, out of esteem for the word of those who have come so far, hold his conflicting assumptions and judgments *in suspenso*. As indeed the forward-striving thinker always, until he has reached a certain overview and to a certain degree pursued a fundamental thought into its consequences, always finds himself in a certain hovering between assurance and non-assurance, while also that of which he begins to become assured has as yet only a certain indeterminate and hovering shape.

4. But when we now thus see the danger, or *hazardous trial*, that one has to go through in philosophical study, we may not conceal from ourselves that it just cannot be advisable for everyone to be led into the depths of philosophy, and that we may by

no means wonder if even men of excellent mental gift are not seldom disinclined to engage with it in the abstract form that is the form properly belonging to philosophy. An excellent talent for art, or for a certain kind of practical activity—indeed, for certain kinds of scientific inquiries—can, when reflection and penetrating grounding do not reach the depth of what one possesses in one's talent, easily be confused and disturbed, or arrested, by philosophical speculations. Philosophizing in scientific form is, moreover, neither the only nor the highest way in which we can strive to appropriate and possess the Idea and the spiritual content that the Idea gives to life. Piety, love, and virtue are higher than philosophy (and poetry can place itself alongside it). It is one thing, under a living receptivity and productivity, to be animated by an Idea; *another* to strive to fathom the character of that which thus underlies the vigorous activity for whose exercise we feel a vocation and a gift. With a talent for the activity itself, a talent for fathoming its inner nature and essence is precisely not always—indeed, not easily—joined. But then the immediate, vigorous exercise can easily be lost over the endeavor to penetrate, philosophizing, into that which constitutes it. Well known are Bacon's words, that philosophy, when one comes only halfway into it, leads away from God, and only when it is thoroughly studied leads back again to God. And so, too, by a study of the ideal content of one's own life that does not go sufficiently to the ground, one will come away from that content. The Idea, which one would strive by abstract thinking to behold more clearly, as it is in and for itself, cannot continue to live in us as it formerly lived in us—as the soul, not particularly coming into view, of our practical activity; and everything now depends on whether the thinking that has made it the object of penetrating reflections can win it back again under the philosophical form and bring it anew to immediate vigorous life, or whether this immediate life can preserve itself alongside that thinking in the midst of it.

§. 22.

The Idea is to, and will, not only live in the individual, but also express itself through the individual's outward presenting and working, and thereby come to a complete appearance, a complete outer rule and existence in finitude. And just as the Idea comes to constitute, and to show itself as, the sum of all fullness in the individual only when it governs this activity issuing from the individual, so too the individual comes to have the Idea completely only in seeking to realize its demands in such an outward activity.

In the merely scientific respect, this tendency to realization aims at *presenting* the Idea in a scientific whole expressed in an outward way, and thereby coming to outward

reality—a whole at whose bringing-about the individual therefore works. But besides this, the Idea can and must also objectify itself through the individual in a practice, or *practical exercise*, more immediately intervening in human life.

This striving now necessarily binds the individual to *a human community*, and in the complete organization and development of such a human community, or human whole, to becoming animated by the Idea, the Idea seeks the completion of its coming to outer subsistence and existence. The tendency to presentation becomes a tendency to *communication* and a striving to find *participation*. We have the Idea only insofar as it expresses itself through us in its power; but its full power in our utterance we feel by nothing so much as by its coming, through us, to seize others with the same might as ourselves, and now to reproduce itself in them. Even for it to express itself completely in the individual, it first comes to do so in the course of his living communication of thought and *reciprocal action with others*.

The higher life that would live in the individual and come to shape in him would equally live in them all, and comes forth completely, comes to the shape (*Gestaltung*) at which it would arrive, only when it steps forth as the one life in the whole harmoniously joined community. So there is nothing that more incites its stirrings in the individual, its inspired emergence in the individual, than his encounter or collision with other thinking individuals. That, too, is why the study of the science's history is so important, since it leads us into communion with the excellent inquirers of all the centuries.

To bring a science into being and to completion now becomes a common human affair, a concern of humanity. The interest becomes a general interest. But if the individual is to be able to work completely for this, he must *limit himself*—that is, limit his productivity—to something definite, at whose execution he will work, while nonetheless, in thereby intervening as a member in the great whole, he must be filled with the spirit of the whole, and make the study of the chosen particular the *center of a whole individual formation*.

Remark and Supplement.

1. Already from the outset, by nature, we come forth and are constituted as members of a whole, and thereby show ourselves as those destined to grow into the human whole that forms itself by means of human striving and labor. In the most decided way, nature itself points to such a whole by means of definite talents, by which definite directions and aims are assigned to individuals' endeavors—to which the drive bound up with the talent also spurs—but under which, naturally, so many other important aims, even if a sense and interest for them are not excluded, nonetheless, as regards productivity, remain untried. Such a decided talent is to be esteemed a high gift, both in many another

respect and because it raises one above the necessity of a choice guided by reflection and deliberation, and frees one from the manifold precariousnesses of such a choice; for where nature has spoken so definitely, there is, as Steffens rightly often recalled, a higher ordination to be respected, without any regard to civil station—indeed, to the natural differences among human beings—and so no choice is needful. Meanwhile, here as elsewhere, the individual must receive his particular object—though already assigned by nature—from the Idea itself, and therefore take it as the Idea assigns it; the inquirer must, as Fichte somewhere says, “let his particular science be given him by science”; it is science that he must seek out and seek to possess in that particular science. The general Idea that demands the limitation must also lead us to it and guide us by it.

2. But not everyone is taught by nature, through a particularly definite, outstanding aptitude and a definite drive, what he ought to regard as his *life's task*. And then relations and circumstances, the direction and course life has hitherto taken—which, for one who is once in it, is to be taken as a dispensation or a higher determination over him—and likewise the survey and riper judgment of others, may just as readily become a guiding counsel for us as our own inclination or predilection. With a decided disinclination for a field, no one should indeed choose it; for to enter a sphere of activity with a definite lack of what is to drive the work is to make a hazardous experiment with what is not our own. But inclination is not yet at once need or drive, and where the inclination does not have the force and forward-striving power of a definite drive, there inclination is not yet at once to be taken for an inward vocation. The inner first origin and motive of the inclination is especially to be observed. Of the inclination that has at its ground considerations of livelihood, vain honor, or such extraneous considerations—which ought to be kept entirely away—we will not even speak. But attention should indeed be drawn to the fact that an inclination for a certain sphere of activity—an inclination for a certain kind of life and existence, which captivates by its own beauty and by the beneficent influence on many people to which it must by its nature lead—should not be confused with an inclination for the science and inquiry itself, which is to prepare and make one fit for such a sphere of activity. One can, for example, paint for oneself a village priest's or a practicing physician's position and sphere of activity in such a way that one is captivated by an inclination for it, so as to be able to intervene so beneficently in human life and to gladden and bless so many. But it is a quite different inclination on which everything depends in the student who is to decide his choice. Only when, together with that inclination, he also feels an inclination to search the Scripture and to track down every aid to penetrating quite completely into its spirit and into every one of its words, as

well as an inclination to search the human heart and the human mind in order to fathom what, in the most diverse situations and relations, it may need for its salvation and advancement; or when he (to take the other example too) feels an inclination to study the whole structure of the body, the manifold kinds of the functions, their peculiarities and relations, when it interests him to track down the nature of diseases and the properties and effects of so many remedies, and so forth: only then is he moved by that inclination for *science itself* and inquiry which first teaches that that inclination for the *sphere of activity* was a true vocation for it.

3. *Regard to a practice* for which one would make oneself fit is indeed already, during study, of much importance, insofar as it can draw attention to everything that will at some point be required for it and must already now be embraced by the study; as, indeed, in all principal fields the Idea of a definite vocation, a definite activity intervening in life, really leads to gathering a multitude of otherwise separate inquiries around a center. But this regard must not ensnare one in such a way that something the Idea of the science demands for its total execution into a systematic whole should be set aside because it does not seem important for the later practical life, or that the question at all—whether what the course of the science leads to is needful for the practical life—should come forward with respect to the individual points. The best *preparation for practice* is a thorough study of the science itself as it is; for a solid practice requires being entirely *at home in the science* and having appropriated its spirit, its principles and methods—and to this only he comes who studies the science in its wholeness, and moreover its principles and methods in their whole execution, and pursues them in all their principal branches or directions. But just as regard to practice ought not to condition or ensnare, so it ought not to worry or distress either, so that at every individual point we should fret over how we should get on with it when the day of reckoning comes. The first thing is to penetrate to the spirit and the fundamental cognitions on which everything depends; if we are seized and filled by these and have entirely appropriated them, then the manifold cognition of the detail will also come gradually. In study too we must keep before our eyes what is written: Seek first the kingdom of God and his righteousness, and all these things shall be added unto you. Even as regards the practical exercise, exact knowledge of a manifold detail is indeed needful—essentially needful for it—but the truly practical thing is nonetheless the possession of that from which this detail's true *cognition* proceeds. How little, indeed, is there of the proper, deeper-going philosophy that can be applied directly in an outer sphere of activity? And yet, next to religion, nothing is more practical than philosophy, which, in bringing that on which the whole of life rests to complete cognition and clarity,

forms one to lay everywhere the right principles, the right way of viewing things, at the ground of one's judgments, and constantly to have regard to that on which everything depends.

4. The practical exercise is genuine only when science constitutes the moving principle in it. We must, in general, not forget to *take the science with us into life*, and to continue its study throughout the whole practical activity, which also constantly—offering new detail for observation—offers new material for a thinking that not only can become immediately fruitful for practice, but also, by leading us back to and into the whole science, can bring new light into the whole of it, and thereby again bring new light into the practical life. Only thus do we preserve the Idea's life in us in the midst of life in outer reality, and only thus does it come, through us, to the dominion to which it is to come—to govern human life. But then it is also of importance that our outer vocation, our sphere of activity, really stands in close connection with the Idea and science we have especially studied, and that we seek to bring both into the closest possible contact with one another. It is now also easily seen how precarious it is, in science too, to want to *serve two masters*, by cultivating a science other than the one whose cultivation our outer vocation demands of us. The human mind is indeed not seldom able to embrace the study of two disparate and unconnected sciences; but for our principal field conscience demands that we make it the one to whose exercise we are appointed—that we do not, for example, over the study of mineralogy, forget to ponder all that is important for a pastor of souls, whose office especially demands an uninterrupted study throughout one's whole life; or that we do not, over the study of botany, let our medical practice sink to the level of mere handicraft; or that we do not, as schoolmen, over the study of a particular branch of philology, forget the necessity of constant attention to our pupils' welfare in every respect—something for which observation and grounding reflection are uninterruptedly needful. He who, in the midst of his vocation's labors, does not feel himself compelled to his science resembles one who does not feel quite at home in his own house, but has a circle outside his house in which he most prefers to be—a position that is unnatural and precarious.

Conclusion.

However great is that which the one who cognizes possesses in his insight and science, we must nonetheless not forget that this is not that on which everything depends, the one thing that is needful. As Paul says: that though we spoke with the tongues of men and of angels, and had not love, we would be a sounding brass and a tinkling cymbal;

and though we had all prophecy and knew all mysteries and all knowledge, and had all faith, so that we could move mountains, and had not love, we would be nothing. Even though Plato could speak as though the true philosophizing person, for the sake of his higher cognition, had a higher place, a fairer lot to expect after death, still a Christian disposition brings with it a quite different judgment. Even though natural aptitude and talent and favoring outer circumstances may give many an advantage with respect to life's higher goods, still the highest good stands equally near to all, and the cultivated person has therein no advantage over the uncultivated, however much he may in other respects have an advantage over him. Not what we know, not what we are able, with the deeper gaze, to behold and express, is that on which everything depends—as little as it is that which we have been enabled to bring forth and accomplish. What we *are* is that on which everything depends—and that not as regards the outward-stepping subsistence in which we come forward, but as regards the origin from which our life proceeds: whether we have here completely given ourselves over into the power of the Most High and keep God everywhere in view and will what God wills, whether it be that we are to cognize and behold much or little, that what we are to accomplish is to be great or small. He who is able to preach the Word is therefore not yet nearer to salvation and blessedness. It depends on whether he now also personally takes to heart the Word that it has been given him to be able to proclaim—and takes it to heart precisely as those are to take it to heart for whom it is preached. And thus there must be a point in our inner being where we feel that everything we possess in our knowledge and by our grounding is as yet nothing; and in this sense we end with nothing more gladly than with Christ's words: Blessed are they who are poor in spirit.

Translator's note. The Danish first edition (1822) closes with a leaf of *Rettelser* (errata) correcting a few page-and-line orthographic slips in the Danish text. As these corrections concern only the spelling of the Danish original, they have no bearing on the English and are not reproduced here.